

Julius Caesar

William Shakespeare · 1599

First Folio (1623) text as edited by Standard Ebooks

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

19 scene lessons plus 1 seminar day(s), a test day and an essay day: 20 class days of 90 minutes, 5 a week (block schedule), 4 weeks
Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–19), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Julius Caesar survives only in the 1623 First Folio; it was first performed in 1599 at the new Globe. The reading text is the Standard Ebooks edition, divided into the conventional 18 scenes (plus the cast list). Shakespeare's main source was Thomas North's 1579 English translation of Plutarch's Lives. Cite act, scene and line from this edition.

Content note for teachers: Political assassination on stage, mob violence, battle deaths and four suicides (Portia's reported); Roman ideas of honorable suicide need careful, critical discussion. See the scene notes and the safe-messaging script.

Grades: Grades 9–10 (scales to graduate via rigor levels). Scaffolded-support track (grade-9 floor): students work from teacher-selected passages with scaffolds, sentence starters and partial-credit probes. **Weeks:** 4. **Class days:** 20 × 90 minutes (19 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does Julius Caesar suggest about power, ambition and tyranny?
- What does Julius Caesar suggest about honor and self-deception?
- What does Julius Caesar suggest about rhetoric and persuasion?
- What does Julius Caesar suggest about public versus private self?
- What does Julius Caesar suggest about fate, omens and free will?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the play in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.

- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the scene quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: Common Core

RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily scene quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-book test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Scaffolded support through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Scene lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* Dramatis Personae (20-minute preview) and Act I, Scene I Act I, Scene II Act I, Scene III Act II, Scene I	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*power, ambition and tyranny* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
2	Act II, Scene II *Socratic seminar on power, ambition and tyranny* Act II, Scene III (20-minute preview) and Act II, Scene IV Act III, Scene I Act III, Scene II	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*honor and self-deception* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on power, ambition and tyranny • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
3	Act III, Scene III Act IV, Scene I Act IV, Scene II Act IV, Scene III Act V, Scene I	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*rhetoric and persuasion* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
4	Act V, Scene II (20-minute preview) and Act V, Scene III Act V, Scene IV (20-minute preview) and Act V, Scene V *Whole-book test (90 minutes)* *Final paper writing workshop (drafting in class; finish the draft as homework)*	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*public versus private self* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Whole-book test (90 minutes) • Final paper writing workshop (drafting in class; finish the draft as homework) • Final paper: peer review, revision and submission	Whole-book test and final essay

	Final paper: peer review, revision and submission		• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to Julius Caesar

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about William Shakespeare's life or times connects to power, ambition and tyranny in “Julius Caesar”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (power, ambition and tyranny, honor and self-deception, rhetoric and persuasion).

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2

Author biography

William Shakespeare was baptized in Stratford-upon-Avon on 26 April 1564, married Anne Hathaway in 1582 and had three children, Susanna and the twins Hamnet and Judith. By the early 1590s he was writing and acting in London; from 1594 he was a sharer in the Lord Chamberlain's Men, the company that built the Globe on the south bank of the Thames in 1599. He wrote or co-wrote about 38 plays, including histories of English kings and tragedies drawn from Roman history, and died in Stratford on 23 April 1616. His fellow actors collected his plays in the First Folio of 1623.

Historical and cultural context

Julius Caesar dates from 1599, the year the Globe opened; a Swiss traveller, Thomas Platter, recorded seeing a play about Caesar at a Thameside playhouse on 21 September 1599. Shakespeare's source was Plutarch's Lives of the Noble Grecians and Romans in Thomas North's English translation (1579), which he followed closely, sometimes almost word for word. The historical Caesar was stabbed in the Senate house on the Ides of March (15 March) 44 BCE by senators led by Brutus and Cassius; Antony and Octavius defeated them at Philippi in 42 BCE. For English audiences in 1599 the story had urgent echoes: Queen Elizabeth I was old, had no heir, and the question of who would rule next, and whether resisting a ruler could ever be justified, was dangerous to discuss openly.

Publication and reception, then and now

The play was first printed in the First Folio (1623), in an unusually clean text that is thought to come from a theatrical manuscript. It is the first of Shakespeare's Roman tragedies drawn from Plutarch, followed by Antony and Cleopatra and Coriolanus.

Then: It was popular from the start: the poet Leonard Digges, in verses printed in 1640, recalled audiences "ravish'd" by the quarrel scene between Brutus and Cassius while other plays emptied the house. It remained in the repertory after the Restoration and was among the most performed Shakespeare plays in the eighteenth century.

Now: The play is a school standard, partly because it has little sexual content and centres on rhetoric and politics. Productions often make it about modern power: Orson Welles's 1937 Mercury Theatre staging dressed Caesar as a fascist dictator; Joseph Mankiewicz's 1953 film starred Marlon Brando as Antony; the Public Theater's 2017 Shakespeare in the Park production, with a Caesar resembling a contemporary president,

provoked national controversy and lost sponsors. Critics debate who the hero is, Caesar or Brutus, and whether the assassination is presented as justified.

Overview (spoiler-free)

Julius Caesar returns to Rome in triumph, and some senators fear he will make himself king. Cassius sets out to persuade the respected Brutus to join a conspiracy. The play follows what they decide, what happens on the Ides of March, and how words, especially the speeches at Caesar's funeral, change the course of Rome.

Main themes

- power and ambition: is Caesar dangerous, or is the fear of him what is dangerous?
- honour and idealism: Brutus acts for "the general good"; ask whether good intentions are enough.
- rhetoric and persuasion: the play is a contest of speeches; watch how each speaker moves an audience.
- fate and omens: dreams, storms and soothsayers; does anyone listen?
- friendship and loyalty: Brutus and Cassius, Brutus and Caesar, Antony and Caesar.

Why it matters

The play asks questions every democracy faces: when is it right to resist a leader, and what happens when a crowd can be swayed by a good speech? It is also the best training ground in literature for analyzing persuasion, a skill students need every day.

Spoilers · teacher only

The conspirators stab Caesar in the Capitol. Brutus lets Antony speak at the funeral; Antony's oration turns the crowd, and the conspirators flee. Antony, Octavius and Lepidus draw up a death list. Brutus and Cassius quarrel and reconcile; Portia has killed herself; Caesar's ghost visits Brutus. At Philippi Cassius has himself killed after misreading a report, and Brutus runs on his own sword; Antony calls him "the noblest Roman of them all."

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Before we open Julius Caesar: Is it ever right to break a law or overthrow a leader to protect a country? Write for five minutes with one example.*
> **Prompt:** Before we open Julius Caesar: Is it ever right to break a law or overthrow a leader to protect a country? Write for five minutes with one example.

> **8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)**
> Key literary terms for the unit.
> *republic (a state governed by elected representatives, not a king); tribune (an official representing the common people); conspiracy (a secret plan by a group); oration (a formal public speech); rhetoric (the art of persuasion: ethos, pathos, logos); soothsayer (a fortune-teller); the Ides of March (15 March).*

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)

Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).

About the author. William Shakespeare was baptized in Stratford-upon-Avon on 26 April 1564, married Anne Hathaway in 1582 and had three children, Susanna and the twins Hamnet and Judith. By the early 1590s he was writing and acting in London; from 1594 he was a sharer in the Lord Chamberlain's Men, the company that built the Globe on the south bank of the Thames in 1599. He wrote or co-wrote about 38 plays, including histories of English kings and tragedies drawn from Roman history, and died in Stratford on 23 April 1616. His fellow actors collected his plays in the First Folio of 1623. The world of the book. Julius Caesar dates from 1599, the year the Globe opened; a Swiss traveller, Thomas Platter, recorded seeing a play about Caesar at a Thameside playhouse on 21 September 1599. Shakespeare's source was Plutarch's Lives of the Noble Grecians and Romans in Thomas North's English translation (1579), which he followed closely, sometimes almost word for word. The historical Caesar was stabbed in the Senate house on the Ides of March (15 March) 44 BCE by senators led by Brutus and Cassius; Antony and Octavius defeated them at Philippi in 42 BCE. For English audiences in 1599 the story had urgent echoes: Queen Elizabeth I was old, had no heir, and the question of who would rule next, and whether resisting a ruler could ever be justified, was dangerous to discuss openly. Publication and reception. The play was first printed in the First Folio (1623), in an unusually clean text that is thought to come from a theatrical manuscript. It is the first of Shakespeare's Roman tragedies drawn from Plutarch, followed by Antony and Cleopatra and Coriolanus. Then: It was popular from the start: the poet Leonard Digges, in verses printed in 1640, recalled audiences "ravish'd" by the quarrel scene between Brutus and Cassius while other plays emptied the house. It remained in the repertory after the Restoration and was among the most performed Shakespeare plays in the eighteenth century. Now: The play is a school standard, partly because it has little sexual content and centres on rhetoric and politics. Productions often make it about modern power: Orson Welles's 1937 Mercury Theatre staging dressed Caesar as a fascist dictator; Joseph Mankiewicz's 1953 film starred Marlon Brando as Antony; the Public Theater's 2017 Shakespeare in the Park production, with a Caesar resembling a contemporary president, provoked national controversy and lost sponsors. Critics debate who the hero is, Caesar or Brutus, and whether the assassination is presented as justified.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)

Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.

First, meaning. I read "The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings" slowly and put it in my own words: Cassius tells Brutus that their low position is their own fault, not the stars'. Next, craft. I notice the contrast between "stars" (fate) and "ourselves" (choice). The strongest word is "underlings": it is a contemptuous word for inferiors, which stings Brutus's pride. Then, effect. What is Cassius arguing to Brutus? My answer: Cassius urges Brutus to act against Caesar, claiming free will; the line shows his skill at manipulation and introduces the play's question of fate versus choice.

> *The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings* (Act I, Scene II, Cassius)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings" slowly and put it in my own words: Cassius tells Brutus that their low position is their own fault, not the stars'. Next, craft. I notice the contrast between "stars" (fate) and "ourselves" (choice). The strongest word is "underlings": it is a contemptuous word for inferiors, which stings Brutus's pride. Then, effect. What is Cassius arguing to Brutus? My answer: Cassius urges Brutus to act against Caesar, claiming free will; the line shows his skill at manipulation and introduces the play's question of fate versus choice.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
What the book is about (no spoilers): Julius Caesar returns to Rome in triumph, and some senators fear he will make himself king. Cassius sets out to persuade the respected Brutus to join a conspiracy. The play follows what they decide, what happens on the Ides of March, and how words, especially the speeches at Caesar's funeral, change the course of Rome. Themes to track: power and ambition: is Caesar dangerous, or is the fear of him what is dangerous? honour and idealism: Brutus acts for "the general good"; ask whether good intentions are enough. rhetoric and persuasion: the play is a contest of speeches; watch how each speaker moves an audience. fate and omens: dreams, storms and soothsayers; does anyone listen? friendship and loyalty: Brutus and Cassius, Brutus and Caesar, Antony and Caesar.

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Theme page "rhetoric and persuasion": Prediction: someone will use a speech to change the crowd's mind. Question: is persuading people the same as manipulating them?
Task: Set up a reading journal for Julius Caesar: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Theme page "rhetoric and persuasion": Prediction: someone will use a speech to change the crowd's mind. Question: is persuading people the same as manipulating them?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.
Why does Julius Caesar still matter? The play asks questions every democracy faces: when is it right to resist a leader, and what happens when a crowd can be swayed by a good speech? It is also the best training ground in literature for analyzing persuasion, a skill students need every day.
Anchor question: Why might Julius Caesar still be taught today?
Facilitation: The play asks questions every democracy faces: when is it right to resist a leader, and what happens when a crowd can be swayed by a good speech? It is also the best training ground in literature for analyzing persuasion, a skill students need every day.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)
Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).
Shakespeare wrote Julius Caesar in 1599, when Queen Elizabeth was old and had no heir, and Londoners feared civil war over the succession. Why might a play about killing a ruler matter then? Answer: Accept answers such as: audiences worried about rebellion and civil war; the play asks whether overthrowing a ruler is justified; it shows the chaos that follows.
Exit ticket: Shakespeare wrote Julius Caesar in 1599, when Queen Elizabeth was old and had no heir, and Londoners feared civil war over the succession. Why might a play about killing a ruler matter then?
Answer: Accept answers such as: audiences worried about rebellion and civil war; the play asks whether overthrowing a ruler is justified; it shows the chaos that follows.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Preview the first reading.
Tomorrow we begin reading: Dramatis Personae.

Teacher notes · sources: Folger Shakespeare Library, "Julius Caesar" (https://www.folger.edu/explore/shakespeares-works/julius-caesar/); Royal Shakespeare Company, "Julius Caesar: about the play" (https://www.rsc.org.uk/julius-caesar/about-the-play); Plutarch, Lives, trans. Thomas North (1579), "The Life of Julius Caesar" and "The Life of Marcus Brutus" (https://www.gutenberg.org/); Thomas Platter's travel diary, 21 September 1599 (in E. K. Chambers, The Elizabethan Stage, vol. 2) (https://www.worldcat.org/); Leonard Digges, commendatory verses in Shakespeare's Poems (1640) (https://www.folger.edu/); New York Times coverage of the 2017 Public Theater production (https://www.nytimes.com/2017/06/12/theater/julius-caesar-public-theater-delta-bank-of-america.html)

Flags (verify before teaching):

- Platter does not name the playhouse; most scholars identify it as the newly built Globe.
- Plutarch reports that Caesar spoke words to Brutus as he died (in Greek, "You too, child?" in some sources); the Latin "Et tu, Brute?" is not in Plutarch and appears in earlier English plays. Do not present it as Caesar's historical last words.

Lesson 2: Dramatis Personae

Focus: the cast and world of the play

Objective: Students will identify at least 5 characters from the cast list and explain, in one sentence each, how each is related to the play's central family or court.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3

Teacher only · spoilers

The cast list names Julius Caesar; the triumvirs who rule after his death (Octavius Caesar, Mark Antony, Lepidus); the conspirators (Marcus Brutus, Cassius, Casca, Trebonius, Ligarius, Decius Brutus, Metellus Cimber, Cinna); senators, tribunes, a soothsayer, the teacher of rhetoric Artemidorus, two poets, soldiers and servants; and two women, Calpurnia and Portia. The action moves from Rome to Sardis and the plains of Philippi.

Background: Shakespeare wrote the play in 1599, late in the reign of Elizabeth I, who was old, childless and had named no successor. Fears of civil war after a ruler's death made a story about a murdered leader and the war that followed timely. The story comes from Plutarch's Lives in North's translation; the real Caesar was killed on 15 March 44 BC.

Significance: The cast list already divides the world into factions: Caesar's party, the conspirators, and the later triumvirate. Noticing that only two women appear, both as wives, helps students later ask who has a voice in public life.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Is it ever right to remove a leader by force to protect a republic? What would have to be true first? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to power and ambition because....*
> **Prompt:** Is it ever right to remove a leader by force to protect a republic? What would have to be true first?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to power and ambition because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: every group is defined by its relation to Caesar's power.

8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Shakespeare wrote the play in 1599, late in the reign of Elizabeth I, who was old, childless and had named no successor. Fears of civil war after a ruler's death made a story about a murdered leader and the war that followed timely. The story comes from Plutarch's Lives in North's translation; the real Caesar was killed on 15 March 44 BC. The cast list already divides the world into factions: Caesar's party, the conspirators, and the later triumvirate. Noticing that only two women appear, both as wives, helps students later ask who has a voice in public life. Characterization: The cast is divided by politics: Caesar; the triumvirs after his death (Antony, Octavius, Lepidus); the conspirators; senators; tribunes; the citizens. Students should see the factions before they see the people. Structure: Caesar, the title character, dies in Act III; the cast list does not tell us that Brutus has the most lines. Setting: Rome, then Sardis and Philippi: the play moves from the city to the battlefield, from politics to war. Watch for omens and portents: Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: "A Soothsayer" (Dramatis Personae).

16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the cast and world of the play. Key takeaway: every group is defined by its relation to Caesar's power.

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** The cast is divided by politics: Caesar; the triumvirs after his death (Antony, Octavius, Lepidus); the conspirators; senators; tribunes; the citizens. Students should see the factions before they see the people.
- **Structure:** Caesar, the title character, dies in Act III; the cast list does not tell us that Brutus has the most lines.
- **Setting:** Rome, then Sardis and Philippi: the play moves from the city to the battlefield, from politics to war.

Themes and how they develop

- **power and ambition:** every group is defined by its relation to Caesar's power.

Symbols and motifs

- **omens and portents:** Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: "A Soothsayer" (Dramatis Personae).
- **Rome and the people:** The crowd's loyalty is fickle; speakers win Rome by moving the plebeians. In this scene: "Senators, citizens, guards, attendants, etc" (Dramatis Personae).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Julius Caesar" (Dramatis Personae) The title character, who will die halfway through.
- "Marcus Brutus" (Dramatis Personae) Listed among the conspirators; he has more lines than anyone.
- "Calpurnia" (Dramatis Personae) One of only two women, both wives who are not heard by their husbands.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power.
Evidence: "Julius Caesar" (Dramatis Personae)
Reasoning: Caesar, Antony and Octavius head one list, and Brutus, Cassius and the other conspirators another, so the play begins as a map of loyalty and opposition.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
rhetoric (noun)	the art of persuasive speaking	*Artemidorus of Cnidos, a teacher of rhetoric*	
conspirator (noun)	a person who joins a secret plot	*Marcus Brutus, conspirator against Julius Caesar*	"conspirator": Origin: Anglo-Norman conspiratour. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/conspirator#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Is it ever right to remove a leader by force to protect a republic? What would have to be true first?
2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with power, ambition and tyranny?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Which characters on the cast list are conspirators against Caesar? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Brutus, Cassius, Casca, Trebonius, Ligarius, Decius Brutus, Metellus Cimber and Cinna.
2. Who are the two women named in the cast list? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Calpurnia and Portia

3. Which three men become triumvirs after Caesar's death? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Octavius, Antony and Lepidus
4. Whom is Calpurnia married to? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Caesar
5. Where does the final battle of the play take place? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Philippi
6. What is Artemidorus's profession? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A teacher of rhetoric
7. Retell the three most important events of "Dramatis Personae" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The cast list names Julius Caesar; the triumvirs who rule after his death (Octavius Caesar, Mark Antony, Lepidus); the conspirators (Marcus Brutus, Cassius, Casca, Trebonius, Ligarius, Decius Brutus, Metellus Cimber, Cinna); senators, tribunes, a soothsayer, the teacher of rhetoric Artemidorus, two poets, soldiers and servants; and two women, Calpurnia and Portia. The action moves from Rome to…
8. Who is on stage in "Dramatis Personae", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Dramatis Personae" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Artemidorus of Cnidos, a teacher of rhetoric" What does "rhetoric" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: rhetoric: the art of persuasive speaking.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why might a play about killing a ruler have felt dangerous in London in 1599? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Elizabeth was old with no named heir; succession and rebellion were live fears.
2. What does "Dramatis Personae" suggest about the cast and world of the play? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The cast list already divides the world into factions: Caesar's party, the conspirators, and the later triumvirate. Noticing that only two women appear, both as wives, helps students later ask who has a voice in public life.
3. Find one example of setting in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the cast and world of the play? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Useful evidence: "Julius Caesar" (Dramatis Personae): The title character, who will die halfway through. On characterization: The cast is divided by politics: Caesar; the triumvirs after his death (Antony, Octavius, Lepidus); the conspirators; senators; tribunes; the citizens. Students should see the factions before they see the people. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Julius Caesar”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Dramatis Personae”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: The cast list names Julius Caesar; the triumvirs who rule after his death (Octavius Caesar, Mark Antony, Lepidus); the conspirators (Marcus Brutus, Cassius, Casca, Trebonius, Ligarius, Decius Brutus, Metellus Cimber, Cinna); senators, tribunes, a soothsayer, the teacher of rhetoric Artemidorus, two…
7. As the opening scene, what does “Dramatis Personae” set up that the rest of Julius Caesar will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Useful evidence: “Marcus Brutus” (Dramatis Personae): Listed among the conspirators; he has more lines than anyone. On structure: Caesar, the title character, dies in Act III; the cast list does not tell us that Brutus has the most lines. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Useful evidence: “Calpurnia” (Dramatis Personae): One of only two women, both wives who are not heard by their husbands. On characterization: The cast is divided by politics: Caesar; the triumvirs after his death (Antony, Octavius, Lepidus); the conspirators; senators; tribunes; the citizens. Students should see the factions before they see the people. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is it ever right to remove a leader by force to protect a republic? What would have to be true first?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with power, ambition and tyranny? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Useful evidence: “Julius Caesar” (Dramatis Personae): The title character, who will die halfway through. On structure: Caesar, the title character, dies in Act III; the cast list does not tell us that Brutus has the most lines. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. The play is named for Caesar, yet he appears in few scenes. Who do you predict is the true center of the play, and why? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Brutus is a strong case: his choices and conscience drive the plot.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's

power. Useful evidence: “Marcus Brutus” (Dramatis Personae): Listed among the conspirators; he has more lines than anyone. Theme link: every group is defined by its relation to Caesar's power. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “The cast list already divides the world into factions: Caesar's party, the conspirators, and the later triumvirate. Noticing that only two women appear, both as wives, helps students later ask who has a voice in public life.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Useful evidence: “Calpurnia” (Dramatis Personae): One of only two women, both wives who are not heard by their husbands. Theme link: every group is defined by its relation to Caesar's power. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Useful evidence: “Julius Caesar” (Dramatis Personae): The title character, who will die halfway through. On characterization: The cast is divided by politics: Caesar; the triumvirs after his death (Antony, Octavius, Lepidus); the conspirators; senators; tribunes; the citizens. Students should see the factions before they see the people. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Dramatis Personae”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the cast and world of the play. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Useful evidence: “Marcus Brutus” (Dramatis Personae): Listed among the conspirators; he has more lines than anyone. On structure: Caesar, the title character, dies in Act III; the cast list does not tell us that Brutus has the most lines. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Dramatis Personae”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Useful evidence: “Calpurnia” (Dramatis Personae): One of only two women, both wives who are not heard by their husbands. Theme link: every group is defined by its relation to Caesar's power. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to honor and self-deception: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's

power. Useful evidence: “Julius Caesar” (Dramatis Personae): The title character, who will die halfway through. Theme link: every group is defined by its relation to Caesar's power. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Useful evidence: “Marcus Brutus” (Dramatis Personae): Listed among the conspirators; he has more lines than anyone. On setting: Rome, then Sardis and Philippi: the play moves from the city to the battlefield, from politics to war. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Dramatis Personae” treats the cast and world of the play with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Useful evidence: “Calpurnia” (Dramatis Personae): One of only two women, both wives who are not heard by their husbands. Theme link: every group is defined by its relation to Caesar's power. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act I, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Useful evidence: “Julius Caesar” (Dramatis Personae): The title character, who will die halfway through. Theme link: every group is defined by its relation to Caesar's power. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the cast and world of the play? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Useful evidence: “Marcus Brutus” (Dramatis Personae): Listed among the conspirators; he has more lines than anyone. Theme link: every group is defined by its relation to Caesar's power. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Artemidorus of Cnidos, a teacher of _____” Word bank: conspirator, rhetoric

   Key: rhetoric

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whom is Calpurnia married to?

   A. Brutus

   B. Caesar

   C. Cassius

   D. Antony

   Key: B (Caesar)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is Artemidorus's profession?

   A. A poet

   B. A soothsayer

   C. A teacher of rhetoric

   D. A senator

   Key: C (A teacher of rhetoric)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Artemidorus of Cnidos, a teacher of rhetoric”, what does “rhetoric” most nearly mean?

   A. to help; to favor

   B. envious rivalry

   C. to strip (statues) of their decorations

   D. the art of persuasive speaking

   Key: D (the art of persuasive speaking)

5. [short · recall · DOK 1] Which characters on the cast list are conspirators against Caesar?

   Sample answer: Brutus, Cassius, Casca, Trebonius, Ligarius, Decius Brutus, Metellus Cimber and Cinna.

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Marcus Brutus, conspirator against Julius Caesar”, what does “conspirator” most nearly mean?

   A. being stopped before acting

   B. to declare publicly

   C. a person who joins a secret plot

   D. greedy (an itching palm wants bribes)

   Key: C (a person who joins a secret plot)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which three men become triumvirs after Caesar's death?

   A. Octavius, Brutus and Antony

   B. Antony, Cicero and Lepidus

   C. Octavius, Antony and Lepidus

   D. Brutus, Cassius and Casca

   Key: C (Octavius, Antony and Lepidus)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Marcus Brutus, _____ against Julius Caesar” Word bank: rhetoric, conspirator

   Key: conspirator

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who are the two women named in the cast list?

   A. Calpurnia and Portia

   B. Lucretia and Portia

   C. Calpurnia and Cleopatra

   D. Portia and Octavia

   Key: A (Calpurnia and Portia)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Marcus Brutus” (Dramatis Personae)

    A. Caesar's hubris just before his death.

    B. Decius's flattery.

    C. Caesar's courage or pride.

    D. Listed among the conspirators; he has more lines than anyone.

    Key: D (Listed among the conspirators; he has more lines than anyone.)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Julius Caesar” (Dramatis Personae)

    A. Antony on Lepidus.

    B. Antony's taunt about rhetoric.

    C. Antony's opening.

    D. The title character, who will die halfway through.

    Key: D (The title character, who will die halfway through.)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Julius Caesar” (Dramatis Personae) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The title character, who will die halfway through.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Marcus Brutus” (Dramatis Personae) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Listed among the conspirators; he has more lines than anyone.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Dramatis Personae”? The cast is divided by politics: Caesar; the triumvirs after his death (Antony, Octavius, Lepidus); the conspirators; senators; tribunes; the citizens. Students should see the factions before they see the people.

    A. Structure

    B. Setting

    C. Personification

    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Julius Caesar” (Dramatis Personae).

    Sample answer: Caesar, Antony and Octavius head one list, and Brutus, Cassius and the other conspirators another, so the play begins as a map of loyalty and opposition.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Julius Caesar" (Dramatis Personae) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The title character, who will die halfway through.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does the final battle of the play take place?

    A. Philippi
    B. Pharsalus
    C. Rome
    D. Sardis

    Key: A (Philippi)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "Calpurnia" (Dramatis Personae)

    A. His plea.
    B. Young Cato.
    C. Her fear.
    D. One of only two women, both wives who are not heard by their husbands.

    Key: D (One of only two women, both wives who are not heard by their husbands.)

19. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Dramatis Personae"?

    A. The cast and world of the play
    B. The death of Brutus
    C. The death of Cassius
    D. Cinna the poet

    Key: A (The cast and world of the play)

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in "Calpurnia" (Dramatis Personae). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: One of only two women, both wives who are not heard by their husbands.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in "Dramatis Personae"? Caesar, the title character, dies in Act III; the cast list does not tell us that Brutus has the most lines.

    A. Structure
    B. Theme
    C. Symbolism
    D. Characterization

    Key: A (Structure)

22. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why might a play about killing a ruler have felt dangerous in London in 1599?

    Sample answer: Elizabeth was old with no named heir; succession and rebellion were live fears.

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how power and ambition develops from an earlier scene to "Dramatis Personae". Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: every group is defined by its relation to Caesar's power.

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] The play is named for Caesar, yet he appears in few scenes. Who do you predict is the true center of the play, and why?

    Sample answer: Brutus is a strong case: his choices and conscience drive the plot.

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: "The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: Caesar, Antony and Octavius head one list, and Brutus, Cassius and the other conspirators another, so the play begins as a map of loyalty and opposition.
26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Marcus Brutus" (Dramatis Personae) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Listed among the conspirators; he has more lines than anyone.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	2, 9, 7, 8, 17, 5, 1, 6, 13, 18, 19, 11, 20, 21, 14, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	4, 1, 8, 5, 2, 9, 19, 10, 22, 11, 12, 15, 21, 14, 23, 24	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	8, 1, 7, 2, 5, 12, 22, 10, 11, 19, 20, 14, 21, 15, 25, 26	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	1, 8, 9, 7, 18, 12, 10, 11, 19, 15, 14, 20, 21, 16, 25, 26	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	1, 8, 5, 13, 19, 12, 18, 14, 21, 20, 15, 25, 16, 24, 26, 23	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Freshman	1, 8, 9, 19, 13, 10, 12, 14, 21, 20, 15, 16, 25, 26, 23, 24	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	1, 8, 19, 18, 11, 13, 12, 14, 21, 15, 20, 16, 26, 23, 24, 25	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Junior	1, 8, 18, 13, 11, 12, 10, 21, 15, 14, 20, 26, 16, 24, 25, 23	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Senior	1, 8, 19, 22, 13, 11, 10, 21, 20, 15, 14, 24, 26, 16, 25, 23	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	1, 8, 18, 10, 22, 12, 13, 14, 20, 15, 21, 23, 24, 26, 16, 25	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Dramatis Personae," how does Shakespeare show the cast and world of the play? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Dramatis Personae, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the cast and world of the play? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Dramatis Personae develops the idea of the cast and world of the play. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Dramatis Personae (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the cast and world of the play. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Dramatis Personae suggests about the cast and world of the play. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses setting in Dramatis Personae to complicate the reader's understanding of the cast and world of the play. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Dramatis Personae within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the cast and world of the play responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Dramatis Personae alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the cast and world of the play follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Dramatis Personae and its treatment of the cast and world of the play. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's setting and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Dramatis Personae as evidence for a larger claim about the cast and world of the play in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Dramatis Personae as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the cast and world of the play. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *Julius Caesar*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Dramatis Personae”?

   A. Cassius works on Brutus

   B. The first charge

   C. The cast and world of the play

   D. The death of Cassius

SAT key: 1. C (The cast and world of the play)

Lesson 3: Act I, Scene I

Focus: the tribunes and the fickle crowd

Objective: Students will analyze how setting develops in “Act I, Scene I” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Commoners take a holiday to celebrate Caesar's triumph over Pompey's sons. The tribunes Flavius and Marullus scold them; a cobbler answers with puns. Marullus reminds them they once cheered Pompey, calls them ungrateful, and sends them home. The tribunes then go to strip decorations from Caesar's statues so that he will not soar 'above the view of men.'

Background: Tribunes were officials elected to protect ordinary citizens (plebeians). Caesar had defeated Pompey in civil war and then Pompey's sons in 45 BC. Celebrating a victory over fellow Romans was controversial.

Significance: The first scene introduces the crowd as changeable: it cheered Pompey and now cheers Caesar. That sets up Act III, when Brutus and then Antony each win the same crowd within minutes.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Have you seen a crowd or online audience switch sides quickly? What made it change? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to rhetoric and persuasion because....
Prompt: Have you seen a crowd or online audience switch sides quickly? What made it change?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to rhetoric and persuasion because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: disrobe — to strip (statues) of their decorations; handiwork — the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended); trophies — decorations hung in honor of a victory; cobbler — a shoe mender (also a pun on a clumsy worker); ingratitude — failure to show thanks. “disrobe”: Origin: an English formation from dis- + robe. “ingratitude”: Origin: Old French ingratitude; earlier Late Latin ingrātitūdō.
Words: disrobe: to strip (statues) of their decorations · handiwork: the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended) · trophies: decorations hung in honor of a victory · cobbler: a shoe mender (also a pun on a clumsy worker) · ingratitude: failure to show thanks

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Tribunes were officials elected to protect ordinary citizens (plebeians). Caesar had defeated Pompey in civil war and then Pompey's sons in 45 BC. Celebrating a victory over fellow Romans was controversial. The first scene introduces the crowd as changeable: it cheered Pompey and now cheers Caesar. That sets up Act III, when Brutus and then Antony each win the same crowd within minutes. Characterization: The tribunes Flavius and Marullus scold the cobbler and carpenter for celebrating Caesar, reminding them that they cheered Pompey too. Dialogue: The cobbler's puns ("a mender of bad soles") show the commoners' wit and the tribunes' contempt. Foreshadowing: The tribunes strip Caesar's statues and are "put to silence": early warning of the danger of opposing Caesar. Watch for blood: Blood turns the assassination from sacrifice into butchery; the conspirators bathe their hands in it. In this scene: "flowers in his way / That comes in triumph over Pompey's blood? / Be gone! / Run to your houses, fall upon your knees, / Pray" (Act I, Scene I, Marullus).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things" slowly and put it in my own words: Marullus scolds the commoners as blocks, stones and worse than senseless things for celebrating Caesar. Next, craft. I notice the list of insults, each harder and more lifeless. The strongest word is "senseless": it means without feeling or reason. Then, effect. What does Marullus call the crowd, and why? My answer: Marullus calls the crowd blocks, stones and worse than senseless things, because they cheer Caesar after forgetting Pompey; the scene shows how fickle the people are, a key theme later.

> *You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things* (Act I, Scene I, Marullus)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things" slowly and put it in my own words: Marullus scolds the commoners as blocks, stones and worse than senseless things for celebrating Caesar. Next, craft. I notice the list of insults, each harder and more lifeless. The strongest word is "senseless": it means without feeling or reason. Then, effect. What does Marullus call the crowd, and why? My answer: Marullus calls the crowd blocks, stones and worse than senseless things, because they cheer Caesar after forgetting Pompey; the scene shows how fickle the people are, a key theme later.

40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The feather metaphor: Caesar is a bird rising too high; they want to keep him "ordinary." Power and ambition. Ask: How does this line connect to rhetoric and persuasion? Expected: The crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit. (The tribunes' metaphor of limiting Caesar's power.)

> *These growing feathers pluck'd from Caesar's wing / Will make him fly an ordinary pitch (Act I, Scene I, Flavius)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The feather metaphor: Caesar is a bird rising too high; they want to keep him "ordinary." Power and ambition.
Ask: How does this line connect to rhetoric and persuasion?
Expected answer: The crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit. (The tribunes' metaphor of limiting Caesar's power.)

50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, dialogue (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the tribunes and the fickle crowd? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene I develops the idea of the tribunes and the fickle crowd. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. When the text says "You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things" (Act I, Scene I, Marullus), it shows this directly. Marullus reminds them they once cheered Pompey and calls them "you blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things," and the tribunes plan to pluck "growing feathers" from Caesar's wing.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, dialogue (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the tribunes and the fickle crowd? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene I develops the idea of the tribunes and the fickle crowd. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. When the text says "You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things" (Act I, Scene I, Marullus), it shows this directly. Marullus reminds them they once cheered Pompey and calls them "you blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things," and the tribunes plan to pluck "growing feathers" from Caesar's wing.

55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Have you seen a crowd or online audience switch sides quickly? What made it change? Ask: is the crowd foolish, or are the tribunes snobs? Use the cobbler's jokes.
Anchor question: Have you seen a crowd or online audience switch sides quickly? What made it change?
Facilitation: Ask: is the crowd foolish, or are the tribunes snobs? Use the cobbler's jokes.

60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the tribunes and the fickle crowd? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. ("You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things", Act I, Scene I, Marullus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the tribunes and the fickle crowd? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. ("You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things", Act I, Scene I, Marullus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the tribunes and the fickle crowd. Key takeaway: the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit.

Total: 70 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** The tribunes Flavius and Marullus scold the cobbler and carpenter for celebrating Caesar, reminding them that they cheered Pompey too.
- **Dialogue:** The cobbler's puns ("a mender of bad soles") show the commoners' wit and the tribunes' contempt.
- **Foreshadowing:** The tribunes strip Caesar's statues and are "put to silence": early warning of the danger of opposing Caesar.

Themes and how they develop

- **rhetoric and persuasion:** the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit.

Symbols and motifs

- **blood:** Blood turns the assassination from sacrifice into butchery; the conspirators bathe their hands in it. In this scene: “flowers in his way / That comes in triumph over Pompey’s blood? / Be gone! / Run to your houses, fall upon your knees, / Pray” (Act I, Scene I, Marullus).
- **Rome and the people:** The crowd's loyalty is fickle; speakers win Rome by moving the plebeians. In this scene: “Rome. A street” (Act I, Scene I).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things” (Act I, Scene I, Marullus) Marullus's contempt for the crowd.
- “a mender of bad soles” (Act I, Scene I, Second Commoner) The cobbler's pun on soles/souls.
- “These growing feathers pluck’d from Caesar’s wing / Will make him fly an ordinary pitch” (Act I, Scene I, Flavius) The tribunes' metaphor of limiting Caesar's power.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful.
Evidence: “You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things” (Act I, Scene I, Marullus)
Reasoning: Marullus reminds them they once cheered Pompey and calls them "you blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things," and the tribunes plan to pluck "growing feathers" from Caesar's wing.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
disrobe (verb)	to strip (statues) of their decorations	*Go you down that way towards the Capitol; This way will I: disrobe the images, If you do find them deck’d with ceremonies.*	“disrobe”: Origin: an English formation from dis- + robe. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/disrobe#Etymology)
handiwork (noun)	the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended)	*As proper men as ever trod upon neat’s leather have gone upon my handiwork.*	
trophies (noun)	decorations hung in honor of a victory	*It is no matter; let no images Be hung with Caesar’s trophies.*	
cobbler (noun)	a shoe mender (also a pun on a clumsy worker)	*Truly, sir, in respect of a fine workman, I am but, as you would say, a cobbler.*	
		Run to your houses, fall upon your knees, Pray to the gods to	“ingratitude”: Origin: Old French ingratitude; earlier Late Latin ingrātitūdō. (Liber et Libri

ingratitude (noun)	failure to show thanks	*intermit the plague That needs must light on this ingratitude.*	origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/ingratitude#Etymology)
naughty (adjective)	wicked; good-for-nothing	*What trade, thou knave? thou naughty knave, what trade?*	
surgeon (noun)	one who heals (here, a joke: he "heals" old shoes)	*I am, indeed, sir, a surgeon to old shoes; when they are in great danger, I recover them.*	
beseech (verb)	to beg	*Nay, I beseech you, sir, be not out with me: yet, if you be out, sir, I can mend you.*	

Discussion questions

1. Have you seen a crowd or online audience switch sides quickly? What made it change?
2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with honor and self-deception?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Marullus say the crowd once did for Pompey? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Climbed walls and towers and waited all day to see him pass.
2. Why are the commoners out in the streets? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To celebrate Caesar's triumph
3. What trade does the punning commoner follow? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Cobbler
4. Whose earlier triumphs does Marullus remind the crowd they cheered? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Pompey's
5. What do the tribunes plan to do to Caesar's statues? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Strip off their decorations
6. How do Flavius and Marullus feel about Caesar? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: They oppose his rising power
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Commoners take a holiday to celebrate Caesar's triumph over Pompey's sons. The tribunes Flavius and Marullus scold them; a cobbler answers with puns. Marullus reminds them

they once cheered Pompey, calls them ungrateful, and sends them home. The tribunes then go to strip decorations from Caesar's statues so that he will not soar 'above the view of men.'

8. Who is on stage in “Act I, Scene I”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act I, Scene I” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Go you down that way towards the Capitol; This way will I: disrobe the images, If you do find them deck’d with ceremonies.” What does “disrobe” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: disrobe: to strip (statues) of their decorations.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does Flavius's image of plucking 'feathers' from Caesar's wing suggest about how he sees Caesar? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: As a bird of prey who would fly too high and rule over others.
2. What does “Act I, Scene I” suggest about the tribunes and the fickle crowd? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The first scene introduces the crowd as changeable: it cheered Pompey and now cheers Caesar. That sets up Act III, when Brutus and then Antony each win the same crowd within minutes.
3. Find one example of setting in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the tribunes and the fickle crowd? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: “You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things” (Act I, Scene I, Marullus): Marullus's contempt for the crowd. On characterization: The tribunes Flavius and Marullus scold the cobbler and carpenter for celebrating Caesar, reminding them that they cheered Pompey too. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Truly, sir, all that I live by is with the awl: I meddle with no tradesman’s matters, nor women’s matters, but with awl.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Commoners take a holiday to celebrate Caesar's triumph over Pompey's sons. The tribunes Flavius and Marullus scold them; a cobbler answers with puns. Marullus reminds them they once cheered Pompey, calls them ungrateful, and sends them home. The tribunes then go to strip decorations from Caesar's…
7. How does “Act I, Scene I” build on “Dramatis Personae”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: “a mender of bad soles” (Act I, Scene I, Second Commoner): The cobbler's pun on soles/souls. Theme link: the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: “These growing feathers pluck’d from Caesar’s wing / Will make him fly an ordinary pitch” (Act I, Scene I, Flavius): The tribunes' metaphor of limiting Caesar's power. On characterization: The tribunes Flavius and Marullus scold the cobbler and carpenter for celebrating Caesar, reminding them that they cheered Pompey too. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Have you seen a crowd or online audience switch sides quickly? What made it change?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with honor and self-deception? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: “You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things” (Act I, Scene I, Marullus): Marullus's contempt for the crowd. Theme link: the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Are the tribunes defending the people or insulting them? Use their words to argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Both: they guard the republic but call the people blocks and stones.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: “a mender of bad soles” (Act I, Scene I, Second Commoner): The cobbler's pun on soles/souls. Theme link: the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The first scene introduces the crowd as changeable: it cheered Pompey and now cheers Caesar. That sets up Act III, when Brutus and then Antony each win the same crowd within minutes.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: “These growing feathers

pluck'd from Caesar's wing / Will make him fly an ordinary pitch" (Act I, Scene I, Flavius): The tribunes' metaphor of limiting Caesar's power. Theme link: the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: "You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things" (Act I, Scene I, Marullus): Marullus's contempt for the crowd. On characterization: The tribunes Flavius and Marullus scold the cobbler and carpenter for celebrating Caesar, reminding them that they cheered Pompey too. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing "Act I, Scene I". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the tribunes and the fickle crowd. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: "a mender of bad soles" (Act I, Scene I, Second Commoner): The cobbler's pun on soles/souls. Theme link: the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about "Act I, Scene I": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: "These growing feathers pluck'd from Caesar's wing / Will make him fly an ordinary pitch" (Act I, Scene I, Flavius): The tribunes' metaphor of limiting Caesar's power. Theme link: the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to rhetoric and persuasion: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: "You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things" (Act I, Scene I, Marullus): Marullus's contempt for the crowd. Theme link: the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: "a mender of bad soles" (Act I,

Scene I, Second Commoner): The cobbler's pun on soles/souls. Theme link: the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Act I, Scene I" treats the tribunes and the fickle crowd with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: "These growing feathers pluck'd from Caesar's wing / Will make him fly an ordinary pitch" (Act I, Scene I, Flavius): The tribunes' metaphor of limiting Caesar's power. Theme link: the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what "Act I, Scene II" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: "You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things" (Act I, Scene I, Marullus): Marullus's contempt for the crowd. On foreshadowing: The tribunes strip Caesar's statues and are "put to silence": early warning of the danger of opposing Caesar. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the tribunes and the fickle crowd? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: "a mender of bad soles" (Act I, Scene I, Second Commoner): The cobbler's pun on soles/souls. Theme link: the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Nay, I _____ you, sir, be not out with me: yet, if you be out, sir, I can mend you." Word bank: disrobe, beseech, handiwork, trophies
   Key: beseech
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How do Flavius and Marullus feel about Caesar?
   A. They oppose his rising power

B. They do not care

C. They love him

D. They fear the crowd more than him

Key: A (They oppose his rising power)

3. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does Marullus say the crowd once did for Pompey?
   Sample answer: Climbed walls and towers and waited all day to see him pass.
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Run to your houses, fall upon your knees, Pray to the gods to intermit the plague That needs must light on this _____." Word bank: handiwork, ingratitude, trophies, disrobe
   Key: ingratitude
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Truly, sir, in respect of a fine workman, I am but, as you would say, a cobbler.", what does "cobbler" most nearly mean?

   A. winners in battle

   B. a slave

   C. a shoe mender (also a pun on a clumsy worker)

   D. clothing; here, Caesar's cloak

   Key: C (a shoe mender (also a pun on a clumsy worker))
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What do the tribunes plan to do to Caesar's statues?

   A. Strip off their decorations

   B. Paint them

   C. Pull them down

   D. Guard them

   Key: A (Strip off their decorations)
7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "What trade, thou knave? thou _____ knave, what trade?" Word bank: handiwork, naughty, trophies, disrobe
   Key: naughty
8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene I, Flavius: "These growing _____ pluck'd from Caesar's wing / Will make him fly an ordinary pitch"
   Key: feathers
9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "I am, indeed, sir, a _____ to old shoes; when they are in great danger, I recover them." Word bank: surgeon, trophies, disrobe, handiwork
   Key: surgeon
10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "a mender of bad soles" (Act I, Scene I, Second Commoner) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The cobbler's pun on soles/souls.
11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene I"?

    A. Cinna the poet

    B. The tribunes and the fickle crowd

    C. The death of Brutus

    D. Artemidorus's letter

Key: B (The tribunes and the fickle crowd)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “a mender of bad soles” (Act I, Scene I, Second Commoner)

    A. Young Cato.

    B. Her self-criticism.

    C. Brutus's restraint.

    D. The cobbler's pun on soles/souls.

    Key: D (The cobbler's pun on soles/souls.)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things” (Act I, Scene I, Marullus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Marullus's contempt for the crowd.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene I”? The tribunes Flavius and Marullus scold the cobbler and carpenter for celebrating Caesar, reminding them that they cheered Pompey too.

    A. Theme

    B. Characterization

    C. Plot

    D. Irony

    Key: B (Characterization)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things” (Act I, Scene I, Marullus).

    Sample answer: Marullus reminds them they once cheered Pompey and calls them "you blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things," and the tribunes plan to pluck "growing feathers" from Caesar's wing.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things” (Act I, Scene I, Marullus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Marullus's contempt for the crowd.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “As proper men as ever trod upon neat’s leather have gone upon my handiwork.”, what does “handiwork” most nearly mean?

    A. avenged

    B. payments to free captives

    C. the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended)

    D. an unmarried man

    Key: C (the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended))

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene I, Marullus: “You blocks, you stones, you worse than _____ things”

    Key: senseless

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “It is no matter; let no images Be hung with Caesar’s trophies.”, what does “trophies” most nearly mean?

    A. a boy at school

    B. holds back

C. courage; appetite for battle

D. decorations hung in honor of a victory

Key: D (decorations hung in honor of a victory)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why are the commoners out in the streets?

A. To celebrate Caesar's triumph

B. To see a play

C. To protest taxes

D. To elect tribunes

Key: A (To celebrate Caesar's triumph)

21. [short · inference · DOK 2] What does Flavius's image of plucking 'feathers' from Caesar's wing suggest about how he sees Caesar?

Sample answer: As a bird of prey who would fly too high and rule over others.

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things” (Act I, Scene I, Marullus)

A. Urgency.

B. Cassius's willingness to die.

C. Marullus's contempt for the crowd.

D. Reducing the will.

Key: C (Marullus's contempt for the crowd.)

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “These growing feathers pluck’d from Caesar’s wing / Will make him fly an ordinary pitch” (Act I, Scene I, Flavius). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: The tribunes' metaphor of limiting Caesar's power.

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene I”? The cobbler's puns ("a mender of bad soles") show the commoners' wit and the tribunes' contempt.

A. Dialogue

B. Characterization

C. Simile

D. Point of view

Key: A (Dialogue)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “a mender of bad soles” (Act I, Scene I, Second Commoner) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The cobbler's pun on soles/souls.

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What trade does the punning commoner follow?

A. Butcher

B. Cobbler

C. Carpenter

D. Baker

Key: B (Cobbler)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit.

    A. Honor and self-deception

    B. Power, ambition and tyranny

    C. Public versus private self

    D. Rhetoric and persuasion

    Key: D (Rhetoric and persuasion)

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Are the tribunes defending the people or insulting them? Use their words to argue.

    Sample answer: Both: they guard the republic but call the people blocks and stones.

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whose earlier triumphs does Marullus remind the crowd they cheered?

    A. Antony's

    B. Cicero's

    C. Brutus's

    D. Pompey's

    Key: D (Pompey's)

30. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “These growing feathers pluck’d from Caesar’s wing / Will make him fly an ordinary pitch” (Act I, Scene I, Flavius)

    A. Brutus's balanced antithesis.

    B. Antony's prophecy of civil war.

    C. The tribunes' metaphor of limiting Caesar's power.

    D. Cicero on interpreting omens.

    Key: C (The tribunes' metaphor of limiting Caesar's power.)

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how rhetoric and persuasion develops from an earlier scene to “Act I, Scene I”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit.

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: Marullus reminds them they once cheered Pompey and calls them "you blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things," and the tribunes plan to pluck "growing feathers" from Caesar's wing.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 4, 19, 1, 20, 8, 9, 12, 21, 10, 22, 23, 24, 15, 25	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	2, 1, 6, 18, 26, 8, 22, 21, 10, 11, 13, 24, 23, 27, 28, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	4, 3, 8, 29, 5, 13, 12, 10, 30, 21, 23, 14, 27, 24, 31, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	18, 17, 7, 3, 13, 11, 10, 30, 22, 14, 23, 24, 27, 16, 28, 25	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	4, 7, 6, 22, 30, 21, 10, 23, 27, 24, 14, 15, 28, 32, 31, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	4, 29, 9, 30, 21, 10, 11, 24, 27, 14, 23, 15, 32, 25, 28, 31	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4

College Sophomore	4, 7, 10, 11, 22, 30, 14, 24, 15, 27, 23, 25, 16, 31, 28, 32	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	4, 7, 13, 11, 10, 30, 27, 23, 24, 14, 15, 25, 31, 32, 16, 28	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	7, 4, 30, 21, 12, 11, 23, 24, 27, 15, 14, 32, 28, 31, 16, 25	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	7, 4, 12, 13, 22, 21, 15, 27, 24, 23, 14, 31, 25, 16, 32, 28	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act I, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show the tribunes and the fickle crowd? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act I, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the tribunes and the fickle crowd? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene I develops the idea of the tribunes and the fickle crowd. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the tribunes and the fickle crowd. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene I suggests about the tribunes and the fickle crowd. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses setting in Act I, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of the tribunes and the fickle crowd. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act I, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the tribunes and the fickle crowd responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act I, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the tribunes and the fickle crowd follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene I and its treatment of the tribunes and the fickle crowd. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's setting and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about the tribunes and the fickle crowd in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the tribunes and the fickle crowd. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *It is no matter; let no images Be hung with Caesar's trophies.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "trophies" most nearly mean?

   A. one who heals (here, a joke: he "heals" old shoes)

   B. decorations hung in honor of a victory

   C. wicked; good-for-nothing

   D. to beg

2. *Truly, sir, all that I live by is with the awl: I meddle with no tradesman's matters, nor women's matters, but with awl. I am, indeed, sir, a surgeon to old shoes; when they are in great danger, I recover them. As proper men as ever trod upon neat's leather have gone upon my handiwork.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene I"?

   A. The funeral orations

   B. The tribunes and the fickle crowd

   C. Artemidorus's letter

   D. Cassius works on Brutus

SAT key: 1. B (decorations hung in honor of a victory); 2. B (The tribunes and the fickle crowd)

Lesson 4: Act I, Scene II

Focus: Cassius works on Brutus

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in "Act I, Scene II" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…ches in their books, Alas, it cried "Give me some drink, Titinius," As a sick girl. Ye gods, it…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Suggested language: "What does this detail add to the scene?"

Teacher only · spoilers

At the feast of Lupercal a soothsayer warns Caesar to beware the ides of March; Caesar dismisses him. Cassius probes Brutus, who admits he fears the people will choose Caesar for king. Cassius tells how he saved Caesar from drowning and saw him sick with fever, and argues 'the fault... is not in our stars, but in ourselves.' Caesar tells Antony he distrusts Cassius's 'lean and hungry look.' Casca reports that Caesar refused a crown offered three times by Antony and then fell in a fit. Alone, Cassius plans to throw forged letters in Brutus's window.

Background: The Lupercalia was a February fertility festival. The 'ides' of March was 15 March. Caesar was made dictator for life in early 44 BC, which alarmed defenders of the republic.

Significance: This long scene shows Cassius's method of persuasion (flattery, comparison, personal grievance) and Brutus's weak point: his public honor. Caesar's private weaknesses (deafness in one ear, fits) contrast with his public godlike pose.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
When someone flatters you to win you over, how can you tell? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to power and ambition because.... Content note before we start: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Prompt: When someone flatters you to win you over, how can you tell?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to power and ambition because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: bestride — to stand over with legs wide apart; coronets — small crowns; underlings — inferiors; people of low rank; cogitations — thoughts; encompass — to enclose; to contain. “coronets”: Origin of “coronet”: Middle French couronnette; earlier Old French coronete. “underlings”: Origin of “underling”: Old English underling.
Words: bestride: to stand over with legs wide apart · coronets: small crowns · underlings: inferiors; people of low rank · cogitations: thoughts · encompass: to enclose; to contain

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The Lupercalia was a February fertility festival. The 'ides' of March was 15 March. Caesar was made dictator for life in early 44 BC, which alarmed defenders of the republic. This long scene shows Cassius's method of persuasion (flattery, comparison, personal grievance) and Brutus's weak point: his public honor. Caesar's private weaknesses (deafness in one ear, fits) contrast with his public godlike pose. Characterization: Cassius works on Brutus through flattery, envy and appeals to Roman honour; Brutus admits he fears "the people / Choose Caesar for their king." Caesar, observed close up, is deaf in one ear and suspicious of "lean and hungry" Cassius. Dramatic irony: Offstage shouts (Caesar refusing the crown three times) punctuate the persuasion; Casca's mocking report undercuts Caesar's show of modesty. Rhetoric: Cassius uses anecdote (Caesar drowning in the Tiber, shaking with fever) to make Caesar seem merely human. Watch for warnings ignored: Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: “Beware the ides of March” (Act I, Scene II, Soothsayer).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read “The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings” slowly and put it in my own words: Cassius tells Brutus that if they are underlings to Caesar, the fault is in themselves, not in their stars. Next, craft. I notice the contrast between "our stars," meaning fate, and "ourselves," meaning choice, set across a line break for emphasis. The strongest word is “underlings”: it is a contemptuous word for inferiors, chosen to sting Brutus's pride as a Roman noble. Then, effect. How does Cassius use this line to work on Brutus? My answer: Cassius flatters Brutus's sense of honor and freedom to push him toward conspiracy; the line shows his skill as a manipulator and raises the play's question of whether men or fate decide events.

> *The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings* (Act I, Scene II, Cassius)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read “The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings” slowly and put it in my own words: Cassius tells Brutus that if they are underlings to Caesar, the fault is in themselves, not in their stars. Next, craft. I notice the contrast between "our stars," meaning fate, and "ourselves," meaning choice, set across a line break for emphasis. The strongest word is “underlings”: it is a contemptuous word for inferiors, chosen to sting Brutus's pride as a Roman noble. Then, effect. How does Cassius use this line to work on Brutus? My answer: Cassius flatters Brutus's sense of honor and freedom to push him toward conspiracy; the line shows his skill as a manipulator and raises the play's question of whether men or fate decide events.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The Colossus was a giant statue at Rhodes; the image makes Romans small beneath Caesar. Expected link: power and ambition, and Cassius's rhetoric. Ask: How does this line connect to power and ambition? Expected: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. (Caesar reads Cassius accurately.)

> *Yond Cassius has a lean and hungry look; / He thinks too much: such men are dangerous* (Act I, Scene II, Caesar)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The Colossus was a giant statue at Rhodes; the image makes Romans small beneath Caesar. Expected link: power and ambition, and Cassius's rhetoric.
Ask: How does this line connect to power and ambition?
Expected answer: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. (Caesar reads Cassius accurately.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Cassius works on Brutus? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene II develops the idea of Cassius works on Brutus. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. When the text says "The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings" (Act I, Scene II, Cassius), it shows this directly. He says Caesar "doth bestride the narrow world / Like a Colossus" while others are "underlings," and insists "the fault … is not in our stars, / But in ourselves," urging Brutus to act.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Cassius works on Brutus? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene II develops the idea of Cassius works on Brutus. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. When the text says "The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings" (Act I, Scene II, Cassius), it shows this directly. He says Caesar "doth bestride the narrow world / Like a Colossus" while others are "underlings," and insists "the fault … is not in our stars, / But in ourselves," urging Brutus to act.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: When someone flatters you to win you over, how can you tell? Ask students to list Cassius's persuasive moves. Which would work on them?
Anchor question: When someone flatters you to win you over, how can you tell?
Facilitation: Ask students to list Cassius's persuasive moves. Which would work on them?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Cassius works on Brutus? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. ("The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings", Act I, Scene II, Cassius). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Cassius works on Brutus? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. ("The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings", Act I, Scene II, Cassius). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Cassius works on Brutus. Key takeaway: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Cassius works on Brutus through flattery, envy and appeals to Roman honour; Brutus admits he fears "the people / Choose Caesar for their king." Caesar, observed close up, is deaf in one ear and suspicious of "lean and hungry" Cassius.
- **Dramatic irony:** Offstage shouts (Caesar refusing the crown three times) punctuate the persuasion; Casca's mocking report undercuts Caesar's show of modesty.
- **Rhetoric:** Cassius uses anecdote (Caesar drowning in the Tiber, shaking with fever) to make Caesar seem merely human.

Themes and how they develop

- **power and ambition:** Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection.

Symbols and motifs

- **warnings ignored:** Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: “Beware the ides of March” (Act I, Scene II, Soothsayer).
- **omens and portents:** Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: “Cassius, and Casca; a great crowd following, among them a Soothsayer” (Act I, Scene II).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius) Cassius's argument for action.
- “Yond Cassius has a lean and hungry look; / He thinks too much: such men are dangerous” (Act I, Scene II, Caesar) Caesar reads Cassius accurately.
- “Why, man, he doth bestride the narrow world / Like a Colossus” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius) Cassius's image of Caesar's size and his own smallness.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power.
Evidence: “The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius)
Reasoning: He says Caesar "doth bestride the narrow world / Like a Colossus" while others are "underlings," and insists "the fault ... is not in our stars, / But in ourselves," urging Brutus to act.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
bestride (verb)	to stand over with legs wide apart	*Why, man, he doth bestride the narrow world Like a Colossus, and we petty men Walk under his huge legs and peep about To find ourselves dishonourable graves.*	
coronets (noun)	small crowns	*I saw Mark Antony offer him a crown; —yet 'twas not a crown neither, 'twas one of these coronets;—and, as I told you, he put it by once: but, for all that, to my thinking, he would fain have had it.*	“coronets”: Origin of “coronet”: Middle French couronnette; earlier Old French coronete. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/coronet#Etymology)
underlings (noun)	inferiors; people of low rank	*Men at some time are masters of their fates: The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, But in ourselves, that we are underlings.*	“underlings”: Origin of “underling”: Old English underling. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/underling#Etymology)
cogitations (noun)	thoughts	*Then, Brutus, I have much mistook your passion; By means whereof this breast of*	

		mine hath buried Thoughts of great value, worthy cogitations.	
encompass (verb)	to enclose; to contain	*When could they say till now, that talk'd of Rome, That her wide walls encompass'd but one man?*	
foolery (noun)	foolish behavior; nonsense	*I can as well be hanged as tell the manner of it: it was mere foolery; I did not mark it.*	
wenches (noun)	young women (informal, period term)	*Three or four wenches, where I stood, cried "Alas, good soul!" and forgave him with all their hearts: but there's no heed to be taken of them: if Caesar had stabbed their mothers, they would have done no less.*	
enterprise (noun)	a bold undertaking	*So is he now in execution Of any bold or noble enterprise, However he puts on this tardy form.*	"enterprise": Origin: Middle French entreprise. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/enterprise#Etymology)
chanced (verb)	happened	*Ay, Casca; tell us what hath chanced to-day, That Caesar looks so sad.*	
ceremony (noun)	formal politeness	*Set on; and leave no ceremony out.*	"ceremony": Origin: Latin caerimonia. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/ceremony#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. When someone flatters you to win you over, how can you tell?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with rhetoric and persuasion?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Brutus admit he fears when he hears the crowd shout? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: That the people choose Caesar for their king.

2. What does the soothsayer warn Caesar to beware? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The ides of March
3. From what danger does Cassius say he once saved Caesar? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Drowning in the Tiber
4. How many times does Antony offer Caesar the crown, according to Casca? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Three
5. What does Caesar say about Cassius's appearance? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He has a lean and hungry look
6. What does Cassius plan to put in Brutus's window? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Letters in several hands
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: At the feast of Lupercal a soothsayer warns Caesar to beware the ides of March; Caesar dismisses him. Cassius probes Brutus, who admits he fears the people will choose Caesar for king. Cassius tells how he saved Caesar from drowning and saw him sick with fever, and argues 'the fault... is not in our stars, but in ourselves.' Caesar tells Antony he distrusts Cassius's 'lean and hungry look.' Casca…
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene II", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act I, Scene II" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Why, man, he doth bestride the narrow world Like a Colossus, and we petty men Walk under his huge legs and peep about To find ourselves dishonourable graves." What does "bestride" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: bestride: to stand over with legs wide apart.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Cassius tell stories of Caesar's physical weakness? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: To show Caesar is only a man, no greater than Brutus or Cassius.
2. What does "Act I, Scene II" suggest about Cassius works on Brutus? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: This long scene shows Cassius's method of persuasion (flattery, comparison, personal grievance) and Brutus's weak point: his public honor. Caesar's private weaknesses (deafness in one ear, fits) contrast with his public godlike pose.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the conflict in this scene shape what we understand about Cassius works on Brutus? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: "The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings" (Act I, Scene II, Cassius): Cassius's argument for action. Theme link:

Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Marry, before he fell down, when he perceived the common herd was glad he refused the crown, he plucked me ope his doublet and offered them his throat to cut.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: At the feast of Lupercal a soothsayer warns Caesar to beware the ides of March; Caesar dismisses him. Cassius probes Brutus, who admits he fears the people will choose Caesar for king. Cassius tells how he saved Caesar from drowning and saw him sick with fever, and argues 'the fault... is not in…
7. How does “Act I, Scene II” build on “Act I, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: “Yond Cassius has a lean and hungry look; / He thinks too much: such men are dangerous” (Act I, Scene II, Caesar): Caesar reads Cassius accurately. Theme link: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: “Why, man, he doth bestride the narrow world / Like a Colossus” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius): Cassius's image of Caesar's size and his own smallness. On characterization: Cassius works on Brutus through flattery, envy and appeals to Roman honour; Brutus admits he fears "the people / Choose Caesar for their king." Caesar, observed close up, is deaf in one ear and suspicious of "lean and hungry" Cassius. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “When someone flatters you to win you over, how can you tell?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with rhetoric and persuasion? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: “The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius): Cassius's argument for action. Theme link: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. 'The fault... is not in our stars, but in ourselves.' Does the play prove Cassius right or wrong? Revisit this at the end. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Debatable: omens come true, yet

characters' choices cause each disaster.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: “Yond Cassius has a lean and hungry look; / He thinks too much: such men are dangerous” (Act I, Scene II, Caesar): Caesar reads Cassius accurately. Theme link: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “This long scene shows Cassius's method of persuasion (flattery, comparison, personal grievance) and Brutus's weak point: his public honor. Caesar's private weaknesses (deafness in one ear, fits) contrast with his public godlike pose.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: “Why, man, he doth bestride the narrow world / Like a Colossus” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius): Cassius's image of Caesar's size and his own smallness. Theme link: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: “The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius): Cassius's argument for action. On characterization: Cassius works on Brutus through flattery, envy and appeals to Roman honour; Brutus admits he fears "the people / Choose Caesar for their king." Caesar, observed close up, is deaf in one ear and suspicious of "lean and hungry" Cassius. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act I, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Cassius works on Brutus. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: “Yond Cassius has a lean and hungry look; / He thinks too much: such men are dangerous” (Act I, Scene II, Caesar): Caesar reads Cassius accurately. Theme link: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: “Why, man, he doth bestride the narrow world / Like a Colossus” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius): Cassius's image of Caesar's size and his own smallness. Theme link: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to public versus private self: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: “The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius): Cassius's argument for action. Theme link: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: “Yond Cassius has a lean and hungry look; / He thinks too much: such men are dangerous” (Act I, Scene II, Caesar): Caesar reads Cassius accurately. On characterization: Cassius works on Brutus through flattery, envy and appeals to Roman honour; Brutus admits he fears "the people / Choose Caesar for their king." Caesar, observed close up, is deaf in one ear and suspicious of "lean and hungry" Cassius. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act I, Scene II” treats Cassius works on Brutus with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: “Why, man, he doth bestride the narrow world / Like a Colossus” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius): Cassius's image of Caesar's size and his own smallness. Theme link: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act I, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: “The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius): Cassius's argument for action. Theme link: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Cassius works on Brutus? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: “Yond Cassius has a lean and hungry look; / He thinks too much: such men are dangerous” (Act I, Scene II, Caesar): Caesar reads Cassius accurately. Theme link: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] From what danger does Cassius say he once saved Caesar?

   A. A fire

   B. Drowning in the Tiber

   C. An assassin

   D. A wild boar

   Key: B (Drowning in the Tiber)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the soothsayer warn Caesar to beware?

   A. The Capitol

   B. The ides of March

   C. Cassius

   D. The Lupercal

   Key: B (The ides of March)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Why, man, he doth bestride the narrow world Like a Colossus, and we petty men Walk under his huge legs and peep about To find ourselves dishonourable graves.", what does "bestride" most nearly mean?

   A. to strip (statues) of their decorations

   B. members of the Roman Senate

   C. to stand over with legs wide apart

   D. platforms for public speaking

   Key: C (to stand over with legs wide apart)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Three or four _____, where I stood, cried "Alas, good soul!" and forgave him with all their hearts: but there's no heed to be taken of them: if Caesar had stabbed their mothers, they would have done no less." Word bank: underlings, wenches, bestride, coronets

   Key: wenches

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "When could they say till now, that talk'd of Rome, That her wide walls _____'d but one man?" Word bank: bestride, coronets, encompass, underlings

   Key: encompass

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "So is he now in execution Of any bold or noble _____, However he puts on this tardy form." Word bank: coronets, bestride, underlings, enterprise

   Key: enterprise

7. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does Brutus admit he fears when he hears the crowd shout?

   Sample answer: That the people choose Caesar for their king.

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene II, Cassius: “Why, man, he doth _____ the narrow world / Like a Colossus”

   Key: bestride

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Caesar say about Cassius's appearance?

   A. He looks too cheerful

   B. He looks ill

   C. He looks like a king

   D. He has a lean and hungry look

   Key: D (He has a lean and hungry look)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius)

    A. Brutus's last words.

    B. Cassius's argument for action.

    C. Urgency.

    D. His plea.

    Key: B (Cassius's argument for action.)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Why, man, he doth bestride the narrow world / Like a Colossus” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius)

    A. Urgency.

    B. Brutus's argument for attacking.

    C. Cassius's image of Caesar's size and his own smallness.

    D. The title character, who will die halfway through.

    Key: C (Cassius's image of Caesar's size and his own smallness.)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Cassius tell stories of Caesar's physical weakness?

    Sample answer: To show Caesar is only a man, no greater than Brutus or Cassius.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Cassius's argument for action.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Why, man, he doth bestride the narrow world / Like a Colossus” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Cassius's image of Caesar's size and his own smallness.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene II”? Cassius works on Brutus through flattery, envy and appeals to Roman honour; Brutus admits he fears "the people / Choose Caesar for their king." Caesar, observed close up, is deaf in one ear and suspicious of "lean and hungry" Cassius.

    A. Simile

    B. Theme

    C. Imagery

    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: He says Caesar "doth bestride the narrow world / Like a Colossus" while others are "underlings," and insists "the fault ... is not in our stars, / But in ourselves," urging Brutus to act.
17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene II, Cassius: “The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are _____”
    Key: underlings
18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Cassius plan to put in Brutus's window?
    A. A crown
    B. Letters in several hands
    C. A warning from Calpurnia
    D. A dagger
    Key: B (Letters in several hands)
19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I can as well be hanged as tell the manner of it: it was mere _____; I did not mark it.” Word bank: foolery, underlings, coronets, bestride
    Key: foolery
20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Men at some time are masters of their fates: The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, But in ourselves, that we are underlings.”, what does “underlings” most nearly mean?
    A. inferiors; people of low rank
    B. courageously
    C. explained; interpreted
    D. to supply sparingly (here, to cut short with a little sleep)
    Key: A (inferiors; people of low rank)
21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act I, Scene II”?
    A. The funeral orations
    B. Storm, omens and recruitment
    C. Young Cato and Lucilius
    D. Cassius works on Brutus
    Key: D (Cassius works on Brutus)
22. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Yond Cassius has a lean and hungry look; / He thinks too much: such men are dangerous” (Act I, Scene II, Caesar) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Caesar reads Cassius accurately.
23. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius).
    Sample answer: He says Caesar "doth bestride the narrow world / Like a Colossus" while others are "underlings," and insists "the fault ... is not in our stars, / But in ourselves," urging Brutus to act.
24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius) shape its meaning? Consider

a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Cassius's argument for action.

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I saw Mark Antony offer him a crown;—yet ’twas not a crown neither, ’twas one of these coronets;—and, as I told you, he put it by once: but, for all that, to my thinking, he would fain have had it.”, what does “coronets” most nearly mean?

    A. small crowns

    B. polite behavior

    C. without sound; silent

    D. avenged

    Key: A (small crowns)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene II”? Offstage shouts (Caesar refusing the crown three times) punctuate the persuasion; Casca's mocking report undercuts Caesar's show of modesty.

    A. Dramatic irony

    B. Diction / vocabulary

    C. Irony

    D. Conflict

    Key: A (Dramatic irony)

27. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene II, Caesar: “Yond Cassius has a lean and hungry look; / He thinks too much: such men are _____”

    Key: dangerous

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Then, Brutus, I have much mistook your passion; By means whereof this breast of mine hath buried Thoughts of great value, worthy cogitations.”, what does “cogitations” most nearly mean?

    A. food for horses

    B. irritable; childish

    C. like a beast; without reason

    D. thoughts

    Key: D (thoughts)

29. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Yond Cassius has a lean and hungry look; / He thinks too much: such men are dangerous” (Act I, Scene II, Caesar)

    A. Antony's taunt about rhetoric.

    B. Caesar reads Cassius accurately.

    C. His last words in the play (see the intro flag on their history).

    D. Brutus's last words.

    Key: B (Caesar reads Cassius accurately.)

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Yond Cassius has a lean and hungry look; / He thinks too much: such men are dangerous” (Act I, Scene II, Caesar) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Caesar reads Cassius accurately.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how power and ambition develops from an earlier scene to “Act I, Scene II”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection.
32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] 'The fault... is not in our stars, but in ourselves.' Does the play prove Cassius right or wrong? Revisit this at the end.
    Sample answer: Debatable: omens come true, yet characters' choices cause each disaster.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	5, 3, 17, 9, 18, 19, 20, 6, 21, 22, 12, 11, 23, 14, 15, 24	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	5, 3, 25, 2, 4, 17, 10, 12, 22, 21, 13, 26, 14, 15, 24, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	5, 27, 2, 28, 9, 10, 13, 21, 29, 12, 23, 15, 26, 14, 16, 30	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	18, 28, 27, 8, 10, 13, 21, 29, 22, 14, 15, 26, 23, 24, 16, 30	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	3, 17, 5, 11, 22, 29, 21, 23, 14, 26, 15, 16, 24, 30, 31, 32	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Freshman	17, 5, 3, 13, 21, 12, 29, 23, 26, 15, 14, 24, 30, 31, 32, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	5, 8, 29, 13, 11, 21, 10, 14, 15, 23, 26, 24, 31, 16, 32, 30	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Junior	5, 19, 11, 29, 21, 13, 22, 15, 23, 14, 26, 31, 16, 32, 24, 30	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Senior	27, 5, 11, 21, 13, 22, 12, 26, 14, 15, 23, 31, 24, 16, 32, 30	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	5, 19, 13, 10, 11, 12, 29, 14, 15, 23, 26, 24, 30, 31, 32, 16	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act I, Scene II,” how does Shakespeare show Cassius works on Brutus? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act I, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Cassius works on Brutus? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene II develops the idea of Cassius works on Brutus. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence,

and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Cassius works on Brutus. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene II suggests about Cassius works on Brutus. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act I, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of Cassius works on Brutus. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act I, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Cassius works on Brutus responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act I, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Cassius works on Brutus follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene II and its treatment of Cassius works on Brutus. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and conflict, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about Cassius works on Brutus in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Cassius works on Brutus. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *Men at some time are masters of their fates: The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, But in ourselves, that we are underlings.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "underlings" most nearly mean?

   A. inferiors; people of low rank
   B. happened
   C. formal politeness
   D. a bold undertaking

2. *Marry, before he fell down, when he perceived the common herd was glad he refused the crown, he plucked me ope his doublet and offered them his throat to cut. An I had been a man of any occupation, if I would not have taken him at a word, I would I might go to hell among the rogues. And so he fell. When he came to himself again, he said, If he had done or said anything amiss, he desired their worships to think it was his infirmity. Three or four wenches, where I stood, cried "Alas, good soul!" and forgave him with all their hearts: but there's no heed to be taken of them: if Caesar had stabbed their mothers, they would have done no less.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene II"?

   A. Young Cato and Lucilius
   B. Artemidorus's letter
   C. Cinna the poet
   D. Cassius works on Brutus

SAT key: 1. A (inferiors; people of low rank); 2. D (Cassius works on Brutus)

Lesson 5: Act I, Scene III

Focus: storm, omens and recruitment

Objective: Students will analyze how setting develops in "Act I, Scene III" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

On a night of thunder and strange sights (a slave's burning hand that does not burn, a lion near the Capitol, men on fire walking the streets, an owl hooting at noon), Casca meets Cicero and then Cassius. Cassius reads the omens as warnings against Caesar's tyranny and wins Casca to the plot. Cinna joins them; Cassius sends him to place forged letters where Brutus will find them, and they agree that Brutus's good name will make their deed look like virtue.

Background: Romans read storms and unusual events (prodigies) as messages from the gods. Plutarch records omens before Caesar's death. Cicero, a famous orator, was not part of the plot.

Significance: The same omens are read in opposite ways: Casca is terrified, Cassius turns them into an argument. The scene shows that interpretation is itself a tool of persuasion.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Do people tend to read signs and news in the way that fits what they already believe? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and omens because....*
> **Prompt:** Do people tend to read signs and news in the way that fits what they already believe?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to fate and omens because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: each character reads the omens to suit himself.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: bondman — a slave; construe — to interpret; to explain; alchemy — the supposed art of turning base metal to gold; shrieking — crying out with a high scream; conceited — understood; judged (well conceited: rightly grasped). "bondman": Origin: an English formation from bond + -man.*
> **Words:** bondman: a slave · construe: to interpret; to explain · alchemy: the supposed art of turning base metal to gold · shrieking: crying out with a high scream · conceited: understood; judged (well conceited: rightly grasped)

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Romans read storms and unusual events (prodigies) as messages from the gods. Plutarch records omens before Caesar's death. Cicero, a famous orator, was not part of the plot. The same omens are read in opposite ways: Casca is terrified, Cassius turns them into an argument. The scene shows that interpretation is itself a tool of persuasion. Setting: A violent storm with omens (a lion in the Capitol, men on fire, a bird of night at noon). Characterization: Casca is terrified; Cassius bares his chest to the lightning and interprets the omens as warnings against Caesar. Plot: Cassius plans to throw forged letters in Brutus's window. Watch for warnings ignored: Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: "Be you content: good Cinna, take this paper, / And look you lay it in the praetor's chair, / Where Brutus" (Act I, Scene III, Cassius).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves" slowly and put it in my own words: Cicero tells Casca that men may interpret things in their own way, far from what the things really mean. Next, craft. I notice his calm, skeptical tone in the middle of a terrifying storm, a voice of reason among fearful men. The strongest word is "construe": it means interpret, and it raises the question of who reads signs correctly. Then, effect. What does Cicero warn about the omens of the storm? My answer: Cicero warns that people bend signs to fit their wishes; the play is full of misread omens, and the conspirators will read the storm as a sign against Caesar because they want to.

> *men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves (Act I, Scene III, Cicero)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves" slowly and put it in my own words: Cicero tells Casca that men may interpret things in their own way, far from what the things really mean. Next, craft. I notice his calm, skeptical tone in the middle of a terrifying storm, a voice of reason among fearful men. The strongest word is "construe": it means interpret, and it raises the question of who reads signs correctly. Then, effect. What does Cicero warn about the omens of the storm? My answer: Cicero warns that people bend signs to fit their wishes; the play is full of misread omens, and the conspirators will read the storm as a sign against Caesar because they want to.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Cicero's line is a warning about bias; Cassius proves it. Expected link: fate and omens. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and omens? Expected: Each character reads the omens to suit himself. (Cassius's willingness to die.)

> *Cassius from bondage will deliver Cassius (Act I, Scene III, Cassius)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Cicero's line is a warning about bias; Cassius proves it. Expected link: fate and omens.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and omens?
Expected answer: Each character reads the omens to suit himself. (Cassius's willingness to die.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for setting, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about storm, omens and recruitment? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene III develops the idea of storm, omens and recruitment. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. When the text says "men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves" (Act I, Scene III, Cicero), it shows this directly. Cicero warns that "men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves," and Cassius promptly reads the storm as a sign against Caesar.
Task: Annotate the scene for setting, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about storm, omens and recruitment? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene III develops the idea of storm, omens and recruitment. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. When the text says "men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves" (Act I, Scene III, Cicero), it shows this directly. Cicero warns that "men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves," and Cassius promptly reads the storm as a sign against Caesar.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Do people tend to read signs and news in the way that fits what they already believe? Ask: why does Cassius need Brutus? Use Casca's line.
Anchor question: Do people tend to read signs and news in the way that fits what they already believe?
Facilitation: Ask: why does Cassius need Brutus? Use Casca's line.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about storm, omens and recruitment? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. ("men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves", Act I, Scene III, Cicero). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about storm, omens and recruitment? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. ("men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves", Act I, Scene III, Cicero). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how setting shapes storm, omens and recruitment. Key takeaway: each character reads the omens to suit himself.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Setting:** A violent storm with omens (a lion in the Capitol, men on fire, a bird of night at noon).
- **Characterization:** Casca is terrified; Cassius bares his chest to the lightning and interprets the omens as warnings against Caesar.
- **Plot:** Cassius plans to throw forged letters in Brutus's window.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and omens:** each character reads the omens to suit himself.

Symbols and motifs

- **warnings ignored:** Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: "Be you content: good Cinna, take this paper, / And look you lay it in the praetor's chair, / Where Brutus" (Act I, Scene III, Cassius).
- **omens and portents:** Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: "at noon-day upon the market-place, / Hooting and shrieking. When these prodigies / Do so conjointly meet, let not men say / "These are their" (Act I, Scene III, Casca).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves" (Act I, Scene III, Cicero) Cicero on interpreting omens.
- "Cassius from bondage will deliver Cassius" (Act I, Scene III, Cassius) Cassius's willingness to die.
- "O, he sits high in all the people's hearts" (Act I, Scene III, Casca) Casca on Brutus's reputation.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish.
Evidence: "men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves" (Act I, Scene III, Cicero)
Reasoning: Cicero warns that "men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves," and Cassius promptly reads the storm as a sign against Caesar.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
bondman (noun)	a slave	*So can I: So every bondman in his own hand bears The power to cancel his captivity.*	"bondman": Origin: an English formation from bond + -man. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/bondman#Etymology)
construe (verb)	to interpret; to explain	*Indeed, it is a strange-disposed time: But men may construe things after their fashion, Clean from the purpose of the things themselves.*	
alchemy (noun)	the supposed art of turning base metal to gold	*O, he sits high in all the people's hearts: And that which would appear offence in us, His countenance, like richest alchemy, Will change to virtue and to worthiness.*	
shrieking (verb)	crying out with a high scream	*And yesterday the bird of night did sit Even at noon-day upon the market-place, Hooting and shrieking.*	
conceited (verb)	understood; judged (well conceited: rightly grasped)	*Him and his worth and our great need of him You have right well conceited.*	
conjointly (adverb)	all together; at the same time	*When these prodigies Do so conjointly meet, let not men say "These are their reasons; they are natural;"*	

factious (adjective)	ready to form a faction; active in a cause	*Hold, my hand: Be factious for redress of all these griefs, And I will set this foot of mine as far As who goes farthest.*	
incorporate (adjective)	closely united (with the plot)	*No, it is Casca; one incorporate To our attempts.*	"incorporate": Origin: Late Latin incorporātus. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/incorporate#Etymology)
worthiness (noun)	merit; excellence	*O, he sits high in all the people's hearts: And that which would appear offence in us, His countenance, like richest alchemy, Will change to virtue and to worthiness.*	
sufferance (noun)	patient endurance of wrongs	*Let it be who it is: for Romans now Have thews and limbs like to their ancestors; But, woe the while! our fathers' minds are dead, And we are govern'd with our mothers' spirits; Our yoke and sufferance show us womanish.*	"sufferance": Origin: Anglo-Norman suffraunce; earlier Late Latin sufferentia. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/sufferance#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Do people tend to read signs and news in the way that fits what they already believe?
2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with public versus private self?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Casca say the senators plan to do tomorrow? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Establish Caesar as king, to wear his crown everywhere except in Italy.
2. What strange sight does Casca report about a slave's hand? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: It burned but was not scorched
3. Which wild animal does Casca say he met near the Capitol? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A lion
4. How does Cassius interpret the storm? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: As a warning against Caesar's tyranny

5. Who is sent to place the letters for Brutus? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Cinna
6. Why do the conspirators want Brutus to join them? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: His good reputation will make the deed seem worthy
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: On a night of thunder and strange sights (a slave's burning hand that does not burn, a lion near the Capitol, men on fire walking the streets, an owl hooting at noon), Casca meets Cicero and then Cassius. Cassius reads the omens as warnings against Caesar's tyranny and wins Casca to the plot. Cinna joins them; Cassius sends him to place forged letters where Brutus will find them, and they agree…
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act I, Scene III" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "So can I: So every bondman in his own hand bears The power to cancel his captivity." What does "bondman" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: bondman: a slave.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Cassius say he would rather die than live under Caesar? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: He believes Romans who accept a tyrant become slaves; he will free himself.
2. What does "Act I, Scene III" suggest about storm, omens and recruitment? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The same omens are read in opposite ways: Casca is terrified, Cassius turns them into an argument. The scene shows that interpretation is itself a tool of persuasion.
3. Find one example of setting in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the tone / mood in this scene shape what we understand about storm, omens and recruitment? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: "men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves" (Act I, Scene III, Cicero): Cicero on interpreting omens. Theme link: each character reads the omens to suit himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "A common slave—you know him well by sight— Held up his left hand, which did flame and burn Like twenty torches join'd, and yet his hand, Not sensible of fire, remain'd unscorch'd.", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: On a night of thunder and strange sights (a slave's burning hand that does not burn, a lion near the Capitol, men on fire walking the streets, an owl hooting at noon), Casca meets Cicero and then Cassius. Cassius reads the omens as warnings against Caesar's tyranny and wins Casca to the plot. Cinna…
7. How does “Act I, Scene III” build on “Act I, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “Cassius from bondage will deliver Cassius” (Act I, Scene III, Cassius): Cassius's willingness to die. Theme link: each character reads the omens to suit himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “O, he sits high in all the people’s hearts” (Act I, Scene III, Casca): Casca on Brutus's reputation. On characterization: Casca is terrified; Cassius bares his chest to the lightning and interprets the omens as warnings against Caesar. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Do people tend to read signs and news in the way that fits what they already believe?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with public versus private self? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves” (Act I, Scene III, Cicero): Cicero on interpreting omens. Theme link: each character reads the omens to suit himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is it fair for the conspirators to use Brutus's reputation? What does that suggest about their cause? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: They borrow his virtue as cover; it suggests the cause needs disguising.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “Cassius from bondage will deliver Cassius” (Act I, Scene III, Cassius): Cassius's willingness to die. Theme link: each character reads the omens to suit himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “The same omens are read in opposite ways: Casca is terrified, Cassius turns them into an argument. The scene shows that interpretation is itself a tool of persuasion.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “O, he sits high in all the people’s hearts” (Act I, Scene III, Casca): Casca on Brutus's reputation. Theme link: each character reads the omens to suit himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves” (Act I, Scene III, Cicero): Cicero on interpreting omens. On characterization: Casca is terrified; Cassius bares his chest to the lightning and interprets the omens as warnings against Caesar. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act I, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of storm, omens and recruitment. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “Cassius from bondage will deliver Cassius” (Act I, Scene III, Cassius): Cassius's willingness to die. Theme link: each character reads the omens to suit himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “O, he sits high in all the people’s hearts” (Act I, Scene III, Casca): Casca on Brutus's reputation. Theme link: each character reads the omens to suit himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to fate, omens and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves” (Act I, Scene III, Cicero): Cicero on interpreting omens. Theme link: each character reads the omens to suit himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “Cassius from bondage will deliver Cassius” (Act I, Scene III, Cassius): Cassius's willingness to die. On setting: A violent storm with omens (a lion in the Capitol, men on fire, a bird of night at noon). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act I, Scene III” treats storm, omens and recruitment with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “O, he sits high in all the people’s hearts” (Act I, Scene III, Casca): Casca on Brutus's reputation. Theme link: each character reads the omens to suit himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act II, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves” (Act I, Scene III, Cicero): Cicero on interpreting omens. Theme link: each character reads the omens to suit himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about storm, omens and recruitment? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “Cassius from bondage will deliver Cassius” (Act I, Scene III, Cassius): Cassius's willingness to die. Theme link: each character reads the omens to suit himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “No, it is Casca; one _____ To our attempts.” Word bank: incorporate, alchemy, bondman, construe
   Key: incorporate

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene III, Cicero: “men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things _____”

   Key: themselves

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “And yesterday the bird of night did sit Even at noon-day upon the market-place, Hooting and shrieking.”, what does “shrieking” most nearly mean?

   A. crying out with a high scream

   B. forced; strained

   C. condemning people to death by public list

   D. to supply sparingly (here, to cut short with a little sleep)

   Key: A (crying out with a high scream)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “When these prodigies Do so _____ meet, let not men say “These are their reasons; they are natural;”” Word bank: construe, alchemy, bondman, conjointly

   Key: conjointly

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “So can I: So every bondman in his own hand bears The power to cancel his captivity.”, what does “bondman” most nearly mean?

   A. a slave

   B. very poor people who ask for money

   C. decorations hung in honor of a victory

   D. outskirts; the edges of something

   Key: A (a slave)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Hold, my hand: Be _____ for redress of all these griefs, And I will set this foot of mine as far As who goes farthest.” Word bank: bondman, factious, alchemy, construe

   Key: factious

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why do the conspirators want Brutus to join them?

   A. He is Caesar's son

   B. He is the best soldier

   C. His good reputation will make the deed seem worthy

   D. He has money

   Key: C (His good reputation will make the deed seem worthy)

8. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does Casca say the senators plan to do tomorrow?

   Sample answer: Establish Caesar as king, to wear his crown everywhere except in Italy.

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Him and his worth and our great need of him You have right well _____.” Word bank: bondman, construe, alchemy, conceited

   Key: conceited

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “O, he sits high in all the people’s hearts” (Act I, Scene III, Casca)

    A. The cobbler's pun on soles/souls.

    B. Casca on Brutus's reputation.

    C. Antony on Lepidus.

D. Brutus's balanced antithesis.

Key: B (Casca on Brutus's reputation.)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves” (Act I, Scene III, Cicero)

    A. The proscription.

    B. Marullus's contempt for the crowd.

    C. Cassius's death.

    D. Cicero on interpreting omens.

    Key: D (Cicero on interpreting omens.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act I, Scene III”?

    A. The tribunes and the fickle crowd

    B. Portia's anxiety

    C. Young Cato and Lucilius

    D. Storm, omens and recruitment

    Key: D (Storm, omens and recruitment)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Cassius say he would rather die than live under Caesar?

    Sample answer: He believes Romans who accept a tyrant become slaves; he will free himself.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves” (Act I, Scene III, Cicero).

    Sample answer: Cicero warns that "men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves," and Cassius promptly reads the storm as a sign against Caesar.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act I, Scene III”? Casca is terrified; Cassius bares his chest to the lightning and interprets the omens as warnings against Caesar.

    A. Tone / mood

    B. Characterization

    C. Simile

    D. Hyperbole

    Key: B (Characterization)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: Cicero warns that "men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves," and Cassius promptly reads the storm as a sign against Caesar.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Indeed, it is a strange-disposed time: But men may construe things after their fashion, Clean from the purpose of the things themselves.”, what does “construe” most nearly mean?

    A. a boy at school

    B. to interpret; to explain

    C. immediately

    D. wicked; good-for-nothing

Key: B (to interpret; to explain)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene III, Cassius: "_____ from bondage will deliver Cassius"

    Key: Cassius

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Cassius interpret the storm?

    A. As a sign Caesar should be crowned

    B. As a warning against Caesar's tyranny

    C. As meaningless

    D. As a curse on Cassius

    Key: B (As a warning against Caesar's tyranny)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who is sent to place the letters for Brutus?

    A. Trebonius

    B. Decius

    C. Casca

    D. Cinna

    Key: D (Cinna)

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "Cassius from bondage will deliver Cassius" (Act I, Scene III, Cassius)

    A. The tribunes' metaphor of limiting Caesar's power.

    B. The proscription.

    C. Cassius's willingness to die.

    D. Brutus's hope.

    Key: C (Cassius's willingness to die.)

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in "O, he sits high in all the people's hearts" (Act I, Scene III, Casca). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Casca on Brutus's reputation.

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in "Act I, Scene III"? A violent storm with omens (a lion in the Capitol, men on fire, a bird of night at noon).

    A. Simile

    B. Setting

    C. Structure

    D. Tone / mood

    Key: B (Setting)

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act I, Scene III, Casca: "O, he sits high in all the _____'s hearts"

    Key: people

25. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "Cassius from bondage will deliver Cassius" (Act I, Scene III, Cassius) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Cassius's willingness to die.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is it fair for the conspirators to use Brutus's reputation? What does that suggest about their cause?

    Sample answer: They borrow his virtue as cover; it suggests the cause needs disguising.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves" (Act I, Scene III, Cicero) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Cicero on interpreting omens.

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "O, he sits high in all the people's hearts: And that which would appear offence in us, His countenance, like richest alchemy, Will change to virtue and to worthiness.", what does "alchemy" most nearly mean?

    A. forced; strained

    B. grieves

    C. the supposed art of turning base metal to gold

    D. base criminals (here, the citizens mean the conspirators)

    Key: C (the supposed art of turning base metal to gold)

29. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves" (Act I, Scene III, Cicero) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Cicero on interpreting omens.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Cassius from bondage will deliver Cassius" (Act I, Scene III, Cassius) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Cassius's willingness to die.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how fate and omens develops from an earlier scene to "Act I, Scene III". Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: each character reads the omens to suit himself.

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What strange sight does Casca report about a slave's hand?

    A. It bled

    B. It held a crown

    C. It turned to stone

    D. It burned but was not scorched

    Key: D (It burned but was not scorched)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 4, 19, 2, 20, 3, 1, 11, 12, 21, 10, 14, 22, 23, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	17, 24, 2, 6, 20, 5, 12, 21, 25, 13, 11, 14, 15, 23, 26, 27	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	1, 28, 8, 2, 17, 13, 10, 29, 21, 12, 22, 14, 15, 23, 30, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	9, 4, 17, 3, 10, 13, 11, 12, 29, 23, 15, 22, 14, 27, 30, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	24, 8, 1, 21, 25, 10, 29, 15, 23, 14, 22, 30, 31, 27, 16, 26	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Freshman	9, 4, 32, 29, 12, 21, 10, 22, 23, 15, 14, 27, 31, 26, 30, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5

College Sophomore	18, 9, 21, 11, 10, 13, 25, 15, 22, 23, 14, 31, 26, 16, 30, 27	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Junior	4, 9, 13, 12, 11, 25, 10, 23, 15, 22, 14, 31, 27, 26, 16, 30	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Senior	9, 4, 12, 10, 21, 29, 25, 15, 23, 22, 14, 26, 31, 30, 16, 27	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	4, 9, 11, 29, 12, 21, 13, 22, 15, 14, 23, 30, 16, 26, 31, 27	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act I, Scene III,” how does Shakespeare show storm, omens and recruitment? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act I, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of storm, omens and recruitment? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene III develops the idea of storm, omens and recruitment. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of storm, omens and recruitment. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene III suggests about storm, omens and recruitment. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses setting in Act I, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of storm, omens and recruitment. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act I, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of storm, omens and recruitment responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act I, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of storm, omens and recruitment follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene III and its treatment of storm, omens and recruitment. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's setting and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about storm, omens and recruitment in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of storm, omens and recruitment. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *O, he sits high in all the people's hearts: And that which would appear offence in us, His countenance, like richest alchemy, Will change to virtue and to worthiness.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "alchemy" most nearly mean?

   A. patient endurance of wrongs

   B. closely united (with the plot)

   C. merit; excellence

   D. the supposed art of turning base metal to gold

2. *A common slave—you know him well by sight— Held up his left hand, which did flame and burn Like twenty torches join'd, and yet his hand, Not sensible of fire, remain'd unscorch'd. Besides—I ha' not since put up my sword— Against the Capitol I met a lion, Who glared upon me, and went surly by, Without annoying me: and there were drawn Upon a heap a hundred ghastly women, Transformed with their fear; who swore they saw Men all in fire walk up and down the streets. And yesterday the bird of night did sit Even at noon-day upon the market-place, Hooting and shrieking. When these prodigies Do so conjointly meet, let not men say "These are their reasons; they are natural;" For, I believe, they are portentous things Unto the climate that they point upon.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene III"?

   A. The assassination

   B. The death of Cassius

   C. The death of Brutus

   D. Storm, omens and recruitment

SAT key: 1. D (the supposed art of turning base metal to gold); 2. D (Storm, omens and recruitment)

Lesson 6: Act II, Scene I

Focus: Brutus decides

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “Act II, Scene I” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (self-harm, sexual language): Portia proves her 'constancy' by showing a 'voluntary wound / Here, in the thigh' she gave herself. Frame it as a Roman ideal of endurance read critically, not as a model; use the safe-messaging script. She also says that without his trust she is 'Brutus' harlot, not his wife' (harlot = a mistress or prostitute).
Student preview: A character describes deliberately wounding herself. Support is available if this is hard to read.
Suggested language: “What is Portia trying to prove, and what does it cost her?”
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this scene is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Alone in his orchard at night, Brutus decides Caesar must die, not for what he has done but for what he might become: 'think him as a serpent's egg.' He reads a forged letter urging him to act. The conspirators arrive; Brutus refuses an oath, refuses to include Cicero, and overrules Cassius's plan to kill Antony too: 'Let us be sacrificers, but not butchers.' Decius promises to bring Caesar to the Capitol. Portia, who has wounded her own thigh to prove her constancy, demands to share his secret. Ligarius, though sick, joins.

Background: Brutus's ancestor, Lucius Junius Brutus, was said to have driven out Rome's last king, Tarquin, and founded the republic. That family history weighs on Brutus.

Significance: Brutus's soliloquy argues from fear of the future, not evidence. His three decisions here (no oath, no Cicero, spare Antony) each show idealism and each later harms the conspiracy.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is it fair to punish someone for something they might do in the future? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to honour and idealism because.... Content note before we start: A character describes deliberately wounding herself. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: Is it fair to punish someone for something they might do in the future?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to honour and idealism because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: husbanded — married; having a husband; dismember — to cut the limbs from a body; unbraced — with clothing unfastened; prevention — being stopped before acting; suburbs — outskirts; the edges of something. "dismember": Origin: Old French desmembrer. "unbraced": Origin of "unbrace": an English formation from un- + brace.
Words: husbanded: married; having a husband · dismember: to cut the limbs from a body · unbraced: with clothing unfastened · prevention: being stopped before acting · suburbs: outskirts; the edges of something

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Brutus's ancestor, Lucius Junius Brutus, was said to have driven out Rome's last king, Tarquin, and founded the republic. That family history weighs on Brutus. Brutus's soliloquy argues from fear of the future, not evidence. His three decisions here (no oath, no Cicero, spare Antony) each show idealism and each later harms the conspiracy. Soliloquy: "It must be by his death": Brutus decides to kill Caesar not for what he has done but for what he might become ("think him as a serpent's egg"). Characterization: Brutus overrules Cassius three times (no oath, spare Antony, let Antony speak later); Portia demands to share his secret. Imagery: The serpent's egg; "Let's carve him as a dish fit for the gods." Watch for warnings ignored: Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: "sir. / Searching the window for a flint, I found / This paper, thus seal'd up; and, I am sure, / It did not lie" (Act II, Scene I, Lucius).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "It must be by his death" slowly and put it in my own words: Brutus concludes that the only way to stop Caesar is by his death. Next, craft. I notice the short, final sentence after a sleepless night of reasoning, like a verdict. The strongest word is "death": it is the decision that drives the whole play. Then, effect. What does Brutus decide in his orchard soliloquy? My answer: Brutus decides to kill Caesar not for anything Caesar has done but for what he might become; his reasoning shows an honorable man talking himself into murder for the public good.

> *It must be by his death* (Act II, Scene I, Brutus)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "It must be by his death" slowly and put it in my own words: Brutus concludes that the only way to stop Caesar is by his death. Next, craft. I notice the short, final sentence after a sleepless night of reasoning, like a verdict. The strongest word is "death": it is the decision that drives the whole play. Then, effect. What does Brutus decide in his orchard soliloquy? My answer: Brutus decides to kill Caesar not for anything Caesar has done but for what he might become; his reasoning shows an honorable man talking himself into murder for the public good.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The serpent's egg is a metaphor for potential danger: Caesar is to be judged on what he might do. Honour and idealism. Ask: How does this line connect to honour and idealism? Expected: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." (Preventive reasoning.)

> *And therefore think him as a serpent's egg / Which, hatch'd, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell* (Act II, Scene I, Brutus)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The serpent's egg is a metaphor for potential danger: Caesar is to be judged on what he might do. Honour and idealism.
Ask: How does this line connect to honour and idealism?
Expected answer: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." (Preventive reasoning.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for soliloquy, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Brutus decides? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene I develops the idea of Brutus decides. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. When the text says "And therefore think him as a serpent's egg / Which, hatch'd, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell" (Act II, Scene I, Brutus), it shows this directly. He admits he has no evidence of present tyranny but asks the conspirators to "think him as a serpent's egg" and kill him "in the shell," and he wants them to be "sacrificers, but not butchers."

Task: Annotate the scene for soliloquy, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Brutus decides? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene I develops the idea of Brutus decides. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. When the text says "And therefore think him as a serpent's egg / Which, hatch'd, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell" (Act II, Scene I, Brutus), it shows this directly. He admits he has no evidence of present tyranny but asks the conspirators to "think him as a serpent's egg" and kill him "in the shell," and he wants them to be "sacrificers, but not butchers."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Is it fair to punish someone for something they might do in the future? Ask: is preventive killing ever justified? Push for evidence from Brutus's own words.

Anchor question: Is it fair to punish someone for something they might do in the future?

Facilitation: Ask: is preventive killing ever justified? Push for evidence from Brutus's own words.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Brutus decides? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. ("And therefore think him as a serpent's egg / Which, hatch'd, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell", Act II, Scene I, Brutus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Brutus decides? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. ("And therefore think him as a serpent's egg / Which, hatch'd, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell", Act II, Scene I, Brutus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how soliloquy shapes Brutus decides. Key takeaway: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers."

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Soliloquy:** "It must be by his death": Brutus decides to kill Caesar not for what he has done but for what he might become ("think him as a serpent's egg").
- **Characterization:** Brutus overrules Cassius three times (no oath, spare Antony, let Antony speak later); Portia demands to share his secret.
- **Imagery:** The serpent's egg; "Let's carve him as a dish fit for the gods."

Themes and how they develop

- **honour and idealism:** Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers."

Symbols and motifs

- **warnings ignored:** Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: "sir. / Searching the window for a flint, I found / This paper, thus seal'd up; and, I am sure, / It did not lie" (Act II, Scene I, Lucius).
- **omens and portents:** Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: "again; it is not day. / Is not to-morrow, boy, the ides of March" (Act II, Scene I, Brutus).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "It must be by his death" (Act II, Scene I, Brutus) Brutus's decision.
- "And therefore think him as a serpent's egg / Which, hatch'd, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell" (Act II, Scene I, Brutus) Preventive reasoning.
- "Let us be sacrificers, but not butchers, Caius" (Act II, Scene I, Brutus) Brutus's idealism.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning.
Evidence: "And therefore think him as a serpent's egg / Which, hatch'd, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell" (Act II, Scene I, Brutus)
Reasoning: He admits he has no evidence of present tyranny but asks the conspirators to "think him as a serpent's egg" and kill him "in the shell," and he wants them to be "sacrificers, but not butchers."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
husbanded (adjective)	married; having a husband	*Think you I am no stronger than my sex, Being so father'd and so husbanded?*	
dismember (verb)	to cut the limbs from a body	*We all stand up against the spirit of Caesar; And in the spirit of men there is no blood: O, that we then could come by Caesar's spirit, And not dismember Caesar!*	"dismember": Origin: Old French desmembrer. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/dismember#Etymology)
unbraced (adjective)	with clothing unfastened	*Is Brutus sick? and is it physical To walk unbraced and suck up the humours Of the dank morning?*	"unbraced": Origin of "unbrace": an English formation from un- + brace. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/unbrace#Etymology)
prevention (noun)	being stopped before acting	*Seek none, conspiracy; Hide it in smiles and affability: For if thou path, thy native semblance on, Not Erebus itself were dim enough To hide thee from prevention.*	
suburbs (noun)	outskirts; the edges of something	*Dwell I but in the suburbs Of your good pleasure?*	
butchers (noun)	people who kill savagely	*Our course will seem too bloody, Caius Cassius, To cut the head off and then*	

		hack the limbs, Like wrath in death and envy afterwards; For Antony is but a limb of Caesar: Let us be sacrificers, but not butchers, Caius.	
mortified (adjective)	deadened; numb as if dead	*Thou, like an exorcist, hast conjured up My mortified spirit.*	
instigations (noun)	urgings to act	*Such instigations have been often dropp'd Where I have took them up.*	
sacrificers (noun)	people who offer a sacrifice	*Our course will seem too bloody, Caius Cassius, To cut the head off and then hack the limbs, Like wrath in death and envy afterwards; For Antony is but a limb of Caesar: Let us be sacrificers, but not butchers, Caius.*	
exhalations (noun)	meteors; shooting lights in the sky	*The exhalations whizzing in the air Give so much light that I may read by them.*	

Discussion questions

1. Is it fair to punish someone for something they might do in the future?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate, omens and free will?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Whom did Brutus's ancestors drive from Rome, as he recalls while reading the letter? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Tarquin, Rome's last king.
2. To what does Brutus compare Caesar in his soliloquy? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A serpent's egg
3. What does Brutus refuse to let the conspirators do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Swear an oath
4. Whom does Cassius want to kill along with Caesar? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Mark Antony

5. Who promises to bring Caesar to the Capitol? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Decius Brutus
6. How has Portia proved her constancy? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She gave herself a wound in the thigh
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Alone in his orchard at night, Brutus decides Caesar must die, not for what he has done but for what he might become: 'think him as a serpent's egg.' He reads a forged letter urging him to act. The conspirators arrive; Brutus refuses an oath, refuses to include Cicero, and overrules Cassius's plan to kill Antony too: 'Let us be sacrificers, but not butchers.' Decius promises to bring Caesar to…
8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act II, Scene I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Think you I am no stronger than my sex, Being so father'd and so husbanded?" What does "husbanded" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: husbanded: married; having a husband.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does Brutus's admission that he has no quarrel with what Caesar has done reveal about his reasoning? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: His case rests on speculation about Caesar's future, not facts.
2. What does "Act II, Scene I" suggest about Brutus decides? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Brutus's soliloquy argues from fear of the future, not evidence. His three decisions here (no oath, no Cicero, spare Antony) each show idealism and each later harms the conspiracy.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the theme in this scene shape what we understand about Brutus decides? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: "It must be by his death" (Act II, Scene I, Brutus): Brutus's decision. Theme link: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "The exhalations whizzing in the air Give so much light that I may read by them.", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Act II, Scene I", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Alone in his orchard at night, Brutus decides Caesar must

die, not for what he has done but for what he might become: 'think him as a serpent's egg.' He reads a forged letter urging him to act. The conspirators arrive; Brutus refuses an oath, refuses to include Cicero, and overrules Cassius's plan…

7. How does “Act II, Scene I” build on “Act I, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “And therefore think him as a serpent’s egg / Which, hatch’d, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus): Preventive reasoning. Theme link: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “Let us be sacrificers, but not butchers, Caius” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus): Brutus's idealism. On characterization: Brutus overrules Cassius three times (no oath, spare Antony, let Antony speak later); Portia demands to share his secret. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is it fair to punish someone for something they might do in the future?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate, omens and free will? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “It must be by his death” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus): Brutus's decision. Theme link: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Brutus calls the killing a sacrifice, not a butchery. Can how you name an act change what it is? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Strong answers weigh rhetoric against the reality of violence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “And therefore think him as a serpent’s egg / Which, hatch’d, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus): Preventive reasoning. Theme link: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “Brutus's soliloquy argues from fear of the future, not evidence. His three decisions here (no oath, no Cicero, spare Antony) each show idealism and each later harms the conspiracy.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “Let us be sacrificers, but not butchers, Caius” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus): Brutus's idealism. Theme link: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “It must be by his death” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus): Brutus's decision. On characterization: Brutus overrules Cassius three times (no oath, spare Antony, let Antony speak later); Portia demands to share his secret. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act II, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Brutus decides. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “And therefore think him as a serpent’s egg / Which, hatch’d, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus): Preventive reasoning. Theme link: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “Let us be sacrificers, but not butchers, Caius” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus): Brutus's idealism. Theme link: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to power, ambition and tyranny: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “It must be by his death” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus): Brutus's decision. Theme link: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “And therefore think him as a serpent’s egg / Which, hatch’d, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus): Preventive reasoning. On characterization: Brutus overrules Cassius three times (no oath, spare Antony, let Antony speak later); Portia demands to share his secret. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act II, Scene I” treats Brutus decides with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “Let us be sacrificers, but not butchers, Caius” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus): Brutus's idealism. Theme link: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act II, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “It must be by his death” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus): Brutus's decision. Theme link: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Brutus decides? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “And therefore think him as a serpent’s egg / Which, hatch’d, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus): Preventive reasoning. Theme link: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Brutus refuse to let the conspirators do?
   A. Swear an oath
   B. Speak to Portia
   C. Carry daggers
   D. Meet at night
   Key: A (Swear an oath)
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Dwell I but in the _____ Of your good pleasure?" Word bank: suburbs, unbraced, dismember, husbanded
   Key: suburbs
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Such _____ have been often dropp'd Where I have took them up." Word bank: instigations, unbraced, husbanded, dismember
   Key: instigations
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Seek none, conspiracy; Hide it in smiles and affability: For if thou path, thy native semblance on, Not Erebus itself were dim enough To hide thee from prevention.", what does "prevention" most nearly mean?
   A. debating; quarreling
   B. a free person, no longer a slave
   C. to state freely; to explain fully
   D. being stopped before acting
   Key: D (being stopped before acting)
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How has Portia proved her constancy?
   A. She fasted for a week
   B. She spied on Caesar
   C. She gave herself a wound in the thigh
   D. She swore an oath
   Key: C (She gave herself a wound in the thigh)
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "We all stand up against the spirit of Caesar; And in the spirit of men there is no blood: O, that we then could come by Caesar's spirit, And not dismember Caesar!", what does "dismember" most nearly mean?
   A. condemning people to death by public list
   B. to cut the limbs from a body
   C. merit; excellence
   D. polite behavior
   Key: B (to cut the limbs from a body)
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Is Brutus sick? and is it physical To walk unbraced and suck up the humours Of the dank morning?", what does "unbraced" most nearly mean?
   A. formal politeness
   B. one who heals (here, a joke: he "heals" old shoes)
   C. internal organs (of a sacrificed animal)

D. with clothing unfastened

Key: D (with clothing unfastened)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Our course will seem too bloody, Caius Cassius, To cut the head off and then hack the limbs, Like wrath in death and envy afterwards; For Antony is but a limb of Caesar: Let us be sacrificers, but not _____, Caius.” Word bank: husbanded, dismember, unbraced, butchers

   Key: butchers

9. [short · recall · DOK 1] Whom did Brutus's ancestors drive from Rome, as he recalls while reading the letter?

   Sample answer: Tarquin, Rome's last king.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What does Brutus's admission that he has no quarrel with what Caesar has done reveal about his reasoning?

    Sample answer: His case rests on speculation about Caesar's future, not facts.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act II, Scene I”?

    A. Brutus decides

    B. The assassination

    C. The death of Brutus

    D. Cinna the poet

    Key: A (Brutus decides)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “And therefore think him as a serpent’s egg / Which, hatch’d, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Preventive reasoning.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “It must be by his death” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus)

    A. Antony's opening.

    B. Brutus's decision.

    C. Her self-criticism.

    D. Antony's taunt about rhetoric.

    Key: B (Brutus's decision.)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene I”? "It must be by his death": Brutus decides to kill Caesar not for what he has done but for what he might become ("think him as a serpent's egg").

    A. Soliloquy

    B. Diction / vocabulary

    C. Allusion

    D. Alliteration

    Key: A (Soliloquy)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene I”? Brutus overrules Cassius three times (no oath, spare Antony, let Antony speak later); Portia demands to share his secret.

    A. Setting

B. Characterization

C. Imagery

D. Diction / vocabulary

Key: B (Characterization)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how honour and idealism develops from an earlier scene to “Act II, Scene I”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers."

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene I, Brutus: “Let us be _____, but not butchers, Caius”

    Key: sacrificers

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whom does Cassius want to kill along with Caesar?

    A. Octavius

    B. Mark Antony

    C. Lepidus

    D. Cicero

    Key: B (Mark Antony)

19. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “And therefore think him as a serpent’s egg / Which, hatch’d, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus)

    A. Preventive reasoning.

    B. Brutus's argument for attacking.

    C. Antony's prophecy of civil war.

    D. Young Cato.

    Key: A (Preventive reasoning.)

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Let us be sacrificers, but not butchers, Caius” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Brutus's idealism.

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “And therefore think him as a serpent’s egg / Which, hatch’d, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus).

    Sample answer: He admits he has no evidence of present tyranny but asks the conspirators to "think him as a serpent's egg" and kill him "in the shell," and he wants them to be "sacrificers, but not butchers."

22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Brutus calls the killing a sacrifice, not a butchery. Can how you name an act change what it is?

    Sample answer: Strong answers weigh rhetoric against the reality of violence.

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Thou, like an exorcist, hast conjured up My _____ spirit.” Word bank: unbraced, husbanded, dismember, mortified

    Key: mortified

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who promises to bring Caesar to the Capitol?

    A. Cinna

B. Casca

C. Metellus

D. Decius Brutus

Key: D (Decius Brutus)

25. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “It must be by his death” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Brutus's decision.
26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “It must be by his death” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Brutus's decision.
27. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Think you I am no stronger than my sex, Being so father’d and so husbanded?”, what does “husbanded” most nearly mean?

    A. clothing; here, Caesar's cloak

    B. married; having a husband

    C. to interpret; to explain

    D. a person who joins a secret plot

    Key: B (married; having a husband)
28. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene I, Brutus: “And therefore think him as a serpent’s egg / Which, hatch’d, would, as his kind, grow _____, / And kill him in the shell”
    Key: mischievous
29. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Let us be sacrificers, but not butchers, Caius” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus)

    A. Brutus's idealism.

    B. Brutus on cooling friendship.

    C. Cicero on interpreting omens.

    D. Brutus's restraint.

    Key: A (Brutus's idealism.)
30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “And therefore think him as a serpent’s egg / Which, hatch’d, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Preventive reasoning.
31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: He admits he has no evidence of present tyranny but asks the conspirators to "think him as a serpent's egg" and kill him "in the shell," and he wants them to be "sacrificers, but not butchers."

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	4, 17, 18, 5, 9, 8, 6, 7, 10, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 15, 22	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
		recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2

HS Sophomore	18, 23, 24, 4, 2, 6, 12, 13, 25, 11, 10, 20, 14, 21, 22, 26	
HS Junior	23, 7, 27, 28, 2, 11, 19, 12, 29, 13, 21, 15, 14, 20, 26, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	27, 28, 8, 17, 29, 13, 10, 11, 12, 20, 14, 15, 21, 16, 30, 31	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	2, 8, 7, 19, 25, 13, 12, 20, 15, 21, 14, 16, 22, 26, 30, 31	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Freshman	2, 8, 27, 25, 13, 12, 19, 20, 21, 15, 14, 22, 30, 31, 16, 26	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	2, 8, 10, 29, 12, 19, 11, 14, 20, 15, 21, 30, 26, 16, 31, 22	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Junior	2, 8, 29, 19, 10, 12, 25, 15, 14, 21, 20, 26, 31, 30, 22, 16	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Senior	23, 2, 29, 11, 13, 10, 25, 15, 20, 21, 14, 30, 26, 16, 22, 31	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	2, 8, 25, 29, 10, 12, 13, 20, 21, 15, 14, 22, 30, 16, 26, 31	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show Brutus decides? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act II, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Brutus decides? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene I develops the idea of Brutus decides. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Brutus decides. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene I suggests about Brutus decides. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act II, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of Brutus decides. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act II, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Brutus decides responds to that context.

Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act II, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Brutus decides follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene I and its treatment of Brutus decides. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about Brutus decides in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Brutus decides. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *Is Brutus sick? and is it physical To walk unbraced and suck up the humours Of the dank morning?*

   As used in the text, what does the word “unbraced” most nearly mean?

   A. urgings to act

   B. meteors; shooting lights in the sky

   C. with clothing unfastened

   D. people who offer a sacrifice

2. *The exhalations whizzing in the air Give so much light that I may read by them. Opens the letter and reads. “Brutus, thou sleep’st: awake, and see thyself. Shall Rome, etc. Speak, strike, redress! Brutus, thou sleep’st: awake!” Such instigations have been often dropp’d Where I have took them up. “Shall Rome, etc.” Thus must I piece it out: Shall Rome stand under one man’s awe? What, Rome? My ancestors did from the streets of Rome The Tarquin drive, when he was call’d a king. “Speak, strike, redress!” Am I entreated To speak and strike? O Rome, I make thee promise: If the redress will follow, thou receivest Thy full petition at the hand of Brutus!*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act II, Scene I”?

   A. The funeral orations

   B. Brutus and Cassius at odds

   C. The death of Cassius

   D. Brutus decides

SAT key: 1. C (with clothing unfastened); 2. D (Brutus decides)

Lesson 7: Act II, Scene II

Focus: Calpurnia's dream

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in "Act II, Scene II" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…been further. Good friends, go in, and taste some wine with me; And we, like friends, will str…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Suggested language: "What does this detail add to the scene?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Calpurnia has dreamed of Caesar's statue spouting blood while Romans bathed their hands in it, and begs him to stay home. The augurs find no heart in a sacrificed beast. Caesar first boasts that danger knows he is more dangerous than it, then agrees to stay. Decius reinterprets the dream as Rome drawing life from Caesar, and says the Senate means to crown him and will mock him if he stays for a wife's dreams. Caesar goes; the conspirators and Antony arrive to escort him.

Background: Augurs were Roman priests who read the will of the gods in sacrifices and the flight of birds.

Significance: Caesar's pride and fear of looking weak are what Decius exploits, mirroring how Cassius worked on Brutus. Dramatic irony is strong: the audience knows the men greeting him as friends will kill him.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Have you ever done something risky because you were afraid of looking scared? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and omens because.... Content note before we start: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Prompt: Have you ever done something risky because you were afraid of looking scared?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and omens because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: predictions — statements about what will happen; expounded — explained; interpreted; purposed — intended; entrails — internal organs (of a sacrificed animal); beggars — very poor people who ask for money. "entrails": Origin: Old French entrailles; earlier Vulgar Latin intrālia.
Words: predictions: statements about what will happen · expounded: explained; interpreted · purposed: intended · entrails: internal organs (of a sacrificed animal) · beggars: very poor people who ask for money

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Augurs were Roman priests who read the will of the gods in sacrifices and the flight of birds. Caesar's pride and fear of looking weak are what Decius exploits, mirroring how Cassius worked on Brutus. Dramatic irony is strong: the audience knows the men greeting him as friends will kill him. Characterization: Calpurnia's dream of Caesar's statue spouting blood; Caesar decides to stay, then is persuaded by Decius's flattering reinterpretation. Dramatic irony: The audience knows the conspirators' plan; Caesar welcomes them as friends. Rhetoric: Decius flatters Caesar's pride and fear of looking weak. Watch for omens and portents: Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: "know: / Calpurnia here, my wife, stays me at home: / She dreamt to-night she saw my statua, / Which, like a fountain with an" (Act II, Scene II, Caesar).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once" slowly and put it in my own words: Refusing Calpurnia's warnings, Caesar says cowards die many times before their deaths, but the brave taste death only once. Next, craft. I notice the balanced contrast between cowards and the valiant, a polished, quotable saying. The strongest word is "valiant": it means brave, the quality Caesar insists he has. Then, effect. What does Caesar's view of death reveal about him? My answer: Caesar's view that death will come when it will reveals real courage that tips into pride; by refusing to be seen as afraid, he ignores every warning and walks to the Senate where he will be killed.

> *Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once* (Act II, Scene II, Caesar)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once" slowly and put it in my own words: Refusing Calpurnia's warnings, Caesar says cowards die many times before their deaths, but the brave taste death only once. Next, craft. I notice the balanced contrast between cowards and the valiant, a polished, quotable saying. The strongest word is "valiant": it means brave, the quality Caesar insists he has. Then, effect. What does Caesar's view of death reveal about him? My answer: Caesar's view that death will come when it will reveals real courage that tips into pride; by refusing to be seen as afraid, he ignores every warning and walks to the Senate where he will be killed.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Third-person speech shows Caesar treating himself as a public monument. Fate and omens. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and omens? Expected: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. (Third-person speech.)

> *Caesar shall go forth* (Act II, Scene II, Caesar)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Third-person speech shows Caesar treating himself as a public monument. Fate and omens.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and omens?
Expected answer: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. (Third-person speech.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Calpurnia's dream? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene II develops the idea of Calpurnia's dream. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. When the text says “Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once” (Act II, Scene II, Caesar), it shows this directly. Decius says the dream is "all amiss interpreted," and Caesar, who calls himself "Caesar" in the third person, goes, insisting the valiant "never taste of death but once."
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Calpurnia's dream? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene II develops the idea of Calpurnia's dream. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. When the text says “Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once” (Act II, Scene II, Caesar), it shows this directly. Decius says the dream is "all amiss interpreted," and Caesar, who calls himself "Caesar" in the third person, goes, insisting the valiant "never taste of death but once."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Have you ever done something risky because you were afraid of looking scared? Ask: is Caesar brave or arrogant?
Anchor question: Have you ever done something risky because you were afraid of looking scared?
Facilitation: Ask: is Caesar brave or arrogant?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Calpurnia's dream? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. ("Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once", Act II, Scene II, Caesar). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Calpurnia's dream? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. ("Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once", Act II, Scene II, Caesar). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Calpurnia's dream. Key takeaway: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Calpurnia's dream of Caesar's statue spouting blood; Caesar decides to stay, then is persuaded by Decius's flattering reinterpretation.
- **Dramatic irony:** The audience knows the conspirators' plan; Caesar welcomes them as friends.
- **Rhetoric:** Decius flatters Caesar's pride and fear of looking weak.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and omens:** Caesar ignores the omens out of pride.

Symbols and motifs

- **omens and portents:** Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: "know: / Calpurnia here, my wife, stays me at home: / She dreamt to-night she saw my statua, / Which, like a fountain with an" (Act II, Scene II, Caesar).
- **blood:** Blood turns the assassination from sacrifice into butchery; the conspirators bathe their hands in it. In this scene: "ranks and squadrons and right form of war, / Which drizzled blood upon the Capitol; / The noise of battle hurtled in the air" (Act II, Scene II, Calpurnia).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once" (Act II, Scene II, Caesar) Caesar's courage or pride.
- "Caesar shall go forth" (Act II, Scene II, Caesar) Third-person speech.

- "This dream is all amiss interpreted" (Act II, Scene II, Decius) Decius's flattery.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings.
Evidence: "Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once" (Act II, Scene II, Caesar)
Reasoning: Decius says the dream is "all amiss interpreted," and Caesar, who calls himself "Caesar" in the third person, goes, insisting the valiant "never taste of death but once."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
predictions (noun)	statements about what will happen	*Yet Caesar shall go forth; for these predictions Are to the world in general as to Caesar.*	
expounded (verb)	explained; interpreted	*And this way have you well expounded it.*	
purposed (verb)	intended	*What can be avoided Whose end is purposed by the mighty gods?*	
entrails (noun)	internal organs (of a sacrificed animal)	*Plucking the entrails of an offering forth, They could not find a heart within the beast.*	"entrails": Origin: Old French entrailles; earlier Vulgar Latin intrālia. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/entrails#Etymology)
beggars (noun)	very poor people who ask for money	*When beggars die, there are no comets seen; The heavens themselves blaze forth the death of princes.*	
signified (verb)	meant; shown	*This by Calpurnia's dream is signified.*	"signified": Origin of "signify": Old French signifier; earlier Latin significare. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/signify#Etymology)
cowardice (noun)	lack of courage	*The gods do this in shame of cowardice: Caesar should be a beast without a heart, If he should stay at home to-day for fear.*	"cowardice": Origin: Anglo-Norman cuardise. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/cowardice#Etymology)
senators (noun)	members of the Roman Senate	*And you are come in very happy time, To bear my greeting to the senators And tell them that I will not come to-day: Cannot, is false, and that I dare not, falser: I will not come to-day: tell them so, Decius.*	"senators": Origin of "senator": Latin senātor. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/senator#Etymology)

straightway (adverb)	immediately	*Good friends, go in, and taste some wine with me; And we, like friends, will straightway go together.*	"straightway": Origin: an English formation from straight + way. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/straightway#Etymology)
conquest (noun)	victory	*Have I in conquest stretch'd mine arm so far, To be afraid to tell graybeards the truth?*	

Discussion questions

1. Have you ever done something risky because you were afraid of looking scared?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with power, ambition and tyranny?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What famous line does Caesar speak about cowards and death? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Cowards die many times before their deaths; the valiant taste death once.
2. What did Calpurnia dream about Caesar's statue? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: It spouted blood that Romans bathed in
3. What do the augurs find in the sacrificed animal? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: No heart
4. How does Decius reinterpret the dream? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Rome will draw reviving blood from Caesar
5. What does Decius say the Senate plans to give Caesar? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A crown
6. Why does Caesar change his mind and go? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He fears being mocked for heeding a wife's dream
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Calpurnia has dreamed of Caesar's statue spouting blood while Romans bathed their hands in it, and begs him to stay home. The augurs find no heart in a sacrificed beast. Caesar first boasts that danger knows he is more dangerous than it, then agrees to stay. Decius reinterprets the dream as Rome drawing life from Caesar, and says the Senate means to crown him and will mock him if he stays for a…

8. Who is on stage in “Act II, Scene II”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act II, Scene II” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Yet Caesar shall go forth; for these predictions Are to the world in general as to Caesar.” What does “predictions” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: predictions: statements about what will happen.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Caesar speak of himself in the third person ('Caesar shall go forth')? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: He treats himself as a public monument; it shows pride and self-image.
2. What does “Act II, Scene II” suggest about Calpurnia's dream? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Caesar's pride and fear of looking weak are what Decius exploits, mirroring how Cassius worked on Brutus. Dramatic irony is strong: the audience knows the men greeting him as friends will kill him.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the conflict in this scene shape what we understand about Calpurnia's dream? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: “Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once” (Act II, Scene II, Caesar): Caesar's courage or pride. Theme link: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “The gods do this in shame of cowardice: Caesar should be a beast without a heart, If he should stay at home to-day for fear.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Calpurnia has dreamed of Caesar's statue spouting blood while Romans bathed their hands in it, and begs him to stay home. The augurs find no heart in a sacrificed beast. Caesar first boasts that danger knows he is more dangerous than it, then agrees to stay. Decius reinterprets the dream as Rome…
7. How does “Act II, Scene II” build on “Act II, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: “Caesar shall go forth” (Act II, Scene II, Caesar): Third-person speech. Theme link: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: “This dream is all amiss interpreted” (Act II, Scene II, Decius): Decius's flattery. On characterization: Calpurnia's dream of Caesar's statue spouting blood; Caesar decides to stay, then is persuaded by Decius's flattering reinterpretation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Have you ever done something risky because you were afraid of looking scared?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with power, ambition and tyranny? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: “Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once” (Act II, Scene II, Caesar): Caesar's courage or pride. Theme link: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Which matters more in Caesar's decision: pride or fate? Argue with evidence from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Decius's appeal to pride is decisive, though omens foreshadow fate.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: “Caesar shall go forth” (Act II, Scene II, Caesar): Third-person speech. Theme link: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Caesar's pride and fear of looking weak are what Decius exploits, mirroring how Cassius worked on Brutus. Dramatic irony is strong: the audience knows the men greeting him as friends will kill him.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: “This dream is all amiss interpreted” (Act II, Scene II, Decius): Decius's flattery. Theme link: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: “Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death

but once" (Act II, Scene II, Caesar): Caesar's courage or pride. On characterization: Calpurnia's dream of Caesar's statue spouting blood; Caesar decides to stay, then is persuaded by Decius's flattering reinterpretation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing "Act II, Scene II". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Calpurnia's dream. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: "Caesar shall go forth" (Act II, Scene II, Caesar): Third-person speech. Theme link: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about "Act II, Scene II": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: "This dream is all amiss interpreted" (Act II, Scene II, Decius): Decius's flattery. Theme link: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to honor and self-deception: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: "Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once" (Act II, Scene II, Caesar): Caesar's courage or pride. Theme link: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: "Caesar shall go forth" (Act II, Scene II, Caesar): Third-person speech. On characterization: Calpurnia's dream of Caesar's statue spouting blood; Caesar decides to stay, then is persuaded by Decius's flattering reinterpretation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Act II, Scene II" treats Calpurnia's dream with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: "This dream is all amiss interpreted" (Act II, Scene II, Decius): Decius's flattery. Theme link: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Act II, Scene III" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment

justified with textual clues.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: “Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once” (Act II, Scene II, Caesar): Caesar's courage or pride. Theme link: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Calpurnia's dream? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2]
    Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: “Caesar shall go forth” (Act II, Scene II, Caesar): Third-person speech. Theme link: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [short · recall · DOK 1] What famous line does Caesar speak about cowards and death?
   Sample answer: Cowards die many times before their deaths; the valiant taste death once.
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “And you are come in very happy time, To bear my greeting to the _____ And tell them that I will not come to-day: Cannot, is false, and that I dare not, falser: I will not come to-day: tell them so, Decius.” Word bank: purposed, expounded, senators, predictions
   Key: senators
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What do the augurs find in the sacrificed animal?
   A. A snake
   B. No heart
   C. A coin
   D. Two hearts

   Key: B (No heart)
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “What can be avoided Whose end is purposed by the mighty gods?”, what does “purposed” most nearly mean?
   A. intended
   B. kind treatment
   C. a person who joins a secret plot
   D. wicked; good-for-nothing

   Key: A (intended)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Decius reinterpret the dream?

   A. Caesar will die soon

   B. Calpurnia is jealous

   C. The gods are angry

   D. Rome will draw reviving blood from Caesar

   Key: D (Rome will draw reviving blood from Caesar)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Decius say the Senate plans to give Caesar?

   A. A triumph

   B. A temple

   C. A crown

   D. An army

   Key: C (A crown)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Yet Caesar shall go forth; for these predictions Are to the world in general as to Caesar.", what does "predictions" most nearly mean?

   A. short knives used as weapons

   B. married; having a husband

   C. to take into service

   D. statements about what will happen

   Key: D (statements about what will happen)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What did Calpurnia dream about Caesar's statue?

   A. It wept

   B. It turned to gold

   C. It spouted blood that Romans bathed in

   D. It fell and broke

   Key: C (It spouted blood that Romans bathed in)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "The gods do this in shame of _____: Caesar should be a beast without a heart, If he should stay at home to-day for fear." Word bank: purposed, expounded, predictions, cowardice

   Key: cowardice

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once" (Act II, Scene II, Caesar)

    A. Antony's opening.

    B. Brutus.

    C. The ideal.

    D. Caesar's courage or pride.

    Key: D (Caesar's courage or pride.)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene II"?

    A. The cast and world of the play

    B. The tribunes and the fickle crowd

C. Calpurnia's dream

D. The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost

Key: C (Calpurnia's dream)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once” (Act II, Scene II, Caesar) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Caesar's courage or pride.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Caesar shall go forth” (Act II, Scene II, Caesar)

    A. Caesar's hubris just before his death.

    B. Antony's prophecy of civil war.

    C. Brutus's concern for appearance.

    D. Third-person speech.

    Key: D (Third-person speech.)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once” (Act II, Scene II, Caesar).

    Sample answer: Decius says the dream is "all amiss interpreted," and Caesar, who calls himself "Caesar" in the third person, goes, insisting the valiant "never taste of death but once."

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene II”? Calpurnia's dream of Caesar's statue spouting blood; Caesar decides to stay, then is persuaded by Decius's flattering reinterpretation.

    A. Setting

    B. Characterization

    C. Simile

    D. Tone / mood

    Key: B (Characterization)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once” (Act II, Scene II, Caesar) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Caesar's courage or pride.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does Caesar change his mind and go?

    A. The augurs approve

    B. Calpurnia changes her mind

    C. Antony insists

    D. He fears being mocked for heeding a wife's dream

    Key: D (He fears being mocked for heeding a wife's dream)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene II, Caesar: “_____ die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once”

    Key: Cowards

19. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “This dream is all amiss interpreted” (Act II, Scene II, Decius)

    A. Marullus's contempt for the crowd.

    B. Haste.

    C. Brutus's decision.

    D. Decius's flattery.

    Key: D (Decius's flattery.)

20. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Caesar speak of himself in the third person ('Caesar shall go forth')?
    Sample answer: He treats himself as a public monument; it shows pride and self-image.

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “This dream is all amiss interpreted” (Act II, Scene II, Decius). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Decius's flattery.

22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: Decius says the dream is "all amiss interpreted," and Caesar, who calls himself "Caesar" in the third person, goes, insisting the valiant "never taste of death but once."

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene II, Decius: “This dream is all amiss _____”
    Key: interpreted

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “When _____ die, there are no comets seen; The heavens themselves blaze forth the death of princes.” Word bank: purposed, predictions, expounded, beggars
    Key: beggars

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene II”? The audience knows the conspirators' plan; Caesar welcomes them as friends.

    A. Simile

    B. Dramatic irony

    C. Personification

    D. Imagery

    Key: B (Dramatic irony)

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how fate and omens develops from an earlier scene to “Act II, Scene II”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Which matters more in Caesar's decision: pride or fate? Argue with evidence from the scene.
    Sample answer: Decius's appeal to pride is decisive, though omens foreshadow fate.

28. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “This by Calpurnia’s dream is _____.”
    Word bank: expounded, predictions, signified, purposed
    Key: signified

29. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Caesar shall go forth” (Act II, Scene II, Caesar) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Third-person speech.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Caesar shall go forth" (Act II, Scene II, Caesar) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Third-person speech.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	5, 6, 4, 1, 9, 7, 17, 18, 19, 20, 13, 10, 14, 21, 15, 22	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	8, 17, 23, 6, 9, 24, 10, 20, 19, 11, 13, 15, 25, 14, 26, 27	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	18, 3, 4, 28, 23, 29, 20, 11, 13, 12, 15, 25, 14, 21, 16, 26	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	28, 23, 9, 2, 11, 29, 20, 10, 12, 21, 15, 14, 25, 26, 22, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	24, 9, 4, 11, 12, 10, 20, 14, 25, 21, 15, 16, 22, 27, 30, 26	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Freshman	9, 17, 18, 10, 11, 12, 19, 15, 14, 25, 21, 26, 30, 27, 16, 22	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	24, 18, 11, 19, 13, 20, 29, 15, 14, 21, 25, 22, 26, 27, 30, 16	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Junior	28, 2, 29, 11, 13, 12, 20, 21, 25, 15, 14, 22, 16, 30, 26, 27	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Senior	9, 24, 10, 19, 12, 11, 29, 14, 21, 25, 15, 30, 27, 26, 22, 16	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	24, 28, 10, 19, 11, 13, 12, 25, 21, 14, 15, 27, 16, 22, 26, 30	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act II, Scene II," how does Shakespeare show Calpurnia's dream? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act II, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Calpurnia's dream? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene II develops the idea of Calpurnia's dream. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Calpurnia's dream. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene II suggests about Calpurnia's dream. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act II, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of Calpurnia's dream. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act II, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Calpurnia's dream responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act II, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Calpurnia's dream follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene II and its treatment of Calpurnia's dream. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and conflict, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about Calpurnia's dream in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Calpurnia's dream. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *What can be avoided Whose end is purposed by the mighty gods?*

   As used in the text, what does the word “purposed” most nearly mean?

   A. victory

B. immediately

C. intended

D. members of the Roman Senate

2. *The gods do this in shame of cowardice: Caesar should be a beast without a heart, If he should stay at home to-day for fear. No, Caesar shall not: danger knows full well That Caesar is more dangerous than he: We are two lions litter'd in one day, And I the elder and more terrible: And Caesar shall go forth.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene II"?

A. The death of Cassius

B. Artemidorus's letter

C. Calpurnia's dream

D. Cinna the poet

SAT key: 1. C (intended); 2. C (Calpurnia's dream)

Lesson 8: Act II, Scene III

Focus: Artemidorus's letter

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Act II, Scene III (Artemidorus's letter) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1

Teacher only · spoilers

Artemidorus, a teacher of rhetoric, reads aloud a letter he has written naming the conspirators and warning Caesar to look about him. He plans to stand in the street and hand it to Caesar on the way to the Capitol, lamenting that virtue cannot live out of reach of envy.

Background: This very short scene (Act II, Scene III) builds suspense just before the assassination. Plutarch reports that a man named Artemidorus tried to warn Caesar.

Significance: The warnings multiply as the moment nears, so the assassination feels both preventable and inevitable.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why do stories often add near-misses just before a disaster? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and omens because....
Prompt: Why do stories often add near-misses just before a disaster?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and omens because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: one more warning that fails.

8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
This very short scene (Act II, Scene III) builds suspense just before the assassination. Plutarch reports that a man named Artemidorus tried to warn Caesar. The warnings multiply as the moment nears, so the assassination feels both preventable and inevitable. Structure: Artemidorus reads his warning letter to the audience. Dramatic irony: We know he will not be heard. Watch for warnings ignored: Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: "Enter Artemidorus, reading a paper" (Act II, Scene III).

16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how structure shapes Artemidorus's letter. Key takeaway: one more warning that fails.

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Structure:** Artemidorus reads his warning letter to the audience.
- **Dramatic irony:** We know he will not be heard.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and omens:** one more warning that fails.

Symbols and motifs

- **warnings ignored:** Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: "Enter Artemidorus, reading a paper" (Act II, Scene III).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Caesar, beware of Brutus; take heed of Cassius" (Act II, Scene III, Artemidorus) The letter.
- "If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live" (Act II, Scene III) Artemidorus's hope.
- "My heart laments that virtue cannot live / Out of the teeth of emulation" (Act II, Scene III) Envy kills virtue.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved.
Evidence: "If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live" (Act II, Scene III)
Reasoning: "If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live," he says, and the audience knows Caesar will not read it.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
emulation (noun)	envious rivalry	*My heart laments that virtue cannot live Out of the teeth of emulation.*	"emulation": Origin: Middle French émulation; earlier Latin aemulātiō. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/emulation#Etymology)
laments (verb)	grieves	*My heart laments that virtue cannot live Out of the teeth of emulation.*	
contrive (verb)	to plot	*If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live; If not, the Fates with traitors do contrive.*	
security (noun)	overconfidence; a false sense of safety		

		If thou beest not immortal, look about you: security gives way to conspiracy.	
immortal (adjective)	unable to die	*If thou beest not immortal, look about you: security gives way to conspiracy.*	"immortal": Origin: Latin immortālis. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/immortal#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Why do stories often add near-misses just before a disaster?
2. Where does structure appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with honor and self-deception?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Which conspirators does Artemidorus name in his letter? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Brutus, Cassius, Casca, Cinna, Trebonius, Metellus Cimber, Decius Brutus and Ligarius.
2. What does Artemidorus's letter contain? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The names of the conspirators
3. Where does Artemidorus plan to give Caesar the letter? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In the street as Caesar passes
4. What is Artemidorus's profession? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A teacher of rhetoric
5. What does Artemidorus say about virtue? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: It cannot live out of the teeth of emulation (envy)
6. What does the letter tell Caesar security gives way to? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Conspiracy
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Artemidorus, a teacher of rhetoric, reads aloud a letter he has written naming the conspirators and warning Caesar to look about him. He plans to stand in the street and hand it to Caesar on the way to the Capitol, lamenting that virtue cannot live out of reach of envy.
8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act II, Scene III" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.

10. Reread: “My heart laments that virtue cannot live Out of the teeth of emulation.” What does “emulation” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: emulation: envious rivalry.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the letter say 'If thou beest not immortal, look about you'? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: It punctures Caesar's godlike self-image: he is mortal and must take care.
2. What does “Act II, Scene III” suggest about Artemidorus's letter? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The warnings multiply as the moment nears, so the assassination feels both preventable and inevitable.
3. Find one example of structure in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
4. How does the tone / mood in this scene shape what we understand about Artemidorus's letter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: “Caesar, beware of Brutus; take heed of Cassius” (Act II, Scene III, Artemidorus): The letter. Theme link: one more warning that fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins ““Caesar, beware of Brutus; take heed of Cassius; come not near Casca; have an eye to Cinna; trust not Trebonius; mark well Metellus Cimber: Decius Brutus loves thee not: thou hast…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Artemidorus, a teacher of rhetoric, reads aloud a letter he has written naming the conspirators and warning Caesar to look about him. He plans to stand in the street and hand it to Caesar on the way to the Capitol, lamenting that virtue cannot live out of reach of envy.
7. How does “Act II, Scene III” build on “Act II, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: “If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live” (Act II, Scene III): Artemidorus's hope. On structure: Artemidorus reads his warning letter to the audience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: “My heart laments that virtue cannot live / Out of the teeth of emulation” (Act II, Scene III): Envy kills virtue. Theme link: one more warning that fails. Credit

any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: "Why do stories often add near-misses just before a disaster?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with honor and self-deception? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: "Caesar, beware of Brutus; take heed of Cassius" (Act II, Scene III, Artemidorus): The letter. Theme link: one more warning that fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. If Caesar had read the letter, would the play's events have been different? What does this scene suggest about chance? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Accept arguments for chance, character, and fate.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: "If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live" (Act II, Scene III): Artemidorus's hope. Theme link: one more warning that fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: "The warnings multiply as the moment nears, so the assassination feels both preventable and inevitable." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: "My heart laments that virtue cannot live / Out of the teeth of emulation" (Act II, Scene III): Envy kills virtue. Theme link: one more warning that fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: "Caesar, beware of Brutus; take heed of Cassius" (Act II, Scene III, Artemidorus): The letter. Theme link: one more warning that fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing "Act II, Scene III". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Artemidorus's letter. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: "If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live" (Act II, Scene III): Artemidorus's hope. On structure: Artemidorus reads his warning letter to the audience. Credit any

position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: “My heart laments that virtue cannot live / Out of the teeth of emulation” (Act II, Scene III): Envy kills virtue. Theme link: one more warning that fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to rhetoric and persuasion: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: “Caesar, beware of Brutus; take heed of Cassius” (Act II, Scene III, Artemidorus): The letter. Theme link: one more warning that fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the structure in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: “If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live” (Act II, Scene III): Artemidorus's hope. On structure: Artemidorus reads his warning letter to the audience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act II, Scene III” treats Artemidorus's letter with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: “My heart laments that virtue cannot live / Out of the teeth of emulation” (Act II, Scene III): Envy kills virtue. Theme link: one more warning that fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act II, Scene IV” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: “Caesar, beware of Brutus; take heed of Cassius” (Act II, Scene III, Artemidorus): The letter. Theme link: one more warning that fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Artemidorus's letter? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: "If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live" (Act II, Scene III): Artemidorus's hope. Theme link: one more warning that fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Structure:** look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene III, Artemidorus: "Caesar, beware of Brutus; take heed of _____"

   Key: Cassius

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the letter tell Caesar security gives way to?

   A. Fortune

   B. Conspiracy

   C. Tyranny

   D. Death

   Key: B (Conspiracy)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live; If not, the Fates with traitors do contrive.", what does "contrive" most nearly mean?

   A. to foretell

   B. to plot

   C. restoration of a citizen's rights

   D. wicked; good-for-nothing

   Key: B (to plot)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Artemidorus's letter contain?

   A. A love poem

   B. A request for money

   C. The names of the conspirators

   D. A prophecy

   Key: C (The names of the conspirators)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene III: "My heart laments that virtue cannot live / Out of the teeth of _____"

   Key: emulation

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does Artemidorus plan to give Caesar the letter?

   A. At the feast

   B. In the street as Caesar passes

C. At Caesar's house

D. In the Senate

Key: B (In the street as Caesar passes)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Artemidorus say about virtue?

   A. It cannot live out of the teeth of emulation (envy)

   B. It is rare in Rome

   C. It always wins

   D. It is weakness

   Key: A (It cannot live out of the teeth of emulation (envy))

8. [short · recall · DOK 1] Which conspirators does Artemidorus name in his letter?

   Sample answer: Brutus, Cassius, Casca, Cinna, Trebonius, Metellus Cimber, Decius Brutus and Ligarius.

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is Artemidorus's profession?

   A. A senator

   B. A soldier

   C. A teacher of rhetoric

   D. A priest

   Key: C (A teacher of rhetoric)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does the letter say 'If thou beest not immortal, look about you'?

    Sample answer: It punctures Caesar's godlike self-image: he is mortal and must take care.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act II, Scene III”?

    A. The death of Cassius

    B. Cinna the poet

    C. The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost

    D. Artemidorus's letter

    Key: D (Artemidorus's letter)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Caesar, beware of Brutus; take heed of Cassius” (Act II, Scene III, Artemidorus)

    A. Cassius's image of Caesar's size and his own smallness.

    B. Marullus's contempt for the crowd.

    C. Reducing the will.

    D. The letter.

    Key: D (The letter.)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live” (Act II, Scene III)

    A. Artemidorus's hope.

    B. Reducing the will.

    C. Brutus's balanced antithesis.

    D. Antony's tribute.

    Key: A (Artemidorus's hope.)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live” (Act II, Scene III).
    Sample answer: "If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live," he says, and the audience knows Caesar will not read it.
15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “My heart laments that virtue cannot live / Out of the teeth of emulation” (Act II, Scene III). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Envy kills virtue.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live” (Act II, Scene III) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Artemidorus's hope.
17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene III: “If thou read this, O _____, thou mayst live”
    Key: Caesar
18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “My heart laments that virtue cannot live Out of the teeth of emulation.”, what does “laments” most nearly mean?
    A. grieves
    B. very poor people who ask for money
    C. deadened; numb as if dead
    D. victory
    Key: A (grieves)
19. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live” (Act II, Scene III) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Artemidorus's hope.
20. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene III”? We know he will not be heard.
    A. Characterization
    B. Allusion
    C. Dramatic irony
    D. Simile
    Key: C (Dramatic irony)
21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene III”? Artemidorus reads his warning letter to the audience.
    A. Theme
    B. Tone / mood
    C. Structure
    D. Imagery
    Key: C (Structure)
22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: "If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live," he says, and the audience knows Caesar will not read it.

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “My heart laments that virtue cannot live / Out of the teeth of emulation” (Act II, Scene III)

    A. His plea.

    B. The tribunes' metaphor of limiting Caesar's power.

    C. Envy kills virtue.

    D. Titinius.

    Key: C (Envy kills virtue.)

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Caesar, beware of Brutus; take heed of Cassius” (Act II, Scene III, Artemidorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The letter.

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] If Caesar had read the letter, would the play's events have been different? What does this scene suggest about chance?

    Sample answer: Accept arguments for chance, character, and fate.

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “If thou beest not immortal, look about you: security gives way to conspiracy.”, what does “security” most nearly mean?

    A. overconfidence; a false sense of safety

    B. showy display

    C. imagination

    D. married; having a husband

    Key: A (overconfidence; a false sense of safety)

27. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “If thou beest not _____, look about you: security gives way to conspiracy.” Word bank: immortal, contrive, laments, emulation

    Key: immortal

28. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Caesar, beware of Brutus; take heed of Cassius” (Act II, Scene III, Artemidorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The letter.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how fate and omens develops from an earlier scene to “Act II, Scene III”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: one more warning that fails.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	2, 5, 1, 17, 8, 4, 18, 6, 11, 13, 19, 12, 15, 20, 21, 22	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	18, 9, 5, 7, 1, 17, 23, 11, 19, 13, 12, 20, 14, 21, 24, 25	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	17, 26, 5, 9, 27, 19, 28, 23, 10, 12, 21, 15, 14, 20, 25, 22	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	27, 1, 6, 8, 11, 12, 19, 28, 10, 15, 14, 21, 20, 25, 29, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	1, 18, 27, 12, 19, 11, 13, 15, 20, 21, 14, 22, 25, 29, 16, 24	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5

College Freshman	27, 1, 3, 12, 13, 19, 28, 15, 14, 20, 21, 24, 25, 22, 16, 29	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	27, 1, 11, 23, 28, 13, 12, 14, 15, 21, 20, 25, 22, 29, 16, 24	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Junior	27, 1, 11, 23, 28, 19, 13, 14, 15, 20, 21, 25, 16, 24, 22, 29	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Senior	27, 1, 11, 12, 23, 10, 19, 14, 15, 20, 21, 22, 25, 29, 16, 24	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	27, 1, 13, 12, 28, 19, 23, 14, 15, 21, 20, 24, 16, 29, 22, 25	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene III,” how does Shakespeare show Artemidorus's letter? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the structure you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Act II, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Artemidorus's letter? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the structure in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene III develops the idea of Artemidorus's letter. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its structure shape the reader's understanding of Artemidorus's letter. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene III suggests about Artemidorus's letter. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's structure and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses structure in Act II, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of Artemidorus's letter. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act II, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Artemidorus's letter responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act II, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Artemidorus's letter follows or bends those conventions, using the structure as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene III and its treatment of Artemidorus's letter. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's structure and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about Artemidorus's letter in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Artemidorus's letter. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *My heart laments that virtue cannot live Out of the teeth of emulation.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “emulation” most nearly mean?

   A. overconfidence; a false sense of safety

   B. envious rivalry

   C. unable to die

   D. to plot

2. *“Caesar, beware of Brutus; take heed of Cassius; come not near Casca; have an eye to Cinna; trust not Trebonius; mark well Metellus Cimber: Decius Brutus loves thee not: thou hast wronged Caius Ligarius. There is but one mind in all these men, and it is bent against Caesar. If thou beest not immortal, look about you: security gives way to conspiracy. The mighty gods defend thee! Thy lover, “Artemidorus.”*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act II, Scene III”?

   A. Brutus and Cassius at odds

   B. Artemidorus's letter

   C. Calpurnia's dream

   D. Parley before battle

SAT key: 1. B (envious rivalry); 2. B (Artemidorus's letter)

Lesson 9: Act II, Scene IV

Focus: Portia's anxiety

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “Act II, Scene IV” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Portia, nearly frantic with knowledge of the plot, sends the boy Lucius to the Senate house without being able to say why, then asks him to report how Brutus looks and who comes to Caesar. She questions the soothsayer, who plans to warn Caesar again from a narrow place in the street, and she nearly gives the secret away.

Background: Act II, Scene IV is the last scene before the assassination and the last time Portia appears on stage.

Significance: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of a public plot, and prepares for news of her death in Act IV.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What is it like to carry a secret you cannot share? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to honour and idealism because....
Prompt: What is it like to carry a secret you cannot share?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to honour and idealism because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: befriend — to help; to favor; commend — to send greetings; to recommend; suitors — people who bring a request; bustling — noisy and busy; constancy — firmness of mind. “suitors”: Origin of “suitor”: Anglo-Norman suytour; earlier Late Latin secutor (“follower”).
Words: befriend: to help; to favor · commend: to send greetings; to recommend · suitors: people who bring a request · bustling: noisy and busy · constancy: firmness of mind

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Act II, Scene IV is the last scene before the assassination and the last time Portia appears on stage. Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of a public plot, and prepares for news of her death in Act IV. Characterization: Portia's anxiety: she sends Lucius to the Capitol without an errand. Characterization: She knows the secret and struggles to hide it. Watch for omens and portents: Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: "Enter the Soothsayer" (Act II, Scene IV).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "I have a man's mind, but a woman's might" slowly and put it in my own words: Waiting anxiously for news, Portia says she has a man's mind but a woman's strength. Next, craft. I notice the contrast between "mind" and "might," two words that sound alike but mean thought and power. The strongest word is "might": it means physical strength or power, which she lacks as a woman in Rome. Then, effect. What does Portia's line reveal about her situation? My answer: Portia's line reveals her situation: she has a man's mind but a woman's might, so she understands the conspiracy but cannot act; her helpless anxiety shows the cost of the plot on those who must wait.

> *I have a man's mind, but a woman's might* (Act II, Scene IV, Portia)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "I have a man's mind, but a woman's might" slowly and put it in my own words: Waiting anxiously for news, Portia says she has a man's mind but a woman's strength. Next, craft. I notice the contrast between "mind" and "might," two words that sound alike but mean thought and power. The strongest word is "might": it means physical strength or power, which she lacks as a woman in Rome. Then, effect. What does Portia's line reveal about her situation? My answer: Portia's line reveals her situation: she has a man's mind but a woman's might, so she understands the conspiracy but cannot act; her helpless anxiety shows the cost of the plot on those who must wait.

40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Her self-criticism. Look at the craft: She knows the secret and struggles to hide it. Ask: How does this line connect to honour and idealism? Expected: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. (Her self-criticism.)

> *How hard it is for women to keep counsel* (Act II, Scene IV, Portia)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Her self-criticism. Look at the craft: She knows the secret and struggles to hide it.
Ask: How does this line connect to honour and idealism?
Expected answer: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. (Her self-criticism.)

50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Portia's anxiety? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene IV develops the idea of Portia's anxiety. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. When the text says "I have a man's mind, but a woman's might" (Act II, Scene IV, Portia), it shows this directly. She says "I have a man's mind, but a woman's might," wanting to act but unable.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Portia's anxiety? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene IV develops the idea of Portia's anxiety. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. When the text says "I have a man's mind, but a woman's might" (Act II, Scene IV, Portia), it shows this directly. She says "I have a man's mind, but a woman's might," wanting to act but unable.

55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What is it like to carry a secret you cannot share? Ask: what does Portia's scene add to the play?
Anchor question: What is it like to carry a secret you cannot share?
Facilitation: Ask: what does Portia's scene add to the play?

60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Portia's anxiety? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. ("I have a man's mind, but a woman's might", Act II, Scene IV, Portia). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Portia's anxiety? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. ("I have a man's mind, but a woman's might", Act II, Scene IV, Portia). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Portia's anxiety. Key takeaway: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets.

Total: 70 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Portia's anxiety: she sends Lucius to the Capitol without an errand.
- **Characterization:** She knows the secret and struggles to hide it.

Themes and how they develop

- **honour and idealism:** Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets.

Symbols and motifs

- **omens and portents:** Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: “Enter the Soothsayer” (Act II, Scene IV).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “I have a man’s mind, but a woman’s might” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia) Portia's frustration.
- “How hard it is for women to keep counsel” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia) Her self-criticism.
- “Ay me, how weak a thing / The heart of woman is” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia) Her fear.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause.
Evidence: “I have a man’s mind, but a woman’s might” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia)
Reasoning: She says "I have a man's mind, but a woman's might," wanting to act but unable.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
befriend (verb)	to help; to favor	*That I have, lady: if it will please Caesar To be so good to Caesar as to hear me, I shall beseech him to befriend himself.*	
commend (verb)	to send greetings; to recommend	*Run, Lucius, and commend me to my lord; Say I am merry: come to me again, And bring me word what he doth say to thee.*	
suitors (noun)	people who bring a request	*Yes, bring me word, boy, if thy lord look well, For he went sickly forth: and take good note What Caesar doth, what suitors press to him.*	“suitors”: Origin of “suitor”: Anglo-Norman suytour; earlier Late Latin secutor (“follower”). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/suitor#Etymology)
bustling (adjective)	noisy and busy		

		Prithee, listen well; I heard a bustling rumour, like a fray, And the wind brings it from the Capitol.	
constancy (noun)	firmness of mind	*O constancy, be strong upon my side, Set a huge mountain 'tween my heart and tongue!*	

Discussion questions

1. What is it like to carry a secret you cannot share?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with rhetoric and persuasion?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Portia ask Lucius to report back? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Whether Brutus looks well (he went out sickly), what Caesar does and who presses toward him.
2. Where does Portia send Lucius? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To the Senate house
3. Why can't Portia explain the errand to Lucius? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She must not reveal the plot
4. Whom does Portia meet in the street? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The soothsayer
5. What does the soothsayer plan to do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Speak to Caesar as he passes
6. What does Portia say about a woman's heart? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: It is weak
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene IV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Portia, nearly frantic with knowledge of the plot, sends the boy Lucius to the Senate house without being able to say why, then asks him to report how Brutus looks and who comes to Caesar. She questions the soothsayer, who plans to warn Caesar again from a narrow place in the street, and she nearly gives the secret away.
8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene IV", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

9. Where and when does “Act II, Scene IV” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “That I have, lady: if it will please Caesar To be so good to Caesar as to hear me, I shall beseech him to befriend himself.” What does “befriend” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: befriend: to help; to favor.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does Portia's behavior suggest about the burden Brutus has shared with her? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: The secret torments her; she can barely hide it.
2. What does “Act II, Scene IV” suggest about Portia's anxiety? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of a public plot, and prepares for news of her death in Act IV.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the tone / mood in this scene shape what we understand about Portia's anxiety? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “I have a man’s mind, but a woman’s might” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia): Portia's frustration. Theme link: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “I would have had thee there, and here again, Ere I can tell thee what thou shouldst do there.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene IV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Portia, nearly frantic with knowledge of the plot, sends the boy Lucius to the Senate house without being able to say why, then asks him to report how Brutus looks and who comes to Caesar. She questions the soothsayer, who plans to warn Caesar again from a narrow place in the street, and she nearly…
7. How does “Act II, Scene IV” build on “Act II, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “How hard it is for women to keep counsel” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia): Her self-criticism. Theme link: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “Ay me, how weak a thing / The heart of woman is” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia): Her

fear. On characterization: She knows the secret and struggles to hide it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “What is it like to carry a secret you cannot share?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with rhetoric and persuasion? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “I have a man’s mind, but a woman’s might” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia): Portia's frustration. Theme link: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Portia calls a woman's heart weak, though she wounded herself to prove her strength. How do you read this contradiction? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Accept answers on period gender norms and on strain under pressure.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “How hard it is for women to keep counsel” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia): Her self-criticism. Theme link: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of a public plot, and prepares for news of her death in Act IV.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “Ay me, how weak a thing / The heart of woman is” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia): Her fear. Theme link: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “I have a man’s mind, but a woman’s might” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia): Portia's frustration. On characterization: She knows the secret and struggles to hide it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act II, Scene IV”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Portia's anxiety. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “How hard it is for women to keep counsel” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia): Her self-criticism. Theme link: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “Ay me, how weak a thing / The heart of woman is” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia): Her fear. Theme link: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to public versus private self: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “I have a man’s mind, but a woman’s might” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia): Portia's frustration. Theme link: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “How hard it is for women to keep counsel” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia): Her self-criticism. On characterization: She knows the secret and struggles to hide it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act II, Scene IV” treats Portia's anxiety with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “Ay me, how weak a thing / The heart of woman is” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia): Her fear. Theme link: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act III, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “I have a man’s mind, but a woman’s might” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia): Portia's frustration. Theme link: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Portia's anxiety? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “How hard it is for women to keep counsel” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia): Her self-criticism. Theme link: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Portia say about a woman's heart?

   A. It cannot love

   B. It is weak

   C. It is as strong as a man's

   D. It is never afraid

   Key: B (It is weak)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why can't Portia explain the errand to Lucius?

   A. She has forgotten it

   B. She does not trust him

   C. She is ill

   D. She must not reveal the plot

   Key: D (She must not reveal the plot)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "O _____, be strong upon my side, Set a huge mountain 'tween my heart and tongue!" Word bank: befriend, commend, constancy, suitors

   Key: constancy

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whom does Portia meet in the street?

   A. The soothsayer

   B. Calpurnia

   C. Artemidorus

   D. Casca

   Key: A (The soothsayer)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Prithee, listen well; I heard a bustling rumour, like a fray, And the wind brings it from the Capitol.", what does "bustling" most nearly mean?

   A. noisy and busy

   B. internal organs (of a sacrificed animal)

   C. meant; shown

   D. crying out with a high scream

   Key: A (noisy and busy)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Yes, bring me word, boy, if thy lord look well, For he went sickly forth: and take good note What Caesar doth, what suitors press to him.", what does "suitors" most nearly mean?

   A. to take into service

   B. people who bring a request

C. to declare publicly

D. a wreath worn as a sign of victory

Key: B (people who bring a request)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Run, Lucius, and commend me to my lord; Say I am merry: come to me again, And bring me word what he doth say to thee.”, what does “commend” most nearly mean?

   A. to foretell

   B. to send greetings; to recommend

   C. stained red with blood

   D. closely united (with the plot)

   Key: B (to send greetings; to recommend)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the soothsayer plan to do?

   A. Warn Brutus

   B. Speak to Caesar as he passes

   C. Leave Rome

   D. Join the conspirators

   Key: B (Speak to Caesar as he passes)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act II, Scene IV, Portia: “How hard it is for women to keep _____”

   Key: counsel

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act II, Scene IV”?

    A. Portia's anxiety

    B. The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost

    C. The assassination

    D. Brutus and Cassius at odds

    Key: A (Portia's anxiety)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I have a man’s mind, but a woman’s might” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia)

    A. Antony's opening.

    B. Portia's frustration.

    C. Cassius notes it is his birthday: the day of birth may be the day of death.

    D. Young Cato.

    Key: B (Portia's frustration.)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I have a man’s mind, but a woman’s might” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Portia's frustration.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Ay me, how weak a thing / The heart of woman is” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia)

    A. Brutus's concern for appearance.

    B. Her fear.

    C. The tribunes' metaphor of limiting Caesar's power.

D. Brutus's last words.

Key: B (Her fear.)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Ay me, how weak a thing / The heart of woman is” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Her fear.
15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “I have a man’s mind, but a woman’s might” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia).
    Sample answer: She says "I have a man's mind, but a woman's might," wanting to act but unable.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “How hard it is for women to keep counsel” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Her self-criticism.
17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “That I have, lady: if it will please Caesar To be so good to Caesar as to hear me, I shall beseech him to befriend himself.”, what does “befriend” most nearly mean?
    A. slavery; captivity
    B. explained; interpreted
    C. to help; to favor
    D. condemning people to death by public list

    Key: C (to help; to favor)
18. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “How hard it is for women to keep counsel” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Her self-criticism.
19. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene IV”? She knows the secret and struggles to hide it.
    A. Characterization
    B. Theme
    C. Tone / mood
    D. Irony

    Key: A (Characterization)
20. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene IV”? Portia's anxiety: she sends Lucius to the Capitol without an errand.
    A. Simile
    B. Imagery
    C. Structure
    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)
21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how honour and idealism develops from an earlier scene to “Act II, Scene IV”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets.
22. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does Portia send Lucius?
    A. To Antony

B. To the market

C. To the Senate house

D. To Cassius's home

Key: C (To the Senate house)

23. [short · inference · DOK 2] What does Portia's behavior suggest about the burden Brutus has shared with her?
Sample answer: The secret torments her; she can barely hide it.

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Portia calls a woman's heart weak, though she wounded herself to prove her strength. How do you read this contradiction?
Sample answer: Accept answers on period gender norms and on strain under pressure.

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “How hard it is for women to keep counsel” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia)

A. Caesar's courage or pride.

B. Her self-criticism.

C. His last words in the play (see the intro flag on their history).

D. The proscription.

Key: B (Her self-criticism.)

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
Sample answer: She says "I have a man's mind, but a woman's might," wanting to act but unable.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I have a man’s mind, but a woman’s might” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Portia's frustration.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	6, 8, 9, 7, 3, 5, 4, 17, 18, 13, 10, 12, 14, 19, 20, 21	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	3, 9, 1, 8, 17, 22, 23, 18, 10, 13, 12, 15, 19, 14, 16, 24	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	3, 9, 6, 22, 8, 11, 10, 25, 18, 12, 14, 20, 19, 15, 26, 21	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	3, 5, 9, 22, 12, 23, 25, 18, 13, 14, 15, 19, 20, 24, 26, 27	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	1, 3, 9, 18, 25, 12, 13, 20, 15, 19, 14, 21, 26, 16, 24, 27	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Freshman	9, 3, 2, 23, 25, 10, 13, 20, 15, 19, 14, 26, 24, 27, 16, 21	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	9, 3, 18, 10, 25, 23, 13, 14, 19, 20, 15, 16, 26, 21, 24, 27	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Junior	3, 9, 11, 18, 13, 23, 12, 20, 19, 14, 15, 26, 16, 27, 24, 21	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Senior	3, 9, 10, 11, 23, 12, 25, 15, 20, 14, 19, 26, 16, 27, 24, 21	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	3, 9, 25, 10, 23, 13, 12, 14, 19, 20, 15, 24, 27, 26, 21, 16	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene IV,” how does Shakespeare show Portia's anxiety? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act II, Scene IV, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Portia's anxiety? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene IV develops the idea of Portia's anxiety. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Portia's anxiety. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene IV suggests about Portia's anxiety. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act II, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of Portia's anxiety. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act II, Scene IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Portia's anxiety responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act II, Scene IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Portia's anxiety follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene IV and its treatment of Portia's anxiety. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene IV as evidence for a larger claim about Portia's anxiety in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene IV as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Portia's anxiety. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *That I have, lady: if it will please Caesar To be so good to Caesar as to hear me, I shall beseech him to befriend himself.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “befriend” most nearly mean?

   A. to help; to favor

   B. noisy and busy

   C. firmness of mind

   D. people who bring a request

2. *I would have had thee there, and here again, Ere I can tell thee what thou shouldst do there. O constancy, be strong upon my side, Set a huge mountain 'tween my heart and tongue! I have a man's mind, but a woman's might. How hard it is for women to keep counsel! Art thou here yet?*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act II, Scene IV”?

   A. Portia's anxiety

   B. The triumvirs' proscription list

   C. The assassination

   D. The death of Cassius

SAT key: 1. A (to help; to favor); 2. A (Portia's anxiety)

Lesson 10: Act III, Scene I

Focus: the assassination

Objective: Students will analyze how conflict develops in “Act III, Scene I” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (assassination, blood): Caesar is stabbed on stage and the conspirators bathe their hands in his blood. Focus on how each side names the act (sacrifice, murder, liberty).
Student preview: This scene shows a political killing on stage.
Suggested language: “Why do the conspirators want blood on their hands in public?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Caesar brushes aside the soothsayer ('the ides of March are come') and refuses to read Artemidorus's letter first. Trebonius draws Antony away. Metellus Cimber pleads for his banished brother; Caesar refuses, calling himself 'constant as the northern star.' Casca strikes first; the others stab; Brutus strikes last ('Et tu, Brute? Then fall, Caesar!'). The conspirators bathe their hands in Caesar's blood and cry liberty. Antony sends a servant, then comes himself, shakes their bloody hands and asks to speak at the funeral. Brutus agrees over Cassius's objection, on condition that Antony speaks after him and does not blame them. Alone, Antony prophesies civil war ('Cry Havoc, and let slip the dogs of war'). News comes that Octavius is near Rome.

Background: The real assassination took place on 15 March 44 BC in the Theatre of Pompey, where the Senate was meeting; Shakespeare sets it at the Capitol. The words 'Et tu, Brute?' come from earlier English tradition, not Plutarch.

Significance: The climax comes at the midpoint of the play. Brutus's second mistake (letting Antony speak) turns the play from a story of conspiracy into one of revenge.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might a story place its most famous event in the middle rather than at the end? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to power and ambition because.... Content note before we start: This scene shows a political killing on stage.
Prompt: Why might a story place its most famous event in the middle rather than at the end?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to power and ambition because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: purpled — stained red with blood; enfranchisement — restoration of a citizen's rights; doomsday — the day of final judgment; the end of the world; pulpits — platforms for public speaking; abridged — shortened.
Words: purpled: stained red with blood · enfranchisement: restoration of a citizen's rights · doomsday: the day of final judgment; the end of the world · pulpits: platforms for public speaking · abridged: shortened

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The real assassination took place on 15 March 44 BC in the Theatre of Pompey, where the Senate was meeting; Shakespeare sets it at the Capitol. The words 'Et tu, Brute?' come from earlier English tradition, not Plutarch. The climax comes at the midpoint of the play. Brutus's second mistake (letting Antony speak) turns the play from a story of conspiracy into one of revenge. Characterization: Caesar compares himself to the "northern star," refusing a petition moments before he is stabbed; "Et tu, Brute? Then fall, Caesar!" Structure: The assassination is the play's centre; afterwards Brutus mistakes Antony's grief for a negotiation and lets him speak at the funeral. Soliloquy: Alone with the body, Antony prophesies "Cry 'Havoc,' and let slip the dogs of war." Watch for warnings ignored: Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: "He did receive his letters, and is coming; / And bid me say to you by word" (Act III, Scene I, Servant).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "But I am constant as the northern star" slowly and put it in my own words: Refusing to pardon Metellus's brother, Caesar declares he is as constant as the northern star. Next, craft. I notice the boastful comparison of himself to a fixed star that never moves. The strongest word is "constant": it means unchanging, which he presents as a godlike virtue. Then, effect. What does Caesar's comparison show moments before his death? My answer: Caesar's comparison of himself to the constant northern star shows his arrogance moments before his death; the line makes his fall look like the punishment of pride.

> *But I am constant as the northern star (Act III, Scene I, Caesar)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "But I am constant as the northern star" slowly and put it in my own words: Refusing to pardon Metellus's brother, Caesar declares he is as constant as the northern star. Next, craft. I notice the boastful comparison of himself to a fixed star that never moves. The strongest word is "constant": it means unchanging, which he presents as a godlike virtue. Then, effect. What does Caesar's comparison show moments before his death? My answer: Caesar's comparison of himself to the constant northern star shows his arrogance moments before his death; the line makes his fall look like the punishment of pride.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Havoc" was the order for soldiers to loot and kill without mercy; "dogs of war" personifies war as hounds. The assassination has unleashed chaos. Expected link: power and ambition. Ask: How does this line connect to power and ambition? Expected: Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star." (Antony's prophecy of civil war.)

> *Cry “Havoc,” and let slip the dogs of war* (Act III, Scene I, Antony)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Havoc" was the order for soldiers to loot and kill without mercy; "dogs of war" personifies war as hounds. The assassination has unleashed chaos. Expected link: power and ambition.
Ask: How does this line connect to power and ambition?
Expected answer: Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star." (Antony's prophecy of civil war.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the assassination? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene I develops the idea of the assassination. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. When the text says “Cry “Havoc,” and let slip the dogs of war” (Act III, Scene I, Antony), it shows this directly. Caesar dies with "Et tu, Brute?", making Brutus's betrayal the deepest wound, and as soon as Antony is alone he vows to "let slip the dogs of war," the opposite of the peace Brutus hoped for.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the assassination? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene I develops the idea of the assassination. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. When the text says “Cry “Havoc,” and let slip the dogs of war” (Act III, Scene I, Antony), it shows this directly. Caesar dies with "Et tu, Brute?", making Brutus's betrayal the deepest wound, and as soon as Antony is alone he vows to "let slip the dogs of war," the opposite of the peace Brutus hoped for.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why might a story place its most famous event in the middle rather than at the end? Ask: was Brutus right to let Antony speak? Use Cassius's objection.
Anchor question: Why might a story place its most famous event in the middle rather than at the end?
Facilitation: Ask: was Brutus right to let Antony speak? Use Cassius's objection.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the assassination? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. ("Cry "Havoc," and let slip the dogs of war", Act III, Scene I, Antony). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the assassination? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. ("Cry "Havoc," and let slip the dogs of war", Act III, Scene I, Antony). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the assassination. Key takeaway: Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star."

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Caesar compares himself to the "northern star," refusing a petition moments before he is stabbed; "Et tu, Brute? Then fall, Caesar!"
- **Structure:** The assassination is the play's centre; afterwards Brutus mistakes Antony's grief for a negotiation and lets him speak at the funeral.
- **Soliloquy:** Alone with the body, Antony prophesies "Cry 'Havoc,' and let slip the dogs of war."

Themes and how they develop

- **power and ambition:** Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star."

Symbols and motifs

- **warnings ignored:** Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: "He did receive his letters, and is coming; / And bid me say to you by word" (Act III, Scene I, Servant).
- **omens and portents:** Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: "A crowd of people; among them Artemidorus and the Soothsayer. Flourish. Enter Caesar, Brutus, Cassius, Casca, Decius, Metellus, Trebonius, Cinna, Antony" (Act III, Scene I).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "But I am constant as the northern star" (Act III, Scene I, Caesar) Caesar's hubris just before his death.

- "Et tu, Brute! Then fall, Caesar" (Act III, Scene I, Caesar) His last words in the play (see the intro flag on their history).
- "Cry "Havoc," and let slip the dogs of war" (Act III, Scene I, Antony) Antony's prophecy of civil war.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph.
Evidence: "Cry "Havoc," and let slip the dogs of war" (Act III, Scene I, Antony)
Reasoning: Caesar dies with "Et tu, Brute?", making Brutus's betrayal the deepest wound, and as soon as Antony is alone he vows to "let slip the dogs of war," the opposite of the peace Brutus hoped for.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
purpled (adjective)	stained red with blood	*I do beseech ye, if you bear me hard, Now, whilst your purpled hands do reek and smoke, Fulfil your pleasure.*	
enfranchisement (noun)	restoration of a citizen's rights	*Pardon, Caesar; Caesar, pardon: As low as to thy foot doth Cassius fall, To beg enfranchisement for Publius Cimber.*	
doomsday (noun)	the day of final judgment; the end of the world	*Fled to his house amazed: Men, wives and children stare, cry out and run As it were doomsday.*	
pulpits (noun)	platforms for public speaking	*Some to the common pulpits, and cry out "Liberty, freedom, and enfranchisement!"*	
abridged (verb)	shortened	*Grant that, and then is death a benefit: So are we Caesar's friends, that have abridged His time of fearing death.*	
besmear (verb)	to smear all over	*Stoop, Romans, stoop, And let us bathe our hands in Caesar's blood Up to the elbows, and besmear our swords: Then walk we forth, even to the market-place, And, waving our red weapons o'er our heads, Let's all cry "Peace, freedom and liberty!"*	"besmear": Origin: an English formation from be- + smear. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/besmear#Etymology)
fawning (verb)	flattering like a dog	*Be not fond, To think that Caesar bears such rebel blood That will be thaw'd from the true quality With that which melteth fools; I mean, sweet words, Low-crooked court'sies and base spaniel-fawning.*	
proclaim (verb)	to declare publicly	*Run hence, proclaim, cry it about the streets.*	

funeral (noun)	a ceremony for a dead person	*That's all I seek: And am moreover suitor that I may Produce his body to the market-place; And in the pulpit, as becomes a friend, Speak in the order of his funeral.*	

Discussion questions

1. Why might a story place its most famous event in the middle rather than at the end?
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with public versus private self?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who draws Antony away before the attack? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Trebonius.
2. Who strikes Caesar first? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Casca
3. To what does Caesar compare himself just before the attack? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The northern star
4. Whose banished brother does Metellus Cimber plead for? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: His own
5. What condition does Brutus set on Antony's funeral speech? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He must speak after Brutus and not blame the conspirators
6. What does Antony predict in his soliloquy? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Civil war
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act III, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Caesar brushes aside the soothsayer ('the ides of March are come') and refuses to read Artemidorus's letter first. Trebonius draws Antony away. Metellus Cimber pleads for his banished brother; Caesar refuses, calling himself 'constant as the northern star.' Casca strikes first; the others stab; Brutus strikes last ('Et tu, Brute? Then fall, Caesar!'). The conspirators bathe their hands in…
8. Who is on stage in "Act III, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act III, Scene I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.

10. Reread: “I do beseech ye, if you bear me hard, Now, whilst your purpled hands do reek and smoke, Fulfil your pleasure.” What does “purpled” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: purpled: stained red with blood.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Antony shake each conspirator's bloody hand? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: To appear reconciled and win the chance to speak at the funeral.
2. What does “Act III, Scene I” suggest about the assassination? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The climax comes at the midpoint of the play. Brutus's second mistake (letting Antony speak) turns the play from a story of conspiracy into one of revenge.
3. Find one example of conflict in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the assassination? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “But I am constant as the northern star” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar): Caesar's hubris just before his death. On characterization: Caesar compares himself to the "northern star," refusing a petition moments before he is stabbed; "Et tu, Brute? Then fall, Caesar!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “I must prevent thee, Cimber.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Caesar brushes aside the soothsayer ('the ides of March are come') and refuses to read Artemidorus's letter first. Trebonius draws Antony away. Metellus Cimber pleads for his banished brother; Caesar refuses, calling himself 'constant as the northern star.' Casca strikes first; the others stab;…
7. How does “Act III, Scene I” build on “Act II, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “Et tu, Brute! Then fall, Caesar” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar): His last words in the play (see the intro flag on their history). On structure: The assassination is the play's centre; afterwards Brutus mistakes Antony's grief for a negotiation and lets him speak at the funeral. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “Cry “Havoc,” and let slip the dogs of war” (Act III, Scene I,

Antony): Antony's prophecy of civil war. On characterization: Caesar compares himself to the "northern star," refusing a petition moments before he is stabbed; "Et tu, Brute? Then fall, Caesar!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might a story place its most famous event in the middle rather than at the end?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with public versus private self? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “But I am constant as the northern star” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar): Caesar's hubris just before his death. On structure: The assassination is the play's centre; afterwards Brutus mistakes Antony's grief for a negotiation and lets him speak at the funeral. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Cassius predicts letting Antony speak is a mistake. Was Brutus's decision noble, naive, or both? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Strong answers weigh Brutus's honor against political judgment.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “Et tu, Brute! Then fall, Caesar” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar): His last words in the play (see the intro flag on their history). Theme link: Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The climax comes at the midpoint of the play. Brutus's second mistake (letting Antony speak) turns the play from a story of conspiracy into one of revenge.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “Cry “Havoc,” and let slip the dogs of war” (Act III, Scene I, Antony): Antony's prophecy of civil war. Theme link: Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “But I am constant as the northern star” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar): Caesar's hubris just before his death. On characterization: Caesar compares himself to the "northern star," refusing a petition moments before he is stabbed; "Et tu, Brute? Then fall, Caesar!" Credit

any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act III, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the assassination. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “Et tu, Brute! Then fall, Caesar” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar): His last words in the play (see the intro flag on their history). On structure: The assassination is the play's centre; afterwards Brutus mistakes Antony's grief for a negotiation and lets him speak at the funeral. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “Cry “Havoc,” and let slip the dogs of war” (Act III, Scene I, Antony): Antony's prophecy of civil war. Theme link: Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate, omens and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “But I am constant as the northern star” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar): Caesar's hubris just before his death. Theme link: Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the conflict in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “Et tu, Brute! Then fall, Caesar” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar): His last words in the play (see the intro flag on their history). Theme link: Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act III, Scene I” treats the assassination with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “Cry “Havoc,” and let slip the dogs of war” (Act III, Scene I, Antony): Antony's prophecy of civil war. Theme link: Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act III, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “But I am constant as the northern star” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar): Caesar's hubris just before his death. Theme link: Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the assassination? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “Et tu, Brute! Then fall, Caesar” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar): His last words in the play (see the intro flag on their history). Theme link: Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Some to the common pulpits, and cry out “Liberty, freedom, and enfranchisement!””, what does “pulpits” most nearly mean?
   A. harms; dangers
   B. platforms for public speaking
   C. happened
   D. envious rivalry

   Key: B (platforms for public speaking)
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Grant that, and then is death a benefit: So are we Caesar’s friends, that have _____ His time of fearing death.” Word bank: doomsday, purpled, enfranchisement, abridged
   Key: abridged
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Run hence, _____, cry it about the streets.” Word bank: purpled, doomsday, enfranchisement, proclaim
   Key: proclaim
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Antony predict in his soliloquy?
   A. Peace
   B. Brutus's coronation
   C. Civil war

D. A new king

Key: C (Civil war)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene I, Caesar: “But I am _____ as the northern star”

   Key: constant

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I do beseech ye, if you bear me hard, Now, whilst your purpled hands do reek and smoke, Fulfil your pleasure.”, what does “purpled” most nearly mean?

   A. stained red with blood

   B. to provide for; to equip

   C. young women (informal, period term)

   D. winners in battle

   Key: A (stained red with blood)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Pardon, Caesar; Caesar, pardon: As low as to thy foot doth Cassius fall, To beg enfranchisement for Publius Cimber.”, what does “enfranchisement” most nearly mean?

   A. to give rise to

   B. restoration of a citizen's rights

   C. debating; quarreling

   D. with clothing unfastened

   Key: B (restoration of a citizen's rights)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Fled to his house amazed: Men, wives and children stare, cry out and run As it were doomsday.”, what does “doomsday” most nearly mean?

   A. hot-tempered

   B. the day of final judgment; the end of the world

   C. paid back with punishment

   D. slavery; captivity

   Key: B (the day of final judgment; the end of the world)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whose banished brother does Metellus Cimber plead for?

   A. Cicero's

   B. Brutus's

   C. His own

   D. Antony's

   Key: C (His own)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “But I am constant as the northern star” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Caesar's hubris just before his death.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Cry “Havoc,” and let slip the dogs of war” (Act III, Scene I, Antony)

    A. Brutus's decision.

    B. The letter.

    C. The mob's cruelty.

D. Antony's prophecy of civil war.

Key: D (Antony's prophecy of civil war.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Et tu, Brute! Then fall, Caesar” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar)

A. The proscription.

B. Her self-criticism.

C. Envy kills virtue.

D. His last words in the play (see the intro flag on their history).

Key: D (His last words in the play (see the intro flag on their history).)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Antony shake each conspirator's bloody hand?

Sample answer: To appear reconciled and win the chance to speak at the funeral.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Cry “Havoc,” and let slip the dogs of war” (Act III, Scene I, Antony).

Sample answer: Caesar dies with "Et tu, Brute?", making Brutus's betrayal the deepest wound, and as soon as Antony is alone he vows to "let slip the dogs of war," the opposite of the peace Brutus hoped for.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene I”? The assassination is the play's centre; afterwards Brutus mistakes Antony's grief for a negotiation and lets him speak at the funeral.

A. Irony

B. Plot

C. Setting

D. Structure

Key: D (Structure)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: Caesar dies with "Et tu, Brute?", making Brutus's betrayal the deepest wound, and as soon as Antony is alone he vows to "let slip the dogs of war," the opposite of the peace Brutus hoped for.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What condition does Brutus set on Antony's funeral speech?

A. He must speak after Brutus and not blame the conspirators

B. He must not mention Caesar

C. He must speak first

D. He must speak in Greek

Key: A (He must speak after Brutus and not blame the conspirators)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who strikes Caesar first?

A. Casca

B. Cassius

C. Cinna

D. Brutus

Key: A (Casca)

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Be not fond, To think that Caesar bears such rebel blood That will be thaw’d from the true quality With that which melteth fools; I mean, sweet words, Low-crooked court’sies and base spaniel-_____.” Word bank: purpled, fawning, enfranchisement, doomsday

    Key: fawning

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene I, Caesar: “Et tu, Brute! Then fall, _____”

    Key: Caesar

21. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Et tu, Brute! Then fall, Caesar” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: His last words in the play (see the intro flag on their history).

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act III, Scene I”?

    A. Brutus decides

    B. Young Cato and Lucilius

    C. The tribunes and the fickle crowd

    D. The assassination

    Key: D (The assassination)

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “But I am constant as the northern star” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar)

    A. Caesar's hubris just before his death.

    B. Preventive reasoning.

    C. Portia's frustration.

    D. Cassius's death.

    Key: A (Caesar's hubris just before his death.)

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Cry “Havoc,” and let slip the dogs of war” (Act III, Scene I, Antony). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Antony's prophecy of civil war.

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene I”? Caesar compares himself to the "northern star," refusing a petition moments before he is stabbed; "Et tu, Brute? Then fall, Caesar!"

    A. Foreshadowing

    B. Conflict

    C. Setting

    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Stoop, Romans, stoop, And let us bathe our hands in Caesar’s blood Up to the elbows, and _____ our swords: Then walk we forth, even to the market-place, And, waving our red weapons o’er our heads, Let’s all cry “Peace, freedom and liberty!””

    Word bank: doomsday, purpled, enfranchisement, besmear

    Key: besmear

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “But I am constant as the northern star” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Caesar's hubris just before his death.
28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Cassius predicts letting Antony speak is a mistake. Was Brutus's decision noble, naive, or both?
    Sample answer: Strong answers weigh Brutus's honor against political judgment.
29. [mc · recall · DOK 1] To what does Caesar compare himself just before the attack?
    A. The sun
    B. The northern star
    C. A lion
    D. A mountain
    Key: B (The northern star)
30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Et tu, Brute! Then fall, Caesar” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: His last words in the play (see the intro flag on their history).
31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how power and ambition develops from an earlier scene to “Act III, Scene I”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star."

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 3, 5, 18, 19, 20, 2, 1, 21, 22, 13, 23, 24, 14, 25, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	6, 7, 4, 2, 26, 17, 23, 12, 13, 10, 11, 14, 24, 25, 27, 28	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	2, 26, 18, 8, 29, 10, 11, 13, 12, 21, 14, 24, 25, 15, 30, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	3, 20, 18, 17, 11, 23, 12, 22, 21, 15, 14, 24, 25, 31, 27, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	20, 2, 1, 23, 22, 11, 13, 14, 25, 15, 24, 27, 16, 31, 30, 28	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Freshman	5, 18, 2, 10, 22, 23, 21, 25, 15, 14, 24, 30, 27, 31, 16, 28	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	26, 2, 10, 23, 21, 11, 12, 25, 24, 14, 15, 27, 16, 31, 30, 28	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Junior	2, 20, 13, 23, 11, 10, 21, 25, 15, 24, 14, 31, 28, 30, 27, 16	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Senior	20, 2, 21, 22, 23, 10, 11, 14, 25, 24, 15, 27, 30, 31, 28, 16	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	2, 26, 22, 12, 21, 23, 10, 14, 15, 24, 25, 27, 28, 30, 16, 31	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act III, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show the assassination? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act III, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the assassination? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene I develops the idea of the assassination. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of the assassination. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene I suggests about the assassination. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses conflict in Act III, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of the assassination. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act III, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the assassination responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act III, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the assassination follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene I and its treatment of the assassination. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's conflict and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about the assassination in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the assassination. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *Fled to his house amazed: Men, wives and children stare, cry out and run As it were doomsday.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "doomsday" most nearly mean?

   A. flattering like a dog

   B. to declare publicly

   C. the day of final judgment; the end of the world

   D. a ceremony for a dead person

2. *I must prevent thee, Cimber. These couchings and these lowly courtesies Might fire the blood of ordinary men, And turn pre-ordinance and first decree Into the law of children. Be not fond, To think that Caesar bears such rebel blood That will be thaw'd from the true quality With that which melteth fools; I mean, sweet words, Low-crooked court'sies and base spaniel-fawning. Thy brother by decree is banished: If thou dost bend and pray and fawn for him, I spurn thee like a cur out of my way. Know, Caesar doth not wrong, nor without cause Will he be satisfied.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene I"?

   A. The assassination

   B. The triumvirs' proscription list

   C. The funeral orations

   D. The death of Cassius

SAT key: 1. C (the day of final judgment; the end of the world); 2. A (The assassination)

Lesson 11: Act III, Scene II

Focus: the funeral orations

Objective: Students will analyze how theme develops in “Act III, Scene II” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.2, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Brutus speaks to the plebeians in prose: he loved Caesar, but loved Rome more; Caesar was ambitious, so he killed him. The crowd cheers and even shouts to make Brutus Caesar. Brutus leaves Antony to speak. Antony, in verse, repeats that 'Brutus is an honourable man' until the phrase turns to irony; recalls Caesar refusing the crown; weeps; shows the torn, bloody mantle; and finally reads Caesar's will, which leaves every citizen seventy-five drachmas and his private gardens. The crowd riots to burn the conspirators' houses. Antony hears Octavius is in Rome and that Brutus and Cassius have fled.

Background: Roman funeral orations (laudationes) praised the dead in public. Rhetoric, the study of persuasion, was central to Roman and Elizabethan education; students practiced ethos, pathos and logos.

Significance: This is the play's great study in persuasion. Brutus appeals to reason and his own honor; Antony uses repetition, irony, props, delay and emotion. The crowd's swing shows how rhetoric can move a republic toward violence.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Which persuades you more, a logical argument or an emotional story? Why? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to rhetoric and persuasion because....
Prompt: Which persuades you more, a logical argument or an emotional story? Why?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to rhetoric and persuasion because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: extenuated — played down; made to seem less; withholds — holds back; ransoms — payments to free captives; drachmas — silver coins; disprove — to show to be false. “disprove”: Origin: Old French desprover.
Words: extenuated: played down; made to seem less · withholds: holds back · ransoms: payments to free captives · drachmas: silver coins · disprove: to show to be false

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Roman funeral orations (laudationes) praised the dead in public. Rhetoric, the study of persuasion, was central to Roman and Elizabethan education; students practiced ethos, pathos and logos. This is the play's great study in persuasion. Brutus appeals to reason and his own honor; Antony uses repetition, irony, props, delay and emotion. The crowd's swing shows how rhetoric can move a republic toward violence. Rhetoric: Brutus's speech is in prose, logical and restrained ("Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more"); Antony's is verse, emotional, ironic and dramatic, with the will and the body as props. Irony: Antony's repeated "Brutus is an honourable man" turns praise into accusation. Structure: The crowd's lines show their shifts in real time. Watch for honour: "Honourable" is a key word; Antony turns it into irony in the funeral oration. In this scene: "be silent, that you may hear: believe me for mine honour, and have respect to mine honour, that you may believe: censure" (Act III, Scene II, Brutus).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more" slowly and put it in my own words: Brutus tells the Roman people he did not love Caesar less, but loved Rome more. Next, craft. I notice the balanced sentence, "not that... but that," which sounds fair and reasonable. The strongest word is "Rome": it is the higher cause he claims to serve. Then, effect. How does Brutus justify killing Caesar to the crowd? My answer: Brutus appeals to patriotism and reason, and the crowd cheers him; but his plain logic will be overturned by Antony's emotional speech.

> *Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more (Act III, Scene II, Brutus)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more" slowly and put it in my own words: Brutus tells the Roman people he did not love Caesar less, but loved Rome more. Next, craft. I notice the balanced sentence, "not that... but that," which sounds fair and reasonable. The strongest word is "Rome": it is the higher cause he claims to serve. Then, effect. How does Brutus justify killing Caesar to the crowd? My answer: Brutus appeals to patriotism and reason, and the crowd cheers him; but his plain logic will be overturned by Antony's emotional speech.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The repetition becomes ironic: each time, the evidence against Brutus grows. Rhetoric and persuasion. Ask: How does this line connect to rhetoric and persuasion? Expected: The scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. (The repeated ironic refrain.)

> *For Brutus is an honourable man (Act III, Scene II, Antony)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The repetition becomes ironic: each time, the evidence against Brutus grows. Rhetoric and persuasion.
Ask: How does this line connect to rhetoric and persuasion?
Expected answer: The scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. (The repeated ironic refrain.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for rhetoric, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the funeral orations? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene II develops the idea of the funeral orations. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. When the text says "For Brutus is an honourable man" (Act III, Scene II, Antony), it shows this directly. Brutus rests his case on honour ("I loved Rome more"), so Antony repeats "Brutus is an honourable man" until the phrase sounds false, while showing the wounds and the will to move the crowd.
Task: Annotate the scene for rhetoric, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the funeral orations? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene II develops the idea of the funeral orations. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. When the text says "For Brutus is an honourable man" (Act III, Scene II, Antony), it shows this directly. Brutus rests his case on honour ("I loved Rome more"), so Antony repeats "Brutus is an honourable man" until the phrase sounds false, while showing the wounds and the will to move the crowd.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Which persuades you more, a logical argument or an emotional story? Why? Have students chart the crowd's reactions across the scene.
Anchor question: Which persuades you more, a logical argument or an emotional story? Why?
Facilitation: Have students chart the crowd's reactions across the scene.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the funeral orations? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. ("For Brutus is an honourable man", Act III, Scene II, Antony). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the funeral orations? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. ("For Brutus is an honourable man", Act III, Scene II, Antony). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how rhetoric shapes the funeral orations. Key takeaway: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Rhetoric:** Brutus's speech is in prose, logical and restrained ("Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more"); Antony's is verse, emotional, ironic and dramatic, with the will and the body as props.
- **Irony:** Antony's repeated "Brutus is an honourable man" turns praise into accusation.
- **Structure:** The crowd's lines show their shifts in real time.

Themes and how they develop

- **rhetoric and persuasion:** the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos.

Symbols and motifs

- **honour:** "Honourable" is a key word; Antony turns it into irony in the funeral oration. In this scene: “be silent, that you may hear: believe me for mine honour, and have respect to mine honour, that you may believe: censure” (Act III, Scene II, Brutus).
- **blood:** Blood turns the assassination from sacrifice into butchery; the conspirators bathe their hands in it. In this scene: “dead Caesar’s wounds / And dip their napkins in his sacred blood, / Yea, beg a hair of him for memory, / And, dying, mention” (Act III, Scene II, Antony).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more” (Act III, Scene II, Brutus) Brutus's balanced antithesis.
- “Friends, Romans, countrymen, lend me your ears” (Act III, Scene II, Antony) Antony's opening.
- “For Brutus is an honourable man” (Act III, Scene II, Antony) The repeated ironic refrain.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him.
Evidence: “For Brutus is an honourable man” (Act III, Scene II, Antony)
Reasoning: Brutus rests his case on honour ("I loved Rome more"), so Antony repeats "Brutus is an honourable man" until the phrase sounds false, while showing the wounds and the will to move the crowd.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
extenuated (verb)	played down; made to seem less	*The question of his death is enrolled in the Capitol; his glory not extenuated, wherein he was worthy, nor his offences enforced, for which he suffered death.*	
withholds (verb)	holds back	*You all did love him once, not without cause: What cause withholds you then, to mourn for him?*	
ransoms (noun)	payments to free captives	*He hath brought many captives home to Rome, Whose ransoms did the general coffers fill: Did this in Caesar seem ambitious?*	
drachmas (noun)	silver coins	*To every Roman citizen he gives, To every several man, seventy-five drachmas.*	
disprove (verb)	to show to be false	*I speak not to disprove what Brutus spoke, But here I am to speak what I do know.*	"disprove": Origin: Old French desprover. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/disprove#Etymology)
daggers (noun)	short knives used as weapons	*I have o'ershot myself to tell you of it: I fear I wrong the honourable men Whose daggers have stabb'd Caesar; I do fear it.*	
vesture (noun)	clothing; here, Caesar's cloak	*Kind souls, what, weep you when you but behold Our Caesar's vesture wounded?*	"vesture": Origin: Old French vesteüre; earlier Vulgar Latin vestītūra ("clothing"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/vesture#Etymology)
brutish (adjective)	like a beast; without reason	*O judgment! thou art fled to brutish beasts, And men have lost their reason.*	
villains (noun)	base criminals (here, the citizens mean the conspirators)	*They were villains, murderers: the will! read the will.*	

Discussion questions

1. Which persuades you more, a logical argument or an emotional story? Why?
2. Where does theme appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.

3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate, omens and free will?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Antony say Caesar did when offered the crown three times on the Lupercal? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He refused it each time.
2. Does Brutus speak to the crowd in prose or verse? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Prose
3. What phrase does Antony repeat about Brutus? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Brutus is an honourable man
4. How much money does Caesar's will leave each citizen? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Seventy-five drachmas
5. What does Antony show the crowd? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Caesar's torn mantle and wounds
6. Why did Brutus say he killed Caesar? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Caesar was ambitious
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act III, Scene II” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Brutus speaks to the plebeians in prose: he loved Caesar, but loved Rome more; Caesar was ambitious, so he killed him. The crowd cheers and even shouts to make Brutus Caesar. Brutus leaves Antony to speak. Antony, in verse, repeats that 'Brutus is an honourable man' until the phrase turns to irony; recalls Caesar refusing the crown; weeps; shows the torn, bloody mantle; and finally reads Caesar's…
8. Who is on stage in “Act III, Scene II”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act III, Scene II” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “The question of his death is enrolled in the Capitol; his glory not extenuated, wherein he was worthy, nor his offences enforced, for which he suffered death.” What does “extenuated” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: extenuated: played down; made to seem less.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Antony hold back the will until late in the speech? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: To build curiosity and anger so its reading sets off the riot.

2. What does “Act III, Scene II” suggest about the funeral orations? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: This is the play's great study in persuasion. Brutus appeals to reason and his own honor; Antony uses repetition, irony, props, delay and emotion. The crowd's swing shows how rhetoric can move a republic toward violence.
3. Find one example of theme in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the funeral orations? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more” (Act III, Scene II, Brutus): Brutus's balanced antithesis. Theme link: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Then none have I offended.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Brutus speaks to the plebeians in prose: he loved Caesar, but loved Rome more; Caesar was ambitious, so he killed him. The crowd cheers and even shouts to make Brutus Caesar. Brutus leaves Antony to speak. Antony, in verse, repeats that 'Brutus is an honourable man' until the phrase turns to irony;…
7. How does “Act III, Scene II” build on “Act III, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “Friends, Romans, countrymen, lend me your ears” (Act III, Scene II, Antony): Antony's opening. On structure: The crowd's lines show their shifts in real time. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “For Brutus is an honourable man” (Act III, Scene II, Antony): The repeated ironic refrain. Theme link: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Which persuades you more, a logical argument or an emotional story? Why?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate, omens and free will? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more” (Act III, Scene II, Brutus): Brutus's balanced antithesis. On structure: The crowd's lines show their shifts in real time. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Antony's speech honest? Separate true statements from manipulations. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: True facts (refused crown, the will) serve a manipulative design.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “Friends, Romans, countrymen, lend me your ears” (Act III, Scene II, Antony): Antony's opening. Theme link: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “This is the play's great study in persuasion. Brutus appeals to reason and his own honor; Antony uses repetition, irony, props, delay and emotion. The crowd's swing shows how rhetoric can move a republic toward violence.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “For Brutus is an honourable man” (Act III, Scene II, Antony): The repeated ironic refrain. Theme link: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more” (Act III, Scene II, Brutus): Brutus's balanced antithesis. Theme link: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act III, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the funeral orations. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “Friends, Romans, countrymen, lend me your ears” (Act III, Scene II, Antony): Antony's opening. On structure: The crowd's lines show their shifts in real time. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “For Brutus is an honourable man” (Act III, Scene II, Antony): The repeated ironic refrain. Theme link: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to power, ambition and tyranny: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more” (Act III, Scene II, Brutus): Brutus's balanced antithesis. Theme link: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the theme in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “Friends, Romans, countrymen, lend me your ears” (Act III, Scene II, Antony): Antony's opening. Theme link: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act III, Scene II” treats the funeral orations with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “For Brutus is an honourable man” (Act III, Scene II, Antony): The repeated ironic refrain. Theme link: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act III, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more” (Act III, Scene II, Brutus): Brutus's balanced antithesis. Theme link: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the funeral orations? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “Friends, Romans, countrymen, lend me your ears” (Act III, Scene II, Antony): Antony's opening. Theme link: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene II, Antony: “For Brutus is an _____ man”
   Key: honourable
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “O judgment! thou art fled to _____ beasts, And men have lost their reason.” Word bank: withholds, brutish, extenuated, ransoms
   Key: brutish
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene II, Brutus: “Not that I loved _____ less, but that I loved Rome more”
   Key: Caesar
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “You all did love him once, not without cause: What cause withholds you then, to mourn for him?”, what does “withholds” most nearly mean?
   A. to argue noisily
   B. to give rise to
   C. holds back
   D. to declare publicly
   Key: C (holds back)
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “To every Roman citizen he gives, To every several man, seventy-five drachmas.”, what does “drachmas” most nearly mean?
   A. silver coins
   B. merit; excellence
   C. courage; appetite for battle
   D. crying out with a high scream
   Key: A (silver coins)
6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene II, Antony: “Friends, Romans, _____, lend me your ears”
   Key: countrymen
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How much money does Caesar's will leave each citizen?
   A. Ten drachmas
   B. One hundred talents

C. Seventy-five drachmas

D. Nothing

Key: C (Seventy-five drachmas)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Does Brutus speak to the crowd in prose or verse?

   A. Latin

   B. Prose

   C. Song

   D. Verse

   Key: B (Prose)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I have o’ershot myself to tell you of it: I fear I wrong the honourable men Whose _____ have stabb’d Caesar; I do fear it.” Word bank: extenuated, daggers, withholds, ransoms

   Key: daggers

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more” (Act III, Scene II, Brutus)

    A. Cassius notes it is his birthday: the day of birth may be the day of death.

    B. Cassius's willingness to die.

    C. Brutus's hope.

    D. Brutus's balanced antithesis.

    Key: D (Brutus's balanced antithesis.)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Friends, Romans, countrymen, lend me your ears” (Act III, Scene II, Antony)

    A. Antony on Lepidus.

    B. Her self-criticism.

    C. His last words in the play (see the intro flag on their history).

    D. Antony's opening.

    Key: D (Antony's opening.)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more” (Act III, Scene II, Brutus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Brutus's balanced antithesis.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Antony hold back the will until late in the speech?

    Sample answer: To build curiosity and anger so its reading sets off the riot.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos.

    A. Power, ambition and tyranny

    B. Honor and self-deception

    C. Public versus private self

    D. Rhetoric and persuasion

    Key: D (Rhetoric and persuasion)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “For Brutus is an honourable man” (Act III, Scene II, Antony).

    Sample answer: Brutus rests his case on honour ("I loved Rome more"), so Antony repeats "Brutus is an honourable man" until the phrase sounds false, while showing the wounds and the will to move the crowd.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: Brutus rests his case on honour ("I loved Rome more"), so Antony repeats "Brutus is an honourable man" until the phrase sounds false, while showing the wounds and the will to move the crowd.

17. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does Antony say Caesar did when offered the crown three times on the Lupercal?

    Sample answer: He refused it each time.

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why did Brutus say he killed Caesar?

    A. Caesar was cruel to him

    B. The gods ordered it

    C. Caesar stole money

    D. Caesar was ambitious

    Key: D (Caesar was ambitious)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “He hath brought many captives home to Rome, Whose ransoms did the general coffers fill: Did this in Caesar seem ambitious?”, what does “ransoms” most nearly mean?

    A. payments to free captives

    B. a wreath worn as a sign of victory

    C. the supposed art of turning base metal to gold

    D. lack of courage

    Key: A (payments to free captives)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Antony show the crowd?

    A. Caesar's torn mantle and wounds

    B. A crown

    C. A dagger

    D. The conspirators' letters

    Key: A (Caesar's torn mantle and wounds)

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The question of his death is enrolled in the Capitol; his glory not extenuated, wherein he was worthy, nor his offences enforced, for which he suffered death.”, what does “extenuated” most nearly mean?

    A. played down; made to seem less

    B. bolts of lightning (Jove's weapon)

    C. defeat

    D. stance; manner of attack

    Key: A (played down; made to seem less)

22. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Friends, Romans, countrymen, lend me your ears” (Act III, Scene II, Antony) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Antony's opening.
23. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act III, Scene II”?
    A. The death of Brutus
    B. Parley before battle
    C. The funeral orations
    D. Artemidorus's letter

    Key: C (The funeral orations)
24. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “For Brutus is an honourable man” (Act III, Scene II, Antony). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: The repeated ironic refrain.
25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene II”? Antony's repeated "Brutus is an honourable man" turns praise into accusation.
    A. Irony
    B. Conflict
    C. Allusion
    D. Simile

    Key: A (Irony)
26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene II”? Brutus's speech is in prose, logical and restrained ("Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more"); Antony's is verse, emotional, ironic and dramatic, with the will and the body as props.
    A. Characterization
    B. Structure
    C. Rhetoric
    D. Tone / mood

    Key: C (Rhetoric)
27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is Antony's speech honest? Separate true statements from manipulations.
    Sample answer: True facts (refused crown, the will) serve a manipulative design.
28. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Kind souls, what, weep you when you but behold Our Caesar’s _____ wounded?” Word bank: withholds, extenuated, ransoms, vesture
    Key: vesture
29. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “For Brutus is an honourable man” (Act III, Scene II, Antony)
    A. Brutus's last words.
    B. The repeated ironic refrain.
    C. The proscription.
    D. Cassius's accusation.

    Key: B (The repeated ironic refrain.)

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how rhetoric and persuasion develops from an earlier scene to "Act III, Scene II". Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos.
31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more" (Act III, Scene II, Brutus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Brutus's balanced antithesis.
32. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "I speak not to _____ what Brutus spoke, But here I am to speak what I do know." Word bank: disprove, extenuated, withholds, ransoms
    Key: disprove
33. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What phrase does Antony repeat about Brutus?
    A. Brutus is wise
    B. Brutus is a traitor
    C. Brutus loved Caesar
    D. Brutus is an honourable man

    Key: D (Brutus is an honourable man)
34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Friends, Romans, countrymen, lend me your ears" (Act III, Scene II, Antony) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Antony's opening.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	8, 17, 18, 19, 20, 6, 2, 21, 22, 13, 23, 12, 24, 25, 26, 27	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	3, 28, 2, 18, 8, 17, 10, 13, 29, 23, 22, 25, 26, 14, 30, 27	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	19, 6, 9, 20, 21, 23, 13, 29, 22, 12, 14, 25, 24, 15, 30, 31	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	32, 33, 8, 3, 11, 12, 13, 29, 23, 26, 14, 15, 24, 31, 34, 27	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	3, 28, 17, 23, 29, 13, 11, 26, 14, 24, 15, 25, 31, 30, 16, 27	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	3, 32, 4, 11, 12, 23, 13, 15, 25, 14, 26, 24, 30, 31, 16, 34	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	28, 32, 13, 23, 12, 11, 24, 26, 25, 15, 14, 31, 16, 34, 30, 27	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	1, 28, 11, 12, 23, 13, 24, 14, 15, 25, 26, 34, 16, 31, 27, 30	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	32, 9, 13, 23, 29, 10, 26, 24, 25, 14, 15, 34, 31, 16, 27, 30	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Graduate / PhD	32, 9, 12, 23, 10, 11, 24, 14, 26, 15, 25, 31, 16, 30, 27, 34	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act III, Scene II,” how does Shakespeare show the funeral orations? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the theme you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2, W.9-10.1): In Act III, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the funeral orations? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the theme in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene II develops the idea of the funeral orations. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its theme shape the reader's understanding of the funeral orations. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene II suggests about the funeral orations. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's theme and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses theme in Act III, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of the funeral orations. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act III, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the funeral orations responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act III, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the funeral orations follows or bends those conventions, using the theme as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene II and its treatment of

the funeral orations. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's theme and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about the funeral orations in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the funeral orations. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *He hath brought many captives home to Rome, Whose ransoms did the general coffers fill: Did this in Caesar seem ambitious?*

   As used in the text, what does the word “ransoms” most nearly mean?

   A. like a beast; without reason

   B. clothing; here, Caesar's cloak

   C. payments to free captives

   D. base criminals (here, the citizens mean the conspirators)

2. *Then none have I offended. I have done no more to Caesar than you shall do to Brutus. The question of his death is enrolled in the Capitol; his glory not extenuated, wherein he was worthy, nor his offences enforced, for which he suffered death.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act III, Scene II”?

   A. The triumvirs' proscription list

   B. The funeral orations

   C. Portia's anxiety

   D. Cinna the poet

SAT key: 1. C (payments to free captives); 2. B (The funeral orations)

Lesson 12: Act III, Scene III

Focus: Cinna the poet

Objective: Students will analyze how conflict develops in "Act III, Scene III" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (mob violence): An innocent poet is killed by a mob that confuses his name with a conspirator's. Discuss the link between rhetoric and crowd violence without dwelling on the act.
Student preview: A crowd attacks an innocent man.
Suggested language: "What made this crowd stop listening?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Cinna the poet, who has dreamed of feasting with Caesar, goes out to the funeral. A mob of plebeians questions him. When he gives his name, they confuse him with Cinna the conspirator; when he protests that he is the poet, they cry 'Tear him for his bad verses' and kill him anyway.

Background: Plutarch reports that the poet Helvius Cinna was killed by a mob that mistook him for the conspirator Cornelius Cinna.

Significance: This short scene shows the result of Antony's speech: a mob that no longer listens to reason. It darkly mirrors the conspirators' own violence. Note: this scene depicts mob violence; preview with students.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What happens to truth when a crowd is angry? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to rhetoric and persuasion because.... Content note before we start: A crowd attacks an innocent man.
Prompt: What happens to truth when a crowd is angry?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to rhetoric and persuasion because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: bachelor — an unmarried man; unluckily — ominously; with bad luck; fantasy — imagination. "bachelor": Origin: Old French bacheler. "unluckily": Origin: an English formation from unlucky + -ly.
Words: bachelor: an unmarried man · unluckily: ominously; with bad luck · fantasy: imagination

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Plutarch reports that the poet Helvius Cinna was killed by a mob that mistook him for the conspirator Cornelius Cinna. This short scene shows the result of Antony's speech: a mob that no longer listens to reason. It darkly mirrors the conspirators' own violence. Note: this scene depicts mob violence; preview with students. Plot: The mob kills Cinna the poet because he shares a conspirator's name. Tone / mood: Dark comedy turning brutal. Watch for omens and portents: Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: "I dreamt to-night that I did feast with Caesar, / And things unluckily charge" (Act III, Scene III, Cinna).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet" slowly and put it in my own words: The mob seizes Cinna the poet, who keeps insisting he is not Cinna the conspirator. Next, craft. I notice the desperate repetition of his identity, which the crowd ignores. The strongest word is "poet": it shows his innocence, since he shares only a name with the conspirator. Then, effect. What happens to Cinna the poet, and why does it matter? My answer: The mob kills Cinna the poet even after learning he is not the conspirator, "for his bad verses"; it matters because it shows Antony's speech has unleashed senseless violence in Rome.

> *I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet* *(Act III, Scene III, Cinna)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet" slowly and put it in my own words: The mob seizes Cinna the poet, who keeps insisting he is not Cinna the conspirator. Next, craft. I notice the desperate repetition of his identity, which the crowd ignores. The strongest word is "poet": it shows his innocence, since he shares only a name with the conspirator. Then, effect. What happens to Cinna the poet, and why does it matter? My answer: The mob kills Cinna the poet even after learning he is not the conspirator, "for his bad verses"; it matters because it shows Antony's speech has unleashed senseless violence in Rome.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The mob's cruelty. Look at the craft: Dark comedy turning brutal. Ask: How does this line connect to rhetoric and persuasion? Expected: The crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. (The mob's cruelty.)

> *Tear him for his bad verses* *(Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The mob's cruelty. Look at the craft: Dark comedy turning brutal.
Ask: How does this line connect to rhetoric and persuasion?
Expected answer: The crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. (The mob's cruelty.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for plot, tone / mood (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Cinna the poet? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene III develops the idea of Cinna the poet. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. When the text says "I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet" (Act III, Scene III, Cinna), it shows this directly. When he protests "I am Cinna the poet," the mob answers "It is no matter, his name's Cinna" and "Tear him for his bad verses."
Task: Annotate the scene for plot, tone / mood (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Cinna the poet? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene III develops the idea of Cinna the poet. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. When the text says "I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet" (Act III, Scene III, Cinna), it shows this directly. When he protests "I am Cinna the poet," the mob answers "It is no matter, his name's Cinna" and "Tear him for his bad verses."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What happens to truth when a crowd is angry? Ask: who is responsible for Cinna's death?
Anchor question: What happens to truth when a crowd is angry?
Facilitation: Ask: who is responsible for Cinna's death?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Cinna the poet? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. ("I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet", Act III, Scene III, Cinna). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Cinna the poet? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. ("I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet", Act III, Scene III, Cinna). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how plot shapes Cinna the poet. Key takeaway: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** The mob kills Cinna the poet because he shares a conspirator's name.
- **Tone / mood:** Dark comedy turning brutal.

Themes and how they develop

- **rhetoric and persuasion:** the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob.

Symbols and motifs

- **omens and portents:** Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: “I dreamt to-night that I did feast with Caesar, / And things unluckily charge” (Act III, Scene III, Cinna).
- **Rome and the people:** The crowd's loyalty is fickle; speakers win Rome by moving the plebeians. In this scene: “Enter Citizens” (Act III, Scene III).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet” (Act III, Scene III, Cinna) His plea.
- “Tear him for his bad verses” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen) The mob's cruelty.
- “It is no matter, his name’s Cinna” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen) The mob's logic.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd.
Evidence: “I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet” (Act III, Scene III, Cinna)
Reasoning: When he protests "I am Cinna the poet," the mob answers "It is no matter, his name's Cinna" and "Tear him for his bad verses."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
bachelor (noun)	an unmarried man	*Are you a married man or a bachelor?*	“bachelor”: Origin: Old French bacheler. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/bachelor#Etymology)
unluckily (adverb)	ominously; with bad luck	*I dreamt to-night that I did feast with Caesar, And things unluckily charge my fantasy: I have no will to wander forth of doors, Yet something leads me forth.*	“unluckily”: Origin: an English formation from unlucky + -ly. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/unluckily#Etymology)
fantasy (noun)	imagination	*I dreamt to-night that I did feast with Caesar, And things unluckily charge*	

		my fantasy: I have no will to wander forth of doors, Yet something leads me forth.	

Discussion questions

1. What happens to truth when a crowd is angry?
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with power, ambition and tyranny?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What questions does the mob ask Cinna? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: His name, where he is going, where he lives, whether he is married.
2. Why does the mob attack Cinna the poet? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He shares a name with a conspirator
3. What did Cinna dream before going out? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: That he feasted with Caesar
4. Where is Cinna going? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To Caesar's funeral
5. What do the plebeians say to tear him for? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: His bad verses
6. Does the mob stop when they learn he is the poet? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: No
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act III, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Cinna the poet, who has dreamed of feasting with Caesar, goes out to the funeral. A mob of plebeians questions him. When he gives his name, they confuse him with Cinna the conspirator; when he protests that he is the poet, they cry 'Tear him for his bad verses' and kill him anyway.
8. Who is on stage in "Act III, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act III, Scene III" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Are you a married man or a bachelor?" What does "bachelor" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: bachelor: an unmarried man.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why might Shakespeare include this scene right after the orations? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: To show the human cost of inflamed rhetoric.
2. What does “Act III, Scene III” suggest about Cinna the poet? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: This short scene shows the result of Antony's speech: a mob that no longer listens to reason. It darkly mirrors the conspirators' own violence. Note: this scene depicts mob violence; preview with students.
3. Find one example of conflict in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the theme in this scene shape what we understand about Cinna the poet? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: “I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet” (Act III, Scene III, Cinna): His plea. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “What is my name?”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Cinna the poet, who has dreamed of feasting with Caesar, goes out to the funeral. A mob of plebeians questions him. When he gives his name, they confuse him with Cinna the conspirator; when he protests that he is the poet, they cry 'Tear him for his bad verses' and kill him anyway.
7. How does “Act III, Scene III” build on “Act III, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: “Tear him for his bad verses” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen): The mob's cruelty. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: “It is no matter, his name’s Cinna” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen): The mob's logic. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What happens to truth when a crowd is angry?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

10. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with power, ambition and tyranny? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: “I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet” (Act III, Scene III, Cinna): His plea. On tone / mood: Dark comedy turning brutal. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is this scene comic, horrifying, or both? How would you stage it, and why? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Accept justified choices; note the dark humor and violence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: “Tear him for his bad verses” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen): The mob's cruelty. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “This short scene shows the result of Antony's speech: a mob that no longer listens to reason. It darkly mirrors the conspirators' own violence. Note: this scene depicts mob violence; preview with students.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: “It is no matter, his name’s Cinna” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen): The mob's logic. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: “I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet” (Act III, Scene III, Cinna): His plea. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act III, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Cinna the poet. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: “Tear him for his bad verses” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen): The mob's cruelty. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1,

RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: “It is no matter, his name’s Cinna” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen): The mob's logic. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to honor and self-deception: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: “I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet” (Act III, Scene III, Cinna): His plea. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the conflict in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: “Tear him for his bad verses” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen): The mob's cruelty. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act III, Scene III” treats Cinna the poet with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: “It is no matter, his name’s Cinna” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen): The mob's logic. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act IV, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: “I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet” (Act III, Scene III, Cinna): His plea. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Cinna the poet? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: “Tear him for his bad verses” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen): The mob's cruelty. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. Credit any

position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where is Cinna going?
   A. To Brutus's house
   B. To the Senate
   C. Out of Rome
   D. To Caesar's funeral

   Key: D (To Caesar's funeral)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does the mob attack Cinna the poet?
   A. He stole from them
   B. He praised Brutus
   C. He insulted Caesar
   D. He shares a name with a conspirator

   Key: D (He shares a name with a conspirator)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I dreamt to-night that I did feast with Caesar, And things unluckily charge my fantasy: I have no will to wander forth of doors, Yet something leads me forth.”, what does “unluckily” most nearly mean?
   A. unable to die
   B. ominously; with bad luck
   C. to send greetings; to recommend
   D. a person who joins a secret plot

   Key: B (ominously; with bad luck)
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What did Cinna dream before going out?
   A. That he feasted with Caesar
   B. That Caesar was crowned
   C. That he was attacked
   D. That Rome burned

   Key: A (That he feasted with Caesar)
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What do the plebeians say to tear him for?
   A. His bad verses
   B. His lies
   C. His dreams

D. His wealth

Key: A (His bad verses)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Does the mob stop when they learn he is the poet?

   A. Yes

   B. They apologize

   C. No

   D. Only for a moment, then let him go

   Key: C (No)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I dreamt to-night that I did feast with Caesar, And things unluckily charge my fantasy: I have no will to wander forth of doors, Yet something leads me forth.”, what does “fantasy” most nearly mean?

   A. played down; made to seem less

   B. imagination

   C. Roman army units

   D. wicked; good-for-nothing

   Key: B (imagination)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen: “Tear him for his bad _____”

   Key: verses

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen: “It is no _____, his name’s Cinna”

   Key: matter

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Tear him for his bad verses” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The mob's cruelty.

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet” (Act III, Scene III, Cinna) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: His plea.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “It is no matter, his name’s Cinna” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen)

    A. The mob's logic.

    B. Antony's prophecy of civil war.

    C. Caesar's hubris just before his death.

    D. Portia's frustration.

    Key: A (The mob's logic.)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why might Shakespeare include this scene right after the orations?

    Sample answer: To show the human cost of inflamed rhetoric.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet” (Act III, Scene III, Cinna).

Sample answer: When he protests "I am Cinna the poet," the mob answers "It is no matter, his name's Cinna" and "Tear him for his bad verses."

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene III”? The mob kills Cinna the poet because he shares a conspirator's name.

    A. Structure

    B. Plot

    C. Allusion

    D. Tone / mood

    Key: B (Plot)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet” (Act III, Scene III, Cinna) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: His plea.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Are you a married man or a _____?”

    Word bank: bachelor, fantasy, unluckily

    Key: bachelor

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Are you a married man or a bachelor?”, what does “bachelor” most nearly mean?

    A. an unmarried man

    B. a bold undertaking

    C. shortened

    D. foolish behavior; nonsense

    Key: A (an unmarried man)

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I dreamt to-night that I did feast with Caesar, And things _____ charge my fantasy: I have no will to wander forth of doors, Yet something leads me forth.” Word bank: unluckily, bachelor, fantasy

    Key: unluckily

20. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet” (Act III, Scene III, Cinna)

    A. Artemidorus's hope.

    B. Haste.

    C. His plea.

    D. The letter.

    Key: C (His plea.)

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob.

    A. Honor and self-deception

    B. Rhetoric and persuasion

    C. Power, ambition and tyranny

    D. Public versus private self

    Key: B (Rhetoric and persuasion)

22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is this scene comic, horrifying, or both? How would you stage it, and why?
    Sample answer: Accept justified choices; note the dark humor and violence.
23. [short · recall · DOK 1] What questions does the mob ask Cinna?
    Sample answer: His name, where he is going, where he lives, whether he is married.
24. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Tear him for his bad verses” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen)
    A. Cassius's argument for action.
    B. The mob's cruelty.
    C. Caesar reads Cassius accurately.
    D. Cassius notes it is his birthday: the day of birth may be the day of death.
    Key: B (The mob's cruelty.)
25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act III, Scene III”? Dark comedy turning brutal.
    A. Conflict
    B. Metaphor
    C. Tone / mood
    D. Irony
    Key: C (Tone / mood)
26. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “It is no matter, his name’s Cinna” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: The mob's logic.
27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: When he protests "I am Cinna the poet," the mob answers "It is no matter, his name's Cinna" and "Tear him for his bad verses."
28. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act III, Scene III”?
    A. Parley before battle
    B. Brutus and Cassius at odds
    C. The tribunes and the fickle crowd
    D. Cinna the poet
    Key: D (Cinna the poet)
29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how rhetoric and persuasion develops from an earlier scene to “Act III, Scene III”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob.
30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Tear him for his bad verses” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The mob's cruelty.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	

		recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 1, 5, 4, 9, 18, 2, 19, 12, 20, 11, 10, 14, 21, 15, 22	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	17, 8, 1, 23, 5, 3, 24, 10, 13, 12, 20, 21, 25, 26, 27, 22	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	17, 19, 7, 1, 5, 20, 10, 28, 12, 13, 25, 15, 26, 14, 27, 22	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	1, 2, 8, 9, 13, 28, 24, 11, 12, 14, 21, 26, 15, 29, 27, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	9, 8, 5, 13, 12, 24, 28, 25, 15, 26, 14, 21, 16, 30, 22, 27	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	17, 19, 2, 24, 13, 12, 10, 26, 21, 15, 14, 25, 29, 22, 16, 27	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	17, 19, 20, 10, 13, 12, 26, 14, 25, 15, 21, 22, 27, 16, 29, 30	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	17, 9, 13, 20, 11, 28, 21, 25, 14, 15, 26, 22, 30, 16, 29, 27	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Senior	17, 19, 13, 11, 12, 20, 14, 26, 25, 15, 21, 30, 29, 22, 27, 16	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	17, 19, 24, 11, 10, 20, 15, 25, 26, 14, 21, 29, 27, 30, 16, 22	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act III, Scene III,” how does Shakespeare show Cinna the poet? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act III, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Cinna the poet? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene III develops the idea of Cinna the poet. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of Cinna the poet. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene III suggests about Cinna the poet. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses conflict in Act III, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of Cinna the poet. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act III, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Cinna the poet responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act III, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Cinna the poet follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene III and its treatment of Cinna the poet. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's conflict and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about Cinna the poet in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Cinna the poet. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *What is my name? Whither am I going? Where do I dwell? Am I a married man or a bachelor? Then, to answer every man directly and briefly, wisely and truly: wisely I say, I am a bachelor.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene III"?

   A. Cinna the poet

   B. The death of Cassius

   C. Storm, omens and recruitment

   D. Brutus and Cassius at odds

SAT key: 1. A (Cinna the poet)

Lesson 13: Act IV, Scene I

Focus: the triumvirs' proscription list

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “Act IV, Scene I” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Antony, Octavius and Lepidus mark men for death, trading relatives: Lepidus's brother and Antony's nephew are condemned. Antony plans to cut costs from Caesar's will. When Lepidus leaves, Antony calls him a 'slight unmeritable man' fit only for errands, comparing him to a horse; Octavius defends him as a soldier. They plan to meet the armies of Brutus and Cassius.

Background: In 43 BC the Second Triumvirate published proscription lists of enemies to be killed and their property seized; the orator Cicero was among the victims.

Significance: The 'avengers' of Caesar prove as ruthless as the conspirators and more cynical. Antony's plan to reduce the people's legacy undercuts his funeral speech.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Do people who win power by attacking tyranny ever become tyrants themselves? Think of examples. Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to power and ambition because....
Prompt: Do people who win power by attacking tyranny ever become tyrants themselves? Think of examples.
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to power and ambition because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: provender — food for horses; errands — small tasks for others; appoint — to provide for; to equip; proscription — condemning people to death by public list; mischiefs — harms; dangers. “appoint”: Origin: Old French apointier (“to prepare”); earlier Late Latin appunctō. “mischiefs”: Origin of “mischief”: Old French meschief.
Words: provender: food for horses · errands: small tasks for others · appoint: to provide for; to equip · proscription: condemning people to death by public list · mischiefs: harms; dangers

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
In 43 BC the Second Triumvirate published proscription lists of enemies to be killed and their property seized; the orator Cicero was among the victims. The 'avengers' of Caesar prove as ruthless as the conspirators and more cynical. Antony's plan to reduce the people's legacy undercuts his funeral speech. Characterization: Antony, Octavius and Lepidus draw up a death list; Antony mocks Lepidus behind his back. Irony: Antony, who praised Caesar's love for the people, now cuts legacies from Caesar's will. Watch for Rome and the people: The crowd's loyalty is fickle; speakers win Rome by moving the plebeians. In this scene: "A house in Rome" (Act IV, Scene I).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "These many, then, shall die; their names are prick'd" slowly and put it in my own words: Antony, Octavius and Lepidus agree that many people shall die, and mark their names on a list. Next, craft. I notice the cold, businesslike tone as the triumvirs decide who will be executed. The strongest word is "prick'd": it means marked with a small hole on the list, as one ticks off names. Then, effect. What does Antony's line show about the new rulers? My answer: The new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators; Antony bargains away his own relatives, showing that Caesar's death has brought tyranny, not freedom.

> *These many, then, shall die; their names are prick'd* (Act IV, Scene I, Antony)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "These many, then, shall die; their names are prick'd" slowly and put it in my own words: Antony, Octavius and Lepidus agree that many people shall die, and mark their names on a list. Next, craft. I notice the cold, businesslike tone as the triumvirs decide who will be executed. The strongest word is "prick'd": it means marked with a small hole on the list, as one ticks off names. Then, effect. What does Antony's line show about the new rulers? My answer: The new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators; Antony bargains away his own relatives, showing that Caesar's death has brought tyranny, not freedom.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Antony on Lepidus. Look at the craft: Antony, who praised Caesar's love for the people, now cuts legacies from Caesar's will. Ask: How does this line connect to power and ambition? Expected: The new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. (Antony on Lepidus.)

> *This is a slight unmeritable man, / Meet to be sent on errands* (Act IV, Scene I, Antony)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Antony on Lepidus. Look at the craft: Antony, who praised Caesar's love for the people, now cuts legacies from Caesar's will.
Ask: How does this line connect to power and ambition?
Expected answer: The new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. (Antony on Lepidus.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the triumvirs' proscription list? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene I develops the idea of the triumvirs' proscription list. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. When the text says "we shall determine / How to cut off some charge in legacies" (Act IV, Scene I, Antony), it shows this directly. They begin with "These many, then, shall die," and Antony plans to "cut off some charge in legacies" from the will he used to win the crowd.

Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the triumvirs' proscription list? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene I develops the idea of the triumvirs' proscription list. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. When the text says "we shall determine / How to cut off some charge in legacies" (Act IV, Scene I, Antony), it shows this directly. They begin with "These many, then, shall die," and Antony plans to "cut off some charge in legacies" from the will he used to win the crowd.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Do people who win power by attacking tyranny ever become tyrants themselves? Think of examples. Ask: was the conspiracy worth it?

Anchor question: Do people who win power by attacking tyranny ever become tyrants themselves? Think of examples.

Facilitation: Ask: was the conspiracy worth it?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the triumvirs' proscription list? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. ("we shall determine / How to cut off some charge in legacies", Act IV, Scene I, Antony). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the triumvirs' proscription list? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. ("we shall determine / How to cut off some charge in legacies", Act IV, Scene I, Antony). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes the triumvirs' proscription list. Key takeaway: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Antony, Octavius and Lepidus draw up a death list; Antony mocks Lepidus behind his back.
- **Irony:** Antony, who praised Caesar's love for the people, now cuts legacies from Caesar's will.

Themes and how they develop

- **power and ambition:** the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be.

Symbols and motifs

- **Rome and the people:** The crowd's loyalty is fickle; speakers win Rome by moving the plebeians. In this scene: “A house in Rome” (Act IV, Scene I).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “These many, then, shall die; their names are prick’d” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony) The proscription.
- “This is a slight unmeritable man, / Meet to be sent on errands” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony) Antony on Lepidus.
- “we shall determine / How to cut off some charge in legacies” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony) Reducing the will.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones.
Evidence: “we shall determine / How to cut off some charge in legacies” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony)
Reasoning: They begin with "These many, then, shall die," and Antony plans to "cut off some charge in legacies" from the will he used to win the crowd.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
provender (noun)	food for horses	*So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern’d by my spirit.*	

errands (noun)	small tasks for others	*This is a slight unmeritable man, Meet to be sent on errands: is it fit, The three-fold world divided, he should stand One of the three to share it?*	
appoint (verb)	to provide for; to equip	*So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern'd by my spirit.*	"appoint": Origin: Old French apointier ("to prepare"); earlier Late Latin appunctō. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/appoint#Etymology)
proscription (noun)	condemning people to death by public list	*So you thought him; And took his voice who should be prick'd to die, In our black sentence and proscription.*	
mischiefs (noun)	harms; dangers	*Let us do so: for we are at the stake, And bay'd about with many enemies; And some that smile have in their hearts, I fear, Millions of mischiefs.*	"mischiefs": Origin of "mischief": Old French meschief. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/mischief#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Do people who win power by attacking tyranny ever become tyrants themselves? Think of examples.
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with honor and self-deception?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Whose brother must die on the triumvirs' list? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Lepidus's brother.
2. What are the triumvirs doing at the start of the scene? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Marking names of men to be killed
3. Whose nephew is condemned? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Antony's
4. What does Antony plan to do with Caesar's will? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Cut some of its charges
5. To what animal does Antony compare Lepidus? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A horse

6. Who defends Lepidus as a tried and valiant soldier? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Octavius
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act IV, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Antony, Octavius and Lepidus mark men for death, trading relatives: Lepidus's brother and Antony's nephew are condemned. Antony plans to cut costs from Caesar's will. When Lepidus leaves, Antony calls him a 'slight unmeritable man' fit only for errands, comparing him to a horse; Octavius defends him as a soldier. They plan to meet the armies of Brutus and Cassius.
8. Who is on stage in "Act IV, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act IV, Scene I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern'd by my spirit." What does "provender" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: provender: food for horses.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does the scene reveal about how Antony views power? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: As a matter of tools and advantage; allies are used and discarded.
2. What does "Act IV, Scene I" suggest about the triumvirs' proscription list? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The 'avengers' of Caesar prove as ruthless as the conspirators and more cynical. Antony's plan to reduce the people's legacy undercuts his funeral speech.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the theme in this scene shape what we understand about the triumvirs' proscription list? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: "These many, then, shall die; their names are prick'd" (Act IV, Scene I, Antony): The proscription. Theme link: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion…", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Act IV, Scene I", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Antony, Octavius and Lepidus mark men for death, trading relatives: Lepidus's brother and Antony's nephew are condemned. Antony plans to cut costs from Caesar's will. When

Lepidus leaves, Antony calls him a 'slight unmeritable man' fit only for errands, comparing him to a horse; Octavius defends…

7. How does “Act IV, Scene I” build on “Act III, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: “This is a slight unmeritable man, / Meet to be sent on errands” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony): Antony on Lepidus. Theme link: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: “we shall determine / How to cut off some charge in legacies” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony): Reducing the will. On characterization: Antony, Octavius and Lepidus draw up a death list; Antony mocks Lepidus behind his back. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Do people who win power by attacking tyranny ever become tyrants themselves? Think of examples.” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with honor and self-deception? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: “These many, then, shall die; their names are prick’d” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony): The proscription. Theme link: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Compare this scene with Antony's funeral speech. Which shows the 'real' Antony? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Strong answers see both as performances of one strategic self.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: “This is a slight unmeritable man, / Meet to be sent on errands” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony): Antony on Lepidus. Theme link: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The 'avengers' of Caesar prove as ruthless as the conspirators and more cynical. Antony's plan to reduce the people's legacy undercuts his funeral speech.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: “we shall determine / How to cut off some charge in legacies” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony): Reducing the will. Theme link: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: “These many, then, shall die; their names are prick’d” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony): The proscription. On characterization: Antony, Octavius and Lepidus draw up a death list; Antony mocks Lepidus behind his back. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the triumvirs' proscription list. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: “This is a slight unmeritable man, / Meet to be sent on errands” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony): Antony on Lepidus. Theme link: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act IV, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: “we shall determine / How to cut off some charge in legacies” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony): Reducing the will. Theme link: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to rhetoric and persuasion: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: “These many, then, shall die; their names are prick’d” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony): The proscription. Theme link: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: “This is a slight unmeritable man, / Meet to be sent on errands” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony): Antony on Lepidus. On characterization: Antony, Octavius and Lepidus

draw up a death list; Antony mocks Lepidus behind his back. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Act IV, Scene I" treats the triumvirs' proscription list with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: "we shall determine / How to cut off some charge in legacies" (Act IV, Scene I, Antony): Reducing the will. Theme link: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Act IV, Scene II" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: "These many, then, shall die; their names are prick'd" (Act IV, Scene I, Antony): The proscription. Theme link: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the triumvirs' proscription list? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: "This is a slight unmeritable man, / Meet to be sent on errands" (Act IV, Scene I, Antony): Antony on Lepidus. Theme link: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who defends Lepidus as a tried and valiant soldier?

   A. Antony

   B. Brutus

   C. Octavius

   D. Cassius

   Key: C (Octavius)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What are the triumvirs doing at the start of the scene?

   A. Dividing the army

B. Marking names of men to be killed

C. Planning Caesar's funeral

D. Writing laws

Key: B (Marking names of men to be killed)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] To what animal does Antony compare Lepidus?

A. A lion

B. A donkey

C. A horse

D. A dog

Key: C (A horse)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “This is a slight unmeritable man, Meet to be sent on errands: is it fit, The three-fold world divided, he should stand One of the three to share it?”, what does “errands” most nearly mean?

A. poisoned

B. hot-tempered

C. small tasks for others

D. one who heals (here, a joke: he "heals" old shoes)

Key: C (small tasks for others)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “So you thought him; And took his voice who should be prick’d to die, In our black sentence and proscription.”, what does “proscription” most nearly mean?

A. victory

B. condemning people to death by public list

C. to beg

D. bolts of lightning (Jove's weapon)

Key: B (condemning people to death by public list)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Antony plan to do with Caesar's will?

A. Burn it

B. Cut some of its charges

C. Read it again

D. Give more to the people

Key: B (Cut some of its charges)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern’d by my spirit.”, what does “provender” most nearly mean?

A. to foretell

B. food for horses

C. payments to free captives

D. to take into service

Key: B (food for horses)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene I, Antony: “This is a slight _____ man, / Meet to be sent on errands”

   Key: unmeritable

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Let us do so: for we are at the stake, And bay’d about with many enemies; And some that smile have in their hearts, I fear, Millions of _____.”

   Word bank: errands, provender, appoint, mischiefs

   Key: mischiefs

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What does the scene reveal about how Antony views power?

    Sample answer: As a matter of tools and advantage; allies are used and discarded.

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “These many, then, shall die; their names are prick’d” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The proscription.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “These many, then, shall die; their names are prick’d” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony)

    A. The proscription.

    B. The ideal.

    C. The mob's cruelty.

    D. The title character, who will die halfway through.

    Key: A (The proscription.)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “This is a slight unmeritable man, / Meet to be sent on errands” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Antony on Lepidus.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act IV, Scene I”? Antony, Octavius and Lepidus draw up a death list; Antony mocks Lepidus behind his back.

    A. Foreshadowing

    B. Point of view

    C. Hyperbole

    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “we shall determine / How to cut off some charge in legacies” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony).

    Sample answer: They begin with "These many, then, shall die," and Antony plans to "cut off some charge in legacies" from the will he used to win the crowd.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: They begin with "These many, then, shall die," and Antony plans to "cut off some charge in legacies" from the will he used to win the crowd.

17. [short · recall · DOK 1] Whose brother must die on the triumvirs' list?

    Sample answer: Lepidus's brother.

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whose nephew is condemned?

    A. Octavius's

    B. Brutus's

    C. Antony's

    D. Lepidus's

    Key: C (Antony's)

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene I, Antony: “we shall _____ / How to cut off some charge in legacies”

    Key: determine

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern’d by my spirit.”, what does “appoint” most nearly mean?

    A. foolish behavior; nonsense

    B. rhyming in a silly, sing-song way

    C. to provide for; to equip

    D. to help; to favor

    Key: C (to provide for; to equip)

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “This is a slight unmeritable man, / Meet to be sent on errands” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony)

    A. Antony on Lepidus.

    B. The repeated ironic refrain.

    C. Decius's flattery.

    D. Brutus's hope.

    Key: A (Antony on Lepidus.)

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act IV, Scene I”?

    A. The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost

    B. Young Cato and Lucilius

    C. Cassius works on Brutus

    D. The triumvirs' proscription list

    Key: D (The triumvirs' proscription list)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act IV, Scene I”? Antony, who praised Caesar's love for the people, now cuts legacies from Caesar's will.

    A. Characterization

    B. Irony

    C. Setting

    D. Hyperbole

    Key: B (Irony)

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “These many, then, shall die; their names are prick’d” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The proscription.

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “we shall determine / How to cut off some charge in legacies” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony)
    A. Brutus's idealism.
    B. Cassius's image of Caesar's size and his own smallness.
    C. Caesar reads Cassius accurately.
    D. Reducing the will.

    Key: D (Reducing the will.)

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Compare this scene with Antony's funeral speech. Which shows the 'real' Antony?
    Sample answer: Strong answers see both as performances of one strategic self.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how power and ambition develops from an earlier scene to “Act IV, Scene I”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be.

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “we shall determine / How to cut off some charge in legacies” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Reducing the will.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “This is a slight unmeritable man, / Meet to be sent on errands” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Antony on Lepidus.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 3, 8, 9, 19, 20, 6, 11, 12, 21, 22, 15, 14, 23, 24	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	6, 17, 1, 8, 9, 3, 21, 12, 10, 25, 13, 14, 23, 15, 26, 27	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	9, 19, 6, 4, 7, 10, 12, 25, 13, 22, 28, 23, 14, 15, 24, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	9, 8, 17, 1, 22, 11, 25, 12, 13, 14, 28, 23, 15, 27, 16, 29	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	9, 8, 17, 10, 12, 11, 21, 14, 23, 15, 28, 24, 29, 27, 16, 26	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Freshman	9, 8, 1, 22, 21, 11, 25, 14, 15, 28, 23, 29, 27, 16, 24, 26	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	9, 8, 25, 13, 22, 12, 10, 14, 28, 23, 15, 29, 26, 24, 16, 27	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Junior	9, 8, 11, 13, 21, 25, 10, 15, 14, 28, 23, 27, 26, 24, 16, 29	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Senior	9, 8, 11, 10, 12, 21, 25, 23, 14, 15, 28, 29, 24, 16, 26, 27	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	9, 8, 13, 21, 10, 12, 22, 28, 14, 23, 15, 27, 26, 24, 29, 16	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act IV, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show the triumvirs' proscription list? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act IV, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the triumvirs' proscription list? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act IV, Scene I develops the idea of the triumvirs' proscription list. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of the triumvirs' proscription list. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene I suggests about the triumvirs' proscription list. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act IV, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of the triumvirs' proscription list. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act IV, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the triumvirs' proscription list responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act IV, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the triumvirs' proscription list follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act IV, Scene I and its treatment of the triumvirs' proscription list. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act IV, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about the triumvirs' proscription list in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act IV, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the triumvirs' proscription list. Position your reading

within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern'd by my spirit.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "provender" most nearly mean?

   A. to provide for; to equip
   B. food for horses
   C. condemning people to death by public list
   D. harms; dangers

2. *So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern'd by my spirit. And, in some taste, is Lepidus but so; He must be taught and train'd and bid go forth; A barren-spirited fellow; one that feeds On abjects, orts and imitations, Which, out of use and staled by other men, Begin his fashion: do not talk of him, But as a property. And now, Octavius, Listen great things:—Brutus and Cassius Are levying powers: we must straight make head: Therefore let our alliance be combined, Our best friends made, our means stretch'd; And let us presently go sit in council, How covert matters may be best disclosed, And open perils surest answered.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act IV, Scene I"?

   A. The cast and world of the play
   B. Parley before battle
   C. The triumvirs' proscription list
   D. The funeral orations

SAT key: 1. B (food for horses); 2. C (The triumvirs' proscription list)

Lesson 14: Act IV, Scene II

Focus: Brutus and Cassius at odds

Objective: Students will analyze how conflict develops in "Act IV, Scene II" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

At his camp near Sardis, Brutus tells Lucilius that Cassius greets him with cold ceremony, like a hot horse that fails under trial. Cassius arrives angry, saying Brutus has wronged him. Brutus stops him from quarreling before their armies and moves the conversation into his tent.

Background: Sardis was a city in Asia Minor (modern Turkey) where Brutus and Cassius gathered forces after leaving Rome.

Significance: The alliance is cracking. Brutus's care for appearances (no quarrel in front of the soldiers) repeats his concern with public honor.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might friends who share a cause still fall out? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to friendship and loyalty because....
Prompt: Why might friends who share a cause still fall out?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to friendship and loyalty because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the friendship under strain.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: enlarge — to state freely; to explain fully; wrangle — to argue noisily; deceitful — tricky; dishonest; enforced — forced; strained; courtesy — polite behavior. "enlarge": Origin: Old French enlargier. "deceitful": Origin: an English formation from deceit + -ful. "courtesy": Origin: Middle English curteisie; earlier Anglo-Norman curtesie.
Words: enlarge: to state freely; to explain fully · wrangle: to argue noisily · deceitful: tricky; dishonest · enforced: forced; strained · courtesy: polite behavior

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Sardis was a city in Asia Minor (modern Turkey) where Brutus and Cassius gathered forces after leaving Rome. The alliance is cracking. Brutus's care for appearances (no quarrel in front of the soldiers) repeats his concern with public honor. Characterization: Brutus and Cassius meet in tension; Brutus asks to talk privately in his tent. Foreshadowing: Their alliance is cracking. Watch for honour: "Honourable" is a key word; Antony turns it into irony in the funeral oration. In this scene: "will appear / Such as he is, full of regard and honour" (Act IV, Scene II, Pindarus).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony" slowly and put it in my own words: Brutus says that when love begins to sicken and decay, it uses forced ceremony. Next, craft. I notice the image of love as a sick body, falling back on stiff politeness. The strongest word is "ceremony": it means empty formality, the outward show of a friendship that is cooling. Then, effect. What does Brutus say about his failing friendship with Cassius? My answer: Brutus sees that Cassius's greeting was cold; the conspirators' alliance is weakening, which will lead to their quarrel and defeat.

> *When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony" slowly and put it in my own words: Brutus says that when love begins to sicken and decay, it uses forced ceremony. Next, craft. I notice the image of love as a sick body, falling back on stiff politeness. The strongest word is "ceremony": it means empty formality, the outward show of a friendship that is cooling. Then, effect. What does Brutus say about his failing friendship with Cassius? My answer: Brutus sees that Cassius's greeting was cold; the conspirators' alliance is weakening, which will lead to their quarrel and defeat.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Cassius's accusation. Look at the craft: Their alliance is cracking. Ask: How does this line connect to friendship and loyalty? Expected: The friendship under strain. (Cassius's accusation.)

> *Most noble brother, you have done me wrong (Act IV, Scene II, Cassius)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Cassius's accusation. Look at the craft: Their alliance is cracking.
Ask: How does this line connect to friendship and loyalty?
Expected answer: The friendship under strain. (Cassius's accusation.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Brutus and Cassius at odds? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene II develops the idea of Brutus and Cassius at odds. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. When the text says "When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony" (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus), it shows this directly. Brutus observes that when love "begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony."
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Brutus and Cassius at odds? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene II develops the idea of Brutus and Cassius at odds. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. When the text says "When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony" (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus), it shows this directly. Brutus observes that when love "begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why might friends who share a cause still fall out? Ask: why does Brutus care so much about the armies seeing?
Anchor question: Why might friends who share a cause still fall out?
Facilitation: Ask: why does Brutus care so much about the armies seeing?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Brutus and Cassius at odds? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. ("When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony", Act IV, Scene II, Brutus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Brutus and Cassius at odds? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. ("When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony", Act IV, Scene II, Brutus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes Brutus and Cassius at odds. Key takeaway: the friendship under strain.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Brutus and Cassius meet in tension; Brutus asks to talk privately in his tent.
- **Foreshadowing:** Their alliance is cracking.

Themes and how they develop

- **friendship and loyalty:** the friendship under strain.

Symbols and motifs

- **honour:** "Honourable" is a key word; Antony turns it into irony in the funeral oration. In this scene: “will appear / Such as he is, full of regard and honour” (Act IV, Scene II, Pindarus).
- **blood:** Blood turns the assassination from sacrifice into butchery; the conspirators bathe their hands in it. In this scene: “promise of their mettle; / But when they should endure the bloody spur, / They fall their crests, and, like deceitful jades, / Sink in” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus) Brutus on cooling friendship.
- “Most noble brother, you have done me wrong” (Act IV, Scene II, Cassius) Cassius's accusation.
- “Before the eyes of both our armies here” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus) Brutus's concern for appearance.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

> **Claim:** The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing.
> **Evidence:** “When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus)
> **Reasoning:** Brutus observes that when love "begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
enlarge (verb)	to state freely; to explain fully	*Before the eyes of both our armies here, Which should perceive nothing but love from us, Let us not wrangle: bid them move away;*	“enlarge”: Origin: Old French enlargier. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://

		Then in my tent, Cassius, enlarge your griefs, And I will give you audience.	en.wiktionary.org/wiki/enlarge#Etymology)
wrangle (verb)	to argue noisily	*Before the eyes of both our armies here, Which should perceive nothing but love from us, Let us not wrangle: bid them move away; Then in my tent, Cassius, enlarge your griefs, And I will give you audience.*	
deceitful (adjective)	tricky; dishonest	*There are no tricks in plain and simple faith; But hollow men, like horses hot at hand, Make gallant show and promise of their mettle; But when they should endure the bloody spur, They fall their crests, and, like deceitful jades, Sink in the trial.*	"deceitful": Origin: an English formation from deceit + -ful. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/deceitful#Etymology)
enforced (adjective)	forced; strained	*Thou hast described A hot friend cooling: ever note, Lucilius, When love begins to sicken and decay, It useth an enforced ceremony.*	
courtesy (noun)	polite behavior	*With courtesy and with respect enough; But not with such familiar instances, Nor with such free and friendly conference, As he hath used of old.*	"courtesy": Origin: Middle English curteisie; earlier Anglo-Norman curtesie. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/courtesy#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Why might friends who share a cause still fall out?
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with rhetoric and persuasion?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who brings news of Cassius's approach and his cold manner? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Lucilius (with Pindarus, Cassius's servant).
2. How does Lucilius say Cassius received him? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: With courtesy but not old friendliness
3. To what does Brutus compare a cooling friend? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Horses that fail under trial

4. Where does Brutus want to argue with Cassius? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Inside his tent
5. What does Cassius accuse Brutus of? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Wronging him
6. Near which city is Brutus's camp? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Sardis
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act IV, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: At his camp near Sardis, Brutus tells Lucilius that Cassius greets him with cold ceremony, like a hot horse that fails under trial. Cassius arrives angry, saying Brutus has wronged him. Brutus stops him from quarreling before their armies and moves the conversation into his tent.
8. Who is on stage in "Act IV, Scene II", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act IV, Scene II" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Before the eyes of both our armies here, Which should perceive nothing but love from us, Let us not wrangle: bid them move away; Then in my tent, Cassius, enlarge your griefs, And I will give you audience." What does "enlarge" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: enlarge: to state freely; to explain fully.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Brutus insist the quarrel move into the tent? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: So the soldiers do not see their leaders divided.
2. What does "Act IV, Scene II" suggest about Brutus and Cassius at odds? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The alliance is cracking. Brutus's care for appearances (no quarrel in front of the soldiers) repeats his concern with public honor.
3. Find one example of conflict in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about Brutus and Cassius at odds? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: "When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony" (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus): Brutus on cooling friendship. On characterization: Brutus and Cassius meet in tension; Brutus asks to talk privately in his tent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Thou hast described A hot friend cooling: ever note, Lucilius, When love begins to sicken and decay, It useth an enforced ceremony.", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Act IV, Scene II", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: At his camp near Sardis, Brutus tells Lucilius that Cassius

greets him with cold ceremony, like a hot horse that fails under trial. Cassius arrives angry, saying Brutus has wronged him. Brutus stops him from quarreling before their armies and moves the conversation into his tent.

7. How does “Act IV, Scene II” build on “Act IV, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: “Most noble brother, you have done me wrong” (Act IV, Scene II, Cassius): Cassius's accusation. Theme link: the friendship under strain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: “Before the eyes of both our armies here” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus): Brutus's concern for appearance. On characterization: Brutus and Cassius meet in tension; Brutus asks to talk privately in his tent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might friends who share a cause still fall out?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with rhetoric and persuasion? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: “When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus): Brutus on cooling friendship. Theme link: the friendship under strain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Brutus right to care so much about appearances in front of the army? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Accept leadership arguments; link to his public-honor theme.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: “Most noble brother, you have done me wrong” (Act IV, Scene II, Cassius): Cassius's accusation. Theme link: the friendship under strain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The alliance is cracking. Brutus's care for appearances (no quarrel in front of the soldiers) repeats his concern with public honor.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: “Before the eyes of both our armies here” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus): Brutus's concern for appearance. Theme link: the friendship under strain. Credit any position

that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: “When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus): Brutus on cooling friendship. On characterization: Brutus and Cassius meet in tension; Brutus asks to talk privately in his tent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Brutus and Cassius at odds. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: “Most noble brother, you have done me wrong” (Act IV, Scene II, Cassius): Cassius's accusation. Theme link: the friendship under strain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act IV, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: “Before the eyes of both our armies here” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus): Brutus's concern for appearance. Theme link: the friendship under strain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to public versus private self: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: “When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus): Brutus on cooling friendship. Theme link: the friendship under strain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the conflict in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: “Most noble brother, you have done me wrong” (Act IV, Scene II, Cassius): Cassius's accusation. Theme link: the friendship under strain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene II” treats Brutus and Cassius at odds with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: "Before the eyes of both our armies here" (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus): Brutus's concern for appearance. Theme link: the friendship under strain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Act IV, Scene III" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: "When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony" (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus): Brutus on cooling friendship. On foreshadowing: Their alliance is cracking. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Brutus and Cassius at odds? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: "Most noble brother, you have done me wrong" (Act IV, Scene II, Cassius): Cassius's accusation. Theme link: the friendship under strain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene II, Brutus: "_____ the eyes of both our armies here"

   Key: Before

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Before the eyes of both our armies here, Which should perceive nothing but love from us, Let us not wrangle: bid them move away; Then in my tent, Cassius, enlarge your griefs, And I will give you audience.", what does "wrangle" most nearly mean?

   A. to strip (statues) of their decorations

   B. firmness of mind

   C. being declared an outlaw

   D. to argue noisily

   Key: D (to argue noisily)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Lucilius say Cassius received him?

   A. With open anger

   B. With tears

C. With courtesy but not old friendliness

D. With great warmth

Key: C (With courtesy but not old friendliness)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “There are no tricks in plain and simple faith; But hollow men, like horses hot at hand, Make gallant show and promise of their mettle; But when they should endure the bloody spur, They fall their crests, and, like…”, what does “deceitful” most nearly mean?

   A. tricky; dishonest

   B. the supposed art of turning base metal to gold

   C. to give rise to

   D. killing

   Key: A (tricky; dishonest)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] To what does Brutus compare a cooling friend?

   A. Winter

   B. A dying fire

   C. Old wine

   D. Horses that fail under trial

   Key: D (Horses that fail under trial)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene II, Cassius: “Most noble _____, you have done me wrong”

   Key: brother

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene II, Brutus: “When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an _____ ceremony”

   Key: enforced

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does Brutus want to argue with Cassius?

   A. On the battlefield

   B. In Rome

   C. Before the armies

   D. Inside his tent

   Key: D (Inside his tent)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Thou hast described A hot friend cooling: ever note, Lucilius, When love begins to sicken and decay, It useth an enforced ceremony.”, what does “enforced” most nearly mean?

   A. forced; strained

   B. understood; judged (well conceited: rightly grasped)

   C. Roman army units

   D. to stand over with legs wide apart

   Key: A (forced; strained)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Before the eyes of both our armies here” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus)

    A. Brutus's concern for appearance.

    B. Brutus's decision.

C. Antony's prophecy of civil war.

D. Caesar reads Cassius accurately.

Key: A (Brutus's concern for appearance.)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Brutus insist the quarrel move into the tent?

Sample answer: So the soldiers do not see their leaders divided.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Most noble brother, you have done me wrong” (Act IV, Scene II, Cassius) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Cassius's accusation.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act IV, Scene II”?

A. The first charge

B. Cinna the poet

C. Brutus and Cassius at odds

D. Brutus decides

Key: C (Brutus and Cassius at odds)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus).

Sample answer: Brutus observes that when love "begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony."

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act IV, Scene II”? Brutus and Cassius meet in tension; Brutus asks to talk privately in his tent.

A. Alliteration

B. Metaphor

C. Characterization

D. Tone / mood

Key: C (Characterization)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Brutus on cooling friendship.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “With _____ and with respect enough; But not with such familiar instances, Nor with such free and friendly conference, As he hath used of old.” Word bank: wrangle, enlarge, deceitful, courtesy

Key: courtesy

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Before the eyes of both our armies here, Which should perceive nothing but love from us, Let us not wrangle: bid them move away; Then in my tent, Cassius, enlarge your griefs, And I will give you audience.”, what does “enlarge” most nearly mean?

A. a slave

B. to state freely; to explain fully

C. ready to form a faction; active in a cause

D. killing

Key: B (to state freely; to explain fully)

19. [short · recall · DOK 1] Who brings news of Cassius's approach and his cold manner?
    Sample answer: Lucilius (with Pindarus, Cassius's servant).
20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Cassius accuse Brutus of?
    A. Wronging him
    B. Stealing
    C. Loving Antony
    D. Betraying Rome

    Key: A (Wronging him)
21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Most noble brother, you have done me wrong” (Act IV, Scene II, Cassius)
    A. Cassius's accusation.
    B. Cassius's argument for action.
    C. Artemidorus's hope.
    D. Brutus's last words.

    Key: A (Cassius's accusation.)
22. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus)
    A. Antony's tribute.
    B. Brutus on cooling friendship.
    C. The ghost.
    D. Decius's flattery.

    Key: B (Brutus on cooling friendship.)
23. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Before the eyes of both our armies here” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Brutus's concern for appearance.
24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act IV, Scene II”? Their alliance is cracking.
    A. Hyperbole
    B. Foreshadowing
    C. Irony
    D. Setting

    Key: B (Foreshadowing)
25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is Brutus right to care so much about appearances in front of the army?
    Sample answer: Accept leadership arguments; link to his public-honor theme.
26. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Brutus on cooling friendship.
27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Most noble brother, you have done me wrong” (Act IV, Scene II, Cassius) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Cassius's accusation.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: Brutus observes that when love "begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony."
29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how friendship and loyalty develops from an earlier scene to “Act IV, Scene II”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: the friendship under strain.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 7, 5, 18, 4, 19, 20, 2, 10, 21, 22, 12, 23, 15, 24, 25	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	9, 3, 7, 5, 4, 17, 10, 26, 13, 21, 12, 23, 14, 15, 27, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	8, 3, 2, 17, 7, 11, 12, 21, 22, 26, 15, 14, 23, 24, 16, 28	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	17, 7, 20, 19, 10, 21, 22, 26, 12, 23, 24, 15, 14, 29, 28, 25	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	17, 7, 3, 10, 11, 26, 12, 24, 15, 14, 23, 29, 28, 25, 27, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Freshman	6, 7, 19, 10, 26, 13, 22, 24, 23, 14, 15, 25, 28, 27, 29, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	17, 7, 11, 12, 10, 21, 13, 15, 24, 14, 23, 28, 16, 27, 25, 29	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Junior	6, 17, 21, 22, 26, 10, 11, 15, 14, 23, 24, 29, 25, 16, 28, 27	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Senior	17, 7, 26, 12, 21, 13, 22, 14, 24, 23, 15, 25, 16, 28, 29, 27	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	17, 7, 13, 10, 22, 11, 12, 23, 15, 24, 14, 25, 16, 29, 28, 27	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act IV, Scene II,” how does Shakespeare show Brutus and Cassius at odds? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act IV, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Brutus and Cassius at odds? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act IV, Scene II develops the idea of Brutus and Cassius at odds. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of Brutus and Cassius at odds. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene II suggests about Brutus and Cassius at odds. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses conflict in Act IV, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of Brutus and Cassius at odds. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act IV, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Brutus and Cassius at odds responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act IV, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Brutus and Cassius at odds follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act IV, Scene II and its treatment of Brutus and Cassius at odds. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's conflict and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act IV, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about Brutus and Cassius at odds in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act IV, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Brutus and Cassius at odds. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *Before the eyes of both our armies here, Which should perceive nothing but love from us, Let us not wrangle: bid them move away; Then in my tent, Cassius, enlarge your griefs, And I will give you audience.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "enlarge" most nearly mean?

   A. forced; strained
   B. tricky; dishonest
   C. to state freely; to explain fully
   D. polite behavior

2. *Thou hast described A hot friend cooling: ever note, Lucilius, When love begins to sicken and decay, It useth an enforced ceremony. There are no tricks in plain and simple faith; But hollow men, like horses hot at hand, Make gallant show and promise of their mettle; But when they should endure the bloody spur, They fall their crests, and, like deceitful jades, Sink in the trial. Comes his army on?*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act IV, Scene II"?

   A. The death of Cassius
   B. The tribunes and the fickle crowd
   C. Portia's anxiety
   D. Brutus and Cassius at odds

SAT key: 1. C (to state freely; to explain fully); 2. D (Brutus and Cassius at odds)

Lesson 15: Act IV, Scene III

Focus: the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost

Objective: Students will analyze how conflict develops in “Act IV, Scene III” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (suicide (reported), alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Brutus reports that Portia 'swallow'd fire.' Use the safe-messaging script; focus on Brutus's response and the strain of the war. This section mentions drinking or a drug (“…. Exeunt Lucilius and Titinius. Lucius, a bowl of wine! Exit Lucius. I did not think you could…”). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: This scene reports a death by suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read.
Suggested language: “What does Brutus's reaction show about him?”
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this scene is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

In the tent, Cassius protests that Brutus condemned Lucius Pella for bribery despite his letters. Brutus accuses Cassius of an 'itching palm' and of refusing him gold to pay his legions, while insisting he himself will not raise money by vile means. They trade insults until Cassius offers Brutus his dagger and his heart; they reconcile. Brutus reveals that Portia is dead: she 'swallow'd fire.' Messala brings news that the triumvirs have killed many senators (seventy or a hundred), Cicero among them. Brutus overrules Cassius again and decides to march to Philippi: 'There is a tide in the affairs of men.' Late at night, as Lucius sleeps, Caesar's ghost appears and says Brutus will see him at Philippi.

Background: Plutarch reports that Brutus saw a spirit before the battle, calling itself his evil genius. Portia's death is reported in two ways in the scene (Brutus tells Cassius, then appears to learn it again from Messala), which many editors think shows two versions of the scene surviving in the Folio.

Significance: The quarrel exposes the gap between Brutus's ideals and the realities of war. His third bad decision (to march to Philippi) and the ghost both point to the ending. Note: this scene reports a suicide (Portia); preview with students.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Can someone stay perfectly principled while leading an army? What would it cost? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to friendship and loyalty because.... Content note before we start: This scene reports a death by suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: Can someone stay perfectly principled while leading an army? What would it cost?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to friendship and loyalty because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: friendship saved, but the cause doomed.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: jigging — rhyming in a silly, sing-song way; counters — worthless metal tokens used in counting; niggard — to supply sparingly (here, to cut short with a little sleep); itching — greedy (an itching palm wants bribes); thunderbolts — bolts of lightning (Jove's weapon). "thunderbolts": Origin of "thunderbolt": an English formation from thunder + bolt.
Words: jigging: rhyming in a silly, sing-song way · counters: worthless metal tokens used in counting · niggard: to supply sparingly (here, to cut short with a little sleep) · itching: greedy (an itching palm wants bribes) · thunderbolts: bolts of lightning (Jove's weapon)

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Plutarch reports that Brutus saw a spirit before the battle, calling itself his evil genius. Portia's death is reported in two ways in the scene (Brutus tells Cassius, then appears to learn it again from Messala), which many editors think shows two versions of the scene surviving in the Folio. The quarrel exposes the gap between Brutus's ideals and the realities of war. His third bad decision (to march to Philippi) and the ghost both point to the ending. Note: this scene reports a suicide (Portia); preview with students. Dialogue: The quarrel: Brutus accuses Cassius of corruption; Cassius accuses Brutus of not loving him; they reconcile. Characterization: Brutus reveals Portia's death calmly; the ghost of Caesar appears. Structure: The scene moves from rage to tenderness to the supernatural. Watch for warnings ignored: Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: "Pella / For taking bribes here of the Sardians; / Wherein my letters, praying on his side, / Because I knew the man, were slighted" (Act IV, Scene III, Cassius).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Portia is dead" slowly and put it in my own words: After their quarrel, Brutus quietly tells Cassius that his wife Portia is dead. Next, craft. I notice the short, plain sentence, with no outburst of grief. The strongest word is "dead": it is blunt, matching his stoic control. Then, effect. What does Brutus reveal to Cassius, and how? My answer: Brutus reveals to Cassius that Portia is dead, and he reveals it calmly and briefly; his controlled grief explains his anger in the quarrel and shows how much the conspiracy has cost him.

> *Portia is dead* *(Act IV, Scene III, Brutus)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Portia is dead" slowly and put it in my own words: After their quarrel, Brutus quietly tells Cassius that his wife Portia is dead. Next, craft. I notice the short, plain sentence, with no outburst of grief. The strongest word is "dead": it is blunt, matching his stoic control. Then, effect. What does Brutus reveal to Cassius, and how? My answer: Brutus reveals to Cassius that Portia is dead, and he reveals it calmly and briefly; his controlled grief explains his anger in the quarrel and shows how much the conspiracy has cost him.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The tide metaphor argues for seizing the moment; ironically it leads to defeat. Ask: How does this line connect to friendship and loyalty? Expected: Friendship saved, but the cause doomed. (Brutus's argument for attacking.)

> *There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune* *(Act IV, Scene III, Brutus)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The tide metaphor argues for seizing the moment; ironically it leads to defeat.
Ask: How does this line connect to friendship and loyalty?
Expected answer: Friendship saved, but the cause doomed. (Brutus's argument for attacking.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for dialogue, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene III develops the idea of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. When the text says "There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune" (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus), it shows this directly. He reveals "Portia is dead" with stoic calm, then overrules Cassius with "There is a tide in the affairs of men," a metaphor that leads to Philippi.
Task: Annotate the scene for dialogue, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene III develops the idea of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. When the text says "There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune" (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus), it shows this directly. He reveals "Portia is dead" with stoic calm, then overrules Cassius with "There is a tide in the affairs of men," a metaphor that leads to Philippi.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Can someone stay perfectly principled while leading an army? What would it cost? Ask: why do audiences love this scene (see Digges in the intro)?
Anchor question: Can someone stay perfectly principled while leading an army? What would it cost?
Facilitation: Ask: why do audiences love this scene (see Digges in the intro)?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. ("There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune", Act IV, Scene III, Brutus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. ("There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune", Act IV, Scene III, Brutus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how dialogue shapes the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. Key takeaway: friendship saved, but the cause doomed.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Dialogue:** The quarrel: Brutus accuses Cassius of corruption; Cassius accuses Brutus of not loving him; they reconcile.
- **Characterization:** Brutus reveals Portia's death calmly; the ghost of Caesar appears.
- **Structure:** The scene moves from rage to tenderness to the supernatural.

Themes and how they develop

- **friendship and loyalty:** friendship saved, but the cause doomed.

Symbols and motifs

- **warnings ignored:** Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: “Pella / For taking bribes here of the Sardians; / Wherein my letters, praying on his side, / Because I knew the man, were slighted” (Act IV, Scene III, Cassius).
- **omens and portents:** Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: “Remember March, the ides of March remember: / Did not great Julius bleed for justice’ sake” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus) Brutus's argument for attacking.
- “Portia is dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus) Brutus's restraint.
- “Thy evil spirit, Brutus” (Act IV, Scene III, Ghost) The ghost.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

> **Claim:** The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence.
> **Evidence:** “There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus)
> **Reasoning:** He reveals "Portia is dead" with stoic calm, then overrules Cassius with "There is a tide in the affairs of men," a metaphor that leads to Philippi.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word		In context	Word history

	Definition (in this sentence)		
jigging (adjective)	rhyming in a silly, sing-song way	*I'll know his humour, when he knows his time: What should the wars do with these jigging fools?*	
counters (noun)	worthless metal tokens used in counting	*When Marcus Brutus grows so covetous, To lock such rascal counters from his friends, Be ready, gods, with all your thunderbolts; Dash him to pieces!*	
niggard (verb)	to supply sparingly (here, to cut short with a little sleep)	*The deep of night is crept upon our talk, And nature must obey necessity; Which we will niggard with a little rest.*	
itching (adjective)	greedy (an itching palm wants bribes)	*Let me tell you, Cassius, you yourself Are much condemn'd to have an itching palm; To sell and mart your offices for gold To undeservers.*	
thunderbolts (noun)	bolts of lightning (Jove's weapon)	*When Marcus Brutus grows so covetous, To lock such rascal counters from his friends, Be ready, gods, with all your thunderbolts; Dash him to pieces!*	"thunderbolts": Origin of "thunderbolt": an English formation from thunder + bolt. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/thunderbolt#Etymology)
outlawry (noun)	being declared an outlaw	*That by proscription and bills of outlawry, Octavius, Antony, and Lepidus, Have put to death an hundred senators.*	"outlawry": Origin: Medieval Latin utlagaria. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/outlawry#Etymology)
nimbleness (noun)	quickness	*This it is: 'Tis better that the enemy seek us: So shall he waste his means, weary his soldiers, Doing himself offence; whilst we, lying still, Are full of rest, defense, and nimbleness.*	"nimbleness": Origin: an English formation from nimble + -ness. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/nimbleness#Etymology)
shallows (noun)	shallow water where ships run aground	*There is a tide in the affairs of men, Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune; Omitted, all the voyage of their life Is bound in shallows and in miseries.*	
vaunting (noun)	boasting	*You say you are a better soldier: Let it appear so; make your vaunting true, And it shall please me well: for mine own part, I shall be glad to learn of noble men.*	"vaunting": Origin of "vaunt": Anglo-Norman vaunter. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/vaunt#Etymology)

choleric (adjective)	hot-tempered	*All this! ay, more: fret till your proud heart break; Go show your slaves how choleric you are, And make your bondmen tremble.*	

Discussion questions

1. Can someone stay perfectly principled while leading an army? What would it cost?
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with public versus private self?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Which famous senator does Messala report was killed by the triumvirs? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Cicero.
2. What does Brutus accuse Cassius of having? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: An itching palm
3. Why is Brutus angry that Cassius denied him gold? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He needed it to pay his legions
4. How did Portia die, as Brutus reports? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She swallowed fire
5. Where does Brutus decide to march? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To Philippi
6. What does the ghost tell Brutus? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He will see him at Philippi
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act IV, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In the tent, Cassius protests that Brutus condemned Lucius Pella for bribery despite his letters. Brutus accuses Cassius of an 'itching palm' and of refusing him gold to pay his legions, while insisting he himself will not raise money by vile means. They trade insults until Cassius offers Brutus his dagger and his heart; they reconcile. Brutus reveals that Portia is dead: she 'swallow'd fire.'…
8. Who is on stage in "Act IV, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act IV, Scene III" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.

10. Reread: “I’ll know his humour, when he knows his time: What should the wars do with these jigging fools?” What does “jigging” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: jigging: rhyming in a silly, sing-song way.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why might Brutus hide his grief about Portia when Messala brings the news? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: To appear stoic and steady in front of his officers.
2. What does “Act IV, Scene III” suggest about the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The quarrel exposes the gap between Brutus's ideals and the realities of war. His third bad decision (to march to Philippi) and the ghost both point to the ending. Note: this scene reports a suicide (Portia); preview with students.
3. Find one example of conflict in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: “There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus): Brutus's argument for attacking. On characterization: Brutus reveals Portia's death calmly; the ghost of Caesar appears. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “All this!”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act IV, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: In the tent, Cassius protests that Brutus condemned Lucius Pella for bribery despite his letters. Brutus accuses Cassius of an 'itching palm' and of refusing him gold to pay his legions, while insisting he himself will not raise money by vile means. They trade insults until Cassius offers Brutus…
7. How does “Act IV, Scene III” build on “Act IV, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: “Portia is dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus): Brutus's restraint. On structure: The scene moves from rage to tenderness to the supernatural. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: “Thy evil spirit, Brutus” (Act IV, Scene III, Ghost): The ghost. On characterization: Brutus reveals Portia's death calmly; the ghost of Caesar appears. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can someone stay perfectly principled while leading an army? What would it cost?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with public versus private self? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: “There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus): Brutus's argument for attacking. Theme link: friendship saved, but the cause doomed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Brutus refuses to raise money by 'vile means' but expects Cassius's gold. Is that hypocrisy or idealism? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Strong answers note he benefits from methods he condemns.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: “Portia is dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus): Brutus's restraint. Theme link: friendship saved, but the cause doomed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The quarrel exposes the gap between Brutus's ideals and the realities of war. His third bad decision (to march to Philippi) and the ghost both point to the ending. Note: this scene reports a suicide (Portia); preview with students.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: “Thy evil spirit, Brutus” (Act IV, Scene III, Ghost): The ghost. Theme link: friendship saved, but the cause doomed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: “There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus): Brutus's argument for attacking. On characterization: Brutus reveals Portia's death calmly; the ghost of Caesar appears. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal

confidence. Useful evidence: “Portia is dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus): Brutus's restraint. On structure: The scene moves from rage to tenderness to the supernatural. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act IV, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: “Thy evil spirit, Brutus” (Act IV, Scene III, Ghost): The ghost. Theme link: friendship saved, but the cause doomed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate, omens and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: “There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus): Brutus's argument for attacking. Theme link: friendship saved, but the cause doomed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the conflict in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: “Portia is dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus): Brutus's restraint. Theme link: friendship saved, but the cause doomed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene III” treats the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: “Thy evil spirit, Brutus” (Act IV, Scene III, Ghost): The ghost. Theme link: friendship saved, but the cause doomed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act V, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: “There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus): Brutus's argument for attacking. Theme link: friendship saved, but the cause doomed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: "Portia is dead" (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus): Brutus's restraint. Theme link: friendship saved, but the cause doomed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How did Portia die, as Brutus reports?

   A. She swallowed fire

   B. She drowned

   C. She was poisoned

   D. She fell ill

   Key: A (She swallowed fire)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does Brutus decide to march?

   A. To Egypt

   B. To Philippi

   C. Back to Rome

   D. To Sardis

   Key: B (To Philippi)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "That by proscription and bills of _____, Octavius, Antony, and Lepidus, Have put to death an hundred senators." Word bank: outlawry, counters, niggard, jigging

   Key: outlawry

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "I'll know his humour, when he knows his time: What should the wars do with these jigging fools?", what does "jigging" most nearly mean?

   A. food for horses

   B. rhyming in a silly, sing-song way

   C. formal politeness

   D. winners in battle

   Key: B (rhyming in a silly, sing-song way)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "This it is: 'Tis better that the enemy seek us: So shall he waste his means, weary his soldiers, Doing himself offence; whilst we, lying still, Are full of rest, defense, and _____." Word bank: jigging, nimbleness, niggard, counters

   Key: nimbleness

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The deep of night is crept upon our talk, And nature must obey necessity; Which we will niggard with a little rest.”, what does “niggard” most nearly mean?

   A. outskirts; the edges of something

   B. to supply sparingly (here, to cut short with a little sleep)

   C. base criminals (here, the citizens mean the conspirators)

   D. to take into service

   Key: B (to supply sparingly (here, to cut short with a little sleep))

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “There is a tide in the affairs of men, Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune; Omitted, all the voyage of their life Is bound in _____ and in miseries.” Word bank: jigging, niggard, counters, shallows

   Key: shallows

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene III, Brutus: “There is a tide in the _____ of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune”

   Key: affairs

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why is Brutus angry that Cassius denied him gold?

   A. He wanted to bribe Antony

   B. He wanted to buy a crown

   C. He owed Portia

   D. He needed it to pay his legions

   Key: D (He needed it to pay his legions)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why might Brutus hide his grief about Portia when Messala brings the news?

    Sample answer: To appear stoic and steady in front of his officers.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act IV, Scene III”?

    A. Brutus decides

    B. Cassius works on Brutus

    C. The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost

    D. The funeral orations

    Key: C (The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Brutus's argument for attacking.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus)

    A. The proscription.

    B. The cobbler's pun on soles/souls.

    C. Brutus's argument for attacking.

    D. Young Cato.

    Key: C (Brutus's argument for attacking.)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus).
    Sample answer: He reveals "Portia is dead" with stoic calm, then overrules Cassius with "There is a tide in the affairs of men," a metaphor that leads to Philippi.
15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Thy evil spirit, Brutus” (Act IV, Scene III, Ghost). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: The ghost.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Brutus refuses to raise money by 'vile means' but expects Cassius's gold. Is that hypocrisy or idealism?
    Sample answer: Strong answers note he benefits from methods he condemns.
17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Let me tell you, Cassius, you yourself Are much condemn’d to have an itching palm; To sell and mart your offices for gold To undeservers.”, what does “itching” most nearly mean?
    A. to smear all over
    B. payments to free captives
    C. greedy (an itching palm wants bribes)
    D. to foretell

    Key: C (greedy (an itching palm wants bribes))
18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the ghost tell Brutus?
    A. Portia forgives him
    B. He will see him at Philippi
    C. He should flee
    D. Antony will win

    Key: B (He will see him at Philippi)
19. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Thy evil spirit, Brutus” (Act IV, Scene III, Ghost)
    A. Portia's frustration.
    B. Reducing the will.
    C. Brutus's decision.
    D. The ghost.

    Key: D (The ghost.)
20. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act IV, Scene III”? Brutus reveals Portia's death calmly; the ghost of Caesar appears.
    A. Structure
    B. Hyperbole
    C. Plot
    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act IV, Scene III”? The quarrel: Brutus accuses Cassius of corruption; Cassius accuses Brutus of not loving him; they reconcile.

    A. Foreshadowing

    B. Plot

    C. Dialogue

    D. Conflict

    Key: C (Dialogue)

22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: He reveals "Portia is dead" with stoic calm, then overrules Cassius with "There is a tide in the affairs of men," a metaphor that leads to Philippi.

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “When Marcus Brutus grows so covetous, To lock such rascal counters from his friends, Be ready, gods, with all your thunderbolts; Dash him to pieces!”, what does “counters” most nearly mean?

    A. worthless metal tokens used in counting

    B. the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended)

    C. to foretell

    D. clothing; here, Caesar's cloak

    Key: A (worthless metal tokens used in counting)

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Portia is dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus)

    A. Cassius's willingness to die.

    B. Brutus's restraint.

    C. The ideal.

    D. Caesar's hubris just before his death.

    Key: B (Brutus's restraint.)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Portia is dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Brutus's restraint.

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “When Marcus Brutus grows so covetous, To lock such rascal counters from his friends, Be ready, gods, with all your _____; Dash him to pieces!” Word bank: niggard, thunderbolts, counters, jigging

    Key: thunderbolts

27. [short · recall · DOK 1] Which famous senator does Messala report was killed by the triumvirs?

    Sample answer: Cicero.

28. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Portia is dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Brutus's restraint.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how friendship and loyalty develops from an earlier scene to “Act IV, Scene III”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: friendship saved, but the cause doomed.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune" (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Brutus's argument for attacking.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 3, 4, 7, 9, 2, 18, 5, 10, 13, 12, 19, 20, 21, 15, 22	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	17, 2, 7, 5, 23, 18, 11, 24, 12, 19, 10, 15, 14, 21, 16, 25	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	26, 3, 27, 4, 17, 13, 12, 11, 24, 28, 21, 14, 15, 20, 25, 22	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	26, 3, 6, 1, 10, 11, 28, 12, 24, 21, 20, 14, 15, 22, 25, 29	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	3, 9, 8, 28, 11, 13, 24, 20, 21, 15, 14, 30, 16, 25, 22, 29	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Freshman	26, 5, 27, 11, 12, 19, 24, 20, 21, 14, 15, 22, 16, 25, 30, 29	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	26, 3, 28, 19, 11, 13, 10, 15, 21, 14, 20, 22, 16, 25, 29, 30	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Junior	26, 3, 13, 10, 19, 11, 28, 14, 21, 20, 15, 25, 30, 29, 16, 22	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Senior	26, 3, 11, 19, 13, 12, 28, 14, 15, 21, 20, 29, 25, 30, 16, 22	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	26, 3, 24, 10, 13, 28, 19, 20, 21, 14, 15, 25, 16, 22, 29, 30	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act IV, Scene III," how does Shakespeare show the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act IV, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act IV, Scene III develops the idea of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene III suggests about the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses conflict in Act IV, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act IV, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act IV, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act IV, Scene III and its treatment of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's conflict and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act IV, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act IV, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *The deep of night is crept upon our talk, And nature must obey necessity; Which we will niggard with a little rest.*

As used in the text, what does the word "niggard" most nearly mean?

A. to supply sparingly (here, to cut short with a little sleep)

B. shallow water where ships run aground

C. boasting

D. hot-tempered

2. *All this! ay, more: fret till your proud heart break; Go show your slaves how choleric you are, And make your bondmen tremble. Must I budge? Must I observe you? must I stand and crouch Under your testy humour? By the gods, You shall digest the venom of your spleen, Though it do split you; for, from this day forth, I'll use you for my mirth, yea, for my laughter, When you are waspish.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act IV, Scene III"?

A. The tribunes and the fickle crowd

B. Brutus decides

C. The funeral orations

D. The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost

SAT key: 1. A (to supply sparingly (here, to cut short with a little sleep)); 2. D (The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost)

Lesson 16: Act V, Scene I

Focus: parley before battle

Objective: Students will analyze how conflict develops in "Act V, Scene I" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

At Philippi, Octavius notes the enemy has come down to fight. The generals meet and exchange insults: Antony mocks the conspirators' flattery of Caesar; Cassius reminds Brutus he should have killed Antony. Octavius refuses to give way to Antony's order on the field. Cassius tells Messala it is his birthday and that he now half believes in omens: eagles have left their banners and ravens fly overhead. Brutus and Cassius say farewell, uncertain whether they will meet again; Brutus says he would not go bound to Rome.

Background: The battles of Philippi in Macedonia (42 BC) ended the republican cause. Cassius had followed Epicurus, whose followers did not believe omens.

Significance: Octavius's quiet defiance of Antony foreshadows the future (he will become the emperor Augustus). Cassius's change of mind on omens and the farewells build dread.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *How do people prepare to face something they may not survive? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and omens because....*
> **Prompt:** How do people prepare to face something they may not survive?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to fate and omens because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: stomachs — courage; appetite for battle; presage — to foretell; avenged — paid back with punishment; posture — stance; manner of attack; arguing — debating; quarreling. "stomachs": Origin of "stomach": Old French estomac; earlier Latin stomachus.*
> **Words:** stomachs: courage; appetite for battle · presage: to foretell · avenged: paid back with punishment · posture: stance; manner of attack · arguing: debating; quarreling

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The battles of Philippi in Macedonia (42 BC) ended the republican cause. Cassius had followed Epicurus, whose followers did not believe omens. Octavius's quiet defiance of Antony foreshadows the future (he will become the emperor Augustus). Cassius's change of mind on omens and the farewells build dread. Dialogue: Before battle the two sides trade insults; Brutus and Cassius say farewell "for ever and for ever." Characterization: Cassius, an Epicurean who scorned omens, now half believes them; it is his birthday. Watch for omens and portents: Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: "mind. But this same day / Must end that work the ides of March begun; / And whether we shall meet again I know" (Act V, Scene I, Brutus).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "In your bad strokes, Brutus, you give good words" slowly and put it in my own words: Antony tells Brutus that he gives good words while striking bad blows. Next, craft. I notice the contrast between "bad strokes" and "good words." The strongest word is "strokes": it means blows of a sword, recalling the stabbing of Caesar. Then, effect. What does Antony accuse Brutus of before the battle? My answer: Antony calls Brutus a hypocrite who spoke of love for Caesar while killing him; the taunt reminds the audience that Brutus's noble words cannot erase the murder.

> *In your bad strokes, Brutus, you give good words* (Act V, Scene I, Antony)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "In your bad strokes, Brutus, you give good words" slowly and put it in my own words: Antony tells Brutus that he gives good words while striking bad blows. Next, craft. I notice the contrast between "bad strokes" and "good words." The strongest word is "strokes": it means blows of a sword, recalling the stabbing of Caesar. Then, effect. What does Antony accuse Brutus of before the battle? My answer: Antony calls Brutus a hypocrite who spoke of love for Caesar while killing him; the taunt reminds the audience that Brutus's noble words cannot erase the murder.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The farewell foreshadows death; the birthday makes his death circular. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and omens? Expected: The eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. (Brutus's farewell.)

> *Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius* (Act V, Scene I, Brutus)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The farewell foreshadows death; the birthday makes his death circular.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and omens?
Expected answer: The eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. (Brutus's farewell.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for dialogue, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about parley before battle? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene I develops the idea of parley before battle. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. When the text says “Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus), it shows this directly. Brutus's "Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius" is a final goodbye, and Cassius notes "This is my birth-day."
Task: Annotate the scene for dialogue, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about parley before battle? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene I develops the idea of parley before battle. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. When the text says “Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus), it shows this directly. Brutus's "Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius" is a final goodbye, and Cassius notes "This is my birth-day."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How do people prepare to face something they may not survive? Ask: what has changed in Cassius since Act I?
Anchor question: How do people prepare to face something they may not survive?
Facilitation: Ask: what has changed in Cassius since Act I?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about parley before battle? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. (“Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius”, Act V, Scene I, Brutus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about parley before battle? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. (“Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius”, Act V, Scene I, Brutus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how dialogue shapes parley before battle. Key takeaway: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Dialogue:** Before battle the two sides trade insults; Brutus and Cassius say farewell "for ever and for ever."
- **Characterization:** Cassius, an Epicurean who scorned omens, now half believes them; it is his birthday.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and omens:** the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites.

Symbols and motifs

- **omens and portents:** Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: “mind. But this same day / Must end that work the ides of March begun; / And whether we shall meet again I know” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus).
- **honour:** "Honourable" is a key word; Antony turns it into irony in the funeral oration. In this scene: “of thy strain, / Young man, thou couldst not die more honourable” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “In your bad strokes, Brutus, you give good words” (Act V, Scene I, Antony) Antony's taunt about rhetoric.
- “Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus) Brutus's farewell.
- “This is my birth-day; as this very day / Was Cassius born” (Act V, Scene I, Cassius) Cassius notes it is his birthday: the day of birth may be the day of death.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle.
Evidence: “Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus)
Reasoning: Brutus's "Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius" is a final goodbye, and Cassius notes "This is my birth-day."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
stomachs (noun)	courage; appetite for battle	*Defiance, traitors, hurl we in your teeth: If you dare fight to-day, come to the field; If not, when you have stomachs.*	“stomachs”: Origin of “stomach”: Old French estomac; earlier Latin stomachus. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/stomach#Etymology)

presage (verb)	to foretell	*You know that I held Epicurus strong And his opinion: now I change my mind, And partly credit things that do presage.*	
avenged (verb)	paid back with punishment	*Never, till Caesar's three and thirty wounds Be well avenged; or till another Caesar Have added slaughter to the sword of traitors.*	
posture (noun)	stance; manner of attack	*Antony, The posture of your blows are yet unknown; But for your words, they rob the Hybla bees, And leave them honeyless.*	
arguing (noun)	debating; quarreling	*Come, come, the cause: if arguing make us sweat, The proof of it will turn to redder drops.*	
soundless (adjective)	without sound; silent	*O, yes, and soundless too; For you have stol'n their buzzing, Antony, And very wisely threat before you sting.*	
peevish (adjective)	irritable; childish	*A peevish schoolboy, worthless of such honour, Join'd with a masker and a reveller!*	
bravery (noun)	showy display	*Tut, I am in their bosoms, and I know Wherefore they do it: they could be content To visit other places; and come down With fearful bravery, thinking by this face To fasten in our thoughts that they have courage; But 'tis not so.*	"bravery": Origin: Middle French braverie. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/bravery#Etymology)
schoolboy (noun)	a boy at school	*A peevish schoolboy, worthless of such honour, Join'd with a masker and a reveller!*	"schoolboy": Origin: an English formation from school + boy. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/schoolboy#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. How do people prepare to face something they may not survive?
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate, omens and free will?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20,

21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. How many wounds does Octavius say Caesar received? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Three and thirty.
2. Where does the battle take place? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Philippi
3. What does Cassius tell Messala about this day? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: It is his birthday
4. Which birds does Cassius say have replaced the eagles? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Ravens, crows and kites
5. Whose philosophy had Cassius followed? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Epicurus
6. What does Brutus say he will never do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Go bound to Rome as a captive
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: At Philippi, Octavius notes the enemy has come down to fight. The generals meet and exchange insults: Antony mocks the conspirators' flattery of Caesar; Cassius reminds Brutus he should have killed Antony. Octavius refuses to give way to Antony's order on the field. Cassius tells Messala it is his birthday and that he now half believes in omens: eagles have left their banners and ravens fly…
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Defiance, traitors, hurl we in your teeth: If you dare fight to-day, come to the field; If not, when you have stomachs." What does "stomachs" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: stomachs: courage; appetite for battle.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does Octavius's refusal to take Antony's command suggest about the future? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: He will not be Antony's junior; he will rise to rule.
2. What does "Act V, Scene I" suggest about parley before battle? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Octavius's quiet defiance of Antony foreshadows the future (he will become the emperor Augustus). Cassius's change of mind on omens and the farewells build dread.
3. Find one example of conflict in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about parley before battle? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “In your bad strokes, Brutus, you give good words” (Act V, Scene I, Antony): Antony's taunt about rhetoric. On characterization: Cassius, an Epicurean who scorned omens, now half believes them; it is his birthday. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Tut, I am in their bosoms, and I know Wherefore they do it: they could be content To visit other places; and come down With fearful bravery, thinking by this face To fasten in our…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: At Philippi, Octavius notes the enemy has come down to fight. The generals meet and exchange insults: Antony mocks the conspirators' flattery of Caesar; Cassius reminds Brutus he should have killed Antony. Octavius refuses to give way to Antony's order on the field. Cassius tells Messala it is his…
7. How does “Act V, Scene I” build on “Act IV, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus): Brutus's farewell. Theme link: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “This is my birth-day; as this very day / Was Cassius born” (Act V, Scene I, Cassius): Cassius notes it is his birthday: the day of birth may be the day of death. On characterization: Cassius, an Epicurean who scorned omens, now half believes them; it is his birthday. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How do people prepare to face something they may not survive?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate, omens and free will? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “In your bad strokes, Brutus, you give good words” (Act V, Scene I, Antony): Antony's taunt about rhetoric. Theme link: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Brutus's and Cassius's farewells are tender. Does that change how you judge them? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Accept answers on friendship versus political guilt.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus): Brutus's farewell. Theme link: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Octavius's quiet defiance of Antony foreshadows the future (he will become the emperor Augustus). Cassius's change of mind on omens and the farewells build dread.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “This is my birth-day; as this very day / Was Cassius born” (Act V, Scene I, Cassius): Cassius notes it is his birthday: the day of birth may be the day of death. Theme link: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “In your bad strokes, Brutus, you give good words” (Act V, Scene I, Antony): Antony's taunt about rhetoric. On characterization: Cassius, an Epicurean who scorned omens, now half believes them; it is his birthday. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act V, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of parley before battle. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus): Brutus's farewell. Theme link: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “This is my birth-day; as this very day / Was Cassius born” (Act V, Scene I, Cassius): Cassius notes it is his birthday: the day of birth may be the day of death. Theme link: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to power, ambition and tyranny: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2]

Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “In your bad strokes, Brutus, you give good words” (Act V, Scene I, Antony): Antony's taunt about rhetoric. Theme link: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the conflict in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus): Brutus's farewell. Theme link: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act V, Scene I” treats parley before battle with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “This is my birth-day; as this very day / Was Cassius born” (Act V, Scene I, Cassius): Cassius notes it is his birthday: the day of birth may be the day of death. Theme link: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act V, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “In your bad strokes, Brutus, you give good words” (Act V, Scene I, Antony): Antony's taunt about rhetoric. Theme link: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about parley before battle? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus): Brutus's farewell. Theme link: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which birds does Cassius say have replaced the eagles?
   A. Swans
   B. Doves
   C. Owls
   D. Ravens, crows and kites

   Key: D (Ravens, crows and kites)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does the battle take place?
   A. Sardis
   B. Philippi
   C. Actium
   D. Rome

   Key: B (Philippi)
3. [short · recall · DOK 1] How many wounds does Octavius say Caesar received?
   Sample answer: Three and thirty.
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whose philosophy had Cassius followed?
   A. Epicurus
   B. Plato
   C. Socrates
   D. Zeno

   Key: A (Epicurus)
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "You know that I held Epicurus strong And his opinion: now I change my mind, And partly credit things that do presage.", what does "presage" most nearly mean?
   A. poisoned
   B. a slave
   C. to foretell
   D. winners in battle

   Key: C (to foretell)
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Defiance, traitors, hurl we in your teeth: If you dare fight to-day, come to the field; If not, when you have stomachs.", what does "stomachs" most nearly mean?
   A. courage; appetite for battle
   B. explained; interpreted
   C. internal organs (of a sacrificed animal)
   D. formal politeness

   Key: A (courage; appetite for battle)
7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "A _____ schoolboy, worthless of such honour, Join'd with a masker and a reveller!" Word bank: avenged, stomachs, peevish, presage
   Key: peevish

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene I, Antony: “In your bad _____, Brutus, you give good words”
   Key: strokes
9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Tut, I am in their bosoms, and I know Wherefore they do it: they could be content To visit other places; and come down With fearful _____, thinking by this face To fasten in our thoughts that they have courage; But ’tis not so.” Word bank: bravery, stomachs, presage, avenged
   Key: bravery
10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “In your bad strokes, Brutus, you give good words” (Act V, Scene I, Antony) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Antony's taunt about rhetoric.
11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Brutus's farewell.
12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus)
    A. Brutus's farewell.
    B. Antony's prophecy of civil war.
    C. Urgency.
    D. The ideal.

    Key: A (Brutus's farewell.)
13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “This is my birth-day; as this very day / Was Cassius born” (Act V, Scene I, Cassius)
    A. The cobbler's pun on soles/souls.
    B. Antony on Lepidus.
    C. Caesar's courage or pride.
    D. Cassius notes it is his birthday: the day of birth may be the day of death.

    Key: D (Cassius notes it is his birthday: the day of birth may be the day of death.)
14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus).
    Sample answer: Brutus's "Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius" is a final goodbye, and Cassius notes "This is my birth-day."
15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “This is my birth-day; as this very day / Was Cassius born” (Act V, Scene I, Cassius). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Cassius notes it is his birthday: the day of birth may be the day of death.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Brutus's farewell.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Antony, The posture of your blows are yet unknown; But for your words, they rob the Hybla bees, And leave them honeyless.”, what does “posture” most nearly mean?

    A. courageously

    B. to stand over with legs wide apart

    C. stance; manner of attack

    D. short knives used as weapons

    Key: C (stance; manner of attack)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Cassius tell Messala about this day?

    A. It is the ides of March

    B. It is his birthday

    C. It is Portia's birthday

    D. It is a holy day

    Key: B (It is his birthday)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Never, till Caesar’s three and thirty wounds Be well avenged; or till another Caesar Have added slaughter to the sword of traitors.”, what does “avenged” most nearly mean?

    A. greedy (an itching palm wants bribes)

    B. slavery; captivity

    C. paid back with punishment

    D. deeply unhappy

    Key: C (paid back with punishment)

20. [short · inference · DOK 2] What does Octavius's refusal to take Antony's command suggest about the future?

    Sample answer: He will not be Antony's junior; he will rise to rule.

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act V, Scene I”?

    A. Cinna the poet

    B. The assassination

    C. The cast and world of the play

    D. Parley before battle

    Key: D (Parley before battle)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene I”? Before battle the two sides trade insults; Brutus and Cassius say farewell "for ever and for ever."

    A. Setting

    B. Dialogue

    C. Imagery

    D. Structure

    Key: B (Dialogue)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene I”? Cassius, an Epicurean who scorned omens, now half believes them; it is his birthday.

    A. Tone / mood

    B. Diction / vocabulary

C. Characterization

D. Conflict

Key: C (Characterization)

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Come, come, the cause: if _____ make us sweat, The proof of it will turn to redder drops.” Word bank: arguing, stomachs, presage, avenged

    Key: arguing

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene I, Cassius: “This is my birth-day; as this very day / Was _____ born”

    Key: Cassius

26. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “In your bad strokes, Brutus, you give good words” (Act V, Scene I, Antony)

    A. Cassius's death.

    B. Brutus's restraint.

    C. Antony's taunt about rhetoric.

    D. One of only two women, both wives who are not heard by their husbands.

    Key: C (Antony's taunt about rhetoric.)

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how fate and omens develops from an earlier scene to “Act V, Scene I”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Brutus's and Cassius's farewells are tender. Does that change how you judge them?

    Sample answer: Accept answers on friendship versus political guilt.

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Brutus say he will never do?

    A. Fight Antony

    B. Read the will

    C. Go bound to Rome as a captive

    D. Forgive Cassius

    Key: C (Go bound to Rome as a captive)

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “In your bad strokes, Brutus, you give good words” (Act V, Scene I, Antony) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Antony's taunt about rhetoric.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “O, yes, and _____ too; For you have stol’n their buzzing, Antony, And very wisely threat before you sting.” Word bank: soundless, avenged, stomachs, presage

    Key: soundless

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: Brutus's "Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius" is a final goodbye, and Cassius notes "This is my birth-day."

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix

Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 2, 6, 19, 8, 3, 7, 10, 20, 13, 21, 22, 14, 23, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	24, 1, 25, 6, 9, 17, 12, 20, 13, 10, 26, 22, 14, 15, 27, 28	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	7, 29, 25, 9, 18, 26, 12, 10, 11, 13, 22, 15, 14, 23, 16, 30	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	24, 5, 8, 7, 21, 20, 13, 11, 10, 14, 22, 15, 23, 30, 27, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	24, 31, 6, 13, 26, 21, 20, 23, 14, 15, 22, 28, 16, 27, 30, 32	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Freshman	24, 3, 8, 10, 13, 26, 11, 23, 15, 22, 14, 16, 32, 28, 30, 27	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	24, 25, 13, 26, 20, 21, 10, 23, 14, 22, 15, 27, 30, 16, 32, 28	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Junior	24, 25, 21, 11, 20, 12, 26, 22, 15, 14, 23, 16, 30, 27, 32, 28	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Senior	9, 24, 12, 21, 11, 20, 13, 15, 14, 22, 23, 16, 27, 30, 28, 32	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	8, 24, 11, 10, 26, 20, 21, 14, 15, 22, 23, 28, 32, 16, 27, 30	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act V, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show parley before battle? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of parley before battle? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene I develops the idea of parley before battle. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of parley before battle. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene I suggests about parley before battle. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses conflict in Act V, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of parley before battle. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act V, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of parley before battle responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act V, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of parley before battle follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene I and its treatment of parley before battle. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's conflict and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about parley before battle in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of parley before battle. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *Never, till Caesar's three and thirty wounds Be well avenged; or till another Caesar Have added slaughter to the sword of traitors.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "avenged" most nearly mean?

   A. irritable; childish

   B. paid back with punishment

   C. showy display

   D. a boy at school

2. *Tut, I am in their bosoms, and I know Wherefore they do it: they could be content To visit other places; and come down With fearful bravery, thinking by this face To fasten in our thoughts that they have courage; But 'tis not so.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene I"?

A. Brutus and Cassius at odds

B. The triumvirs' proscription list

C. Parley before battle

D. Storm, omens and recruitment

SAT key: 1. B (paid back with punishment); 2. C (Parley before battle)

Lesson 17: Act V, Scene II

Focus: the first charge

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Act V, Scene II (the first charge) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1

Teacher only · spoilers

Brutus sends Messala with written orders for his legions to charge at once, because he sees coldness in Octavius's wing and hopes a sudden attack will overthrow it.

Background: Act V, Scene II is one of the shortest scenes in Shakespeare, a quick cut in battle.

Significance: Brutus's eagerness in battle mirrors his haste in other decisions; the quick cutting between scenes creates the feel of a confused battlefield.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How do filmmakers and playwrights show the confusion of battle? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and omens because....
Prompt: How do filmmakers and playwrights show the confusion of battle?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and omens because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Brutus's haste.

8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Act V, Scene II is one of the shortest scenes in Shakespeare, a quick cut in battle. Brutus's eagerness in battle mirrors his haste in other decisions; the quick cutting between scenes creates the feel of a confused battlefield. Structure: A three-line scene: Brutus sends Messala with orders to attack. Pacing: Short scenes speed up the battle. Watch for warnings ignored: Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: "Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills / Unto the legions on the other side. Loud alarum. / Let them" (Act V, Scene II, Brutus).

16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how structure shapes the first charge. Key takeaway: Brutus's haste.

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Structure:** A three-line scene: Brutus sends Messala with orders to attack.
- **Pacing:** Short scenes speed up the battle.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and omens:** Brutus's haste.

Symbols and motifs

- **warnings ignored:** Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: “Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills / Unto the legions on the other side. Loud alarum. / Let them” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus) Urgency.
- “Let them set on at once” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus) Haste.
- “sudden push gives them the overthrow” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus) Brutus's hope.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy.
Evidence: “Let them set on at once” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus)
Reasoning: "Let them set on at once," he orders.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
overthrow (noun)	defeat	*Let them set on at once; for I perceive But cold demeanour in Octavius' wing, And sudden push gives them the overthrow.*	“overthrow”: Origin: an English formation from over- + throw. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/overthrow#Etymology)
legions (noun)	Roman army units	*Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills Unto the legions on the other side.*	

Discussion questions

1. How do filmmakers and playwrights show the confusion of battle?
2. Where does structure appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with power, ambition and tyranny?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Brutus want his legions to do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Set on (charge) at once.
2. Whom does Brutus send with the orders? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Messala
3. Which wing of the enemy does Brutus plan to attack? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Octavius's
4. Why does Brutus think the attack will work? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He sees coldness in Octavius's wing
5. How does Brutus send his instructions? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Written bills
6. How long is this scene compared with others? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Very short
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Brutus sends Messala with written orders for his legions to charge at once, because he sees coldness in Octavius's wing and hopes a sudden attack will overthrow it.
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene II", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene II" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Let them set on at once; for I perceive But cold demeanour in Octavius' wing, And sudden push gives them the overthrow." What does "overthrow" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: overthrow: defeat.

Inferential / analytical

1. What can you infer about Brutus's mood from this brief scene? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Urgent, hopeful, perhaps rash.
2. What does "Act V, Scene II" suggest about the first charge? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Brutus's eagerness in battle mirrors his haste in other decisions; the quick cutting between scenes creates the feel of a confused battlefield.

3. Find one example of structure in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
4. How does the conflict in this scene shape what we understand about the first charge? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus): Urgency. Theme link: Brutus's haste. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills Unto the legions on the other side.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Brutus sends Messala with written orders for his legions to charge at once, because he sees coldness in Octavius's wing and hopes a sudden attack will overthrow it.
7. How does “Act V, Scene II” build on “Act V, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “Let them set on at once” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus): Haste. On structure: A three-line scene: Brutus sends Messala with orders to attack. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “sudden push gives them the overthrow” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus): Brutus's hope. Theme link: Brutus's haste. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How do filmmakers and playwrights show the confusion of battle?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does setting appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with power, ambition and tyranny? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus): Urgency. Theme link: Brutus's haste. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Why might Shakespeare break the battle into many short scenes rather than one long one? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Pacing, confusion, multiple viewpoints.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “Let them set on at once” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus): Haste. Theme link: Brutus's haste. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Brutus's eagerness in battle mirrors his haste in other decisions; the quick cutting between scenes creates the feel of a confused battlefield.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “sudden push gives them the overthrow” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus): Brutus's hope. Theme link: Brutus's haste. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus): Urgency. Theme link: Brutus's haste. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act V, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the first charge. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “Let them set on at once” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus): Haste. On structure: A three-line scene: Brutus sends Messala with orders to attack. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “sudden push gives them the overthrow” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus): Brutus's hope. Theme link: Brutus's haste. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to honor and self-deception: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus): Urgency. Theme link: Brutus's haste. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the structure in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “Let them set on at once” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus): Haste. On structure: A three-line scene: Brutus sends Messala with orders to attack. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act V, Scene II” treats the first charge with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “sudden push gives them the overthrow” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus): Brutus's hope. Theme link: Brutus's haste. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act V, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus): Urgency. Theme link: Brutus's haste. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the first charge? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “Let them set on at once” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus): Haste. Theme link: Brutus's haste. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Structure:** look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Let them set on at once; for I perceive But cold demeanour in Octavius’ wing, And sudden push gives them the overthrow.”, what does “overthrow” most nearly mean?
   A. defeat
   B. wicked; good-for-nothing
   C. internal organs (of a sacrificed animal)
   D. to help; to favor

Key: A (defeat)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whom does Brutus send with the orders?

   A. Titinius

   B. Lucilius

   C. Messala

   D. Pindarus

   Key: C (Messala)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene II, Brutus: “sudden push gives them the _____”

   Key: overthrow

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Let them set on at once; for I perceive But cold demeanour in Octavius’ wing, And sudden push gives them the _____.” Word bank: overthrow, legions

   Key: overthrow

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which wing of the enemy does Brutus plan to attack?

   A. Lepidus's

   B. Octavius's

   C. Cassius's

   D. Antony's

   Key: B (Octavius's)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene II, Brutus: “Ride, ride, _____, ride, and give these bills”

   Key: Messala

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills Unto the _____ on the other side.” Word bank: legions, overthrow

   Key: legions

8. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does Brutus want his legions to do?

   Sample answer: Set on (charge) at once.

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Brutus send his instructions?

   A. A shouted command

   B. A trumpet signal

   C. Written bills

   D. A messenger bird

   Key: C (Written bills)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Urgency.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus)

    A. Decius's flattery.

    B. Urgency.

C. Antony on Lepidus.

D. Artemidorus's hope.

Key: B (Urgency.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “sudden push gives them the overthrow” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus)

A. Brutus's argument for attacking.

B. Reducing the will.

C. Brutus's hope.

D. Brutus's last words.

Key: C (Brutus's hope.)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act V, Scene II”?

A. The death of Cassius

B. Cassius works on Brutus

C. The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost

D. The first charge

Key: D (The first charge)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Let them set on at once” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus).

Sample answer: "Let them set on at once," he orders.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene II”? A three-line scene: Brutus sends Messala with orders to attack.

A. Hyperbole

B. Tone / mood

C. Irony

D. Structure

Key: D (Structure)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how fate and omens develops from an earlier scene to “Act V, Scene II”. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Brutus's haste.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills Unto the legions on the other side.”, what does “legions” most nearly mean?

A. to foretell

B. Roman army units

C. internal organs (of a sacrificed animal)

D. courage; appetite for battle

Key: B (Roman army units)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does Brutus think the attack will work?

A. The gods favor him

B. Cassius told him

C. Antony is ill

D. He sees coldness in Octavius's wing

Key: D (He sees coldness in Octavius's wing)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Let them set on at once” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Haste.
20. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene II”? Short scenes speed up the battle.
    A. Hyperbole
    B. Pacing
    C. Structure
    D. Conflict

    Key: B (Pacing)
21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: "Let them set on at once," he orders.
22. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer about Brutus's mood from this brief scene?
    Sample answer: Urgent, hopeful, perhaps rash.
23. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Let them set on at once” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus)
    A. Reducing the will.
    B. Third-person speech.
    C. Haste.
    D. Brutus's decision.

    Key: C (Haste.)
24. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “sudden push gives them the overthrow” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Brutus's hope.
25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Urgency.
26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Why might Shakespeare break the battle into many short scenes rather than one long one?
    Sample answer: Pacing, confusion, multiple viewpoints.
27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Let them set on at once” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Haste.
28. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How long is this scene compared with others?
    A. The longest in the play
    B. It has no lines
    C. About average
    D. Very short

Key: D (Very short)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	4, 8, 5, 6, 1, 17, 18, 3, 12, 19, 13, 11, 15, 20, 14, 21	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	4, 3, 2, 6, 9, 18, 19, 12, 11, 22, 23, 24, 14, 20, 16, 25	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	4, 9, 3, 17, 2, 10, 22, 13, 12, 19, 20, 15, 14, 24, 21, 26	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	9, 6, 7, 18, 11, 23, 22, 13, 19, 20, 14, 15, 24, 16, 25, 21	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	1, 4, 7, 19, 10, 23, 13, 24, 15, 20, 14, 26, 16, 21, 25, 27	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Freshman	4, 7, 28, 13, 11, 23, 22, 15, 24, 20, 14, 25, 21, 16, 26, 27	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	3, 4, 22, 10, 13, 19, 12, 15, 20, 14, 24, 25, 16, 21, 27, 26	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Junior	4, 7, 19, 10, 11, 22, 23, 20, 15, 24, 14, 26, 16, 21, 27, 25	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Senior	6, 4, 13, 22, 11, 23, 10, 14, 20, 24, 15, 27, 26, 25, 16, 21	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	3, 4, 22, 12, 10, 23, 11, 24, 15, 14, 20, 21, 27, 25, 26, 16	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act V, Scene II,” how does Shakespeare show the first charge? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the structure you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the first charge? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the structure in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene II develops the idea of the first charge. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its structure shape the reader's understanding of the first charge. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene II suggests about the first charge. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's structure and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses structure in Act V, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of the first

charge. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act V, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the first charge responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act V, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the first charge follows or bends those conventions, using the structure as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene II and its treatment of the first charge. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's structure and conflict, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about the first charge in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the first charge. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills Unto the legions on the other side. Loud alarum. Let them set on at once; for I perceive But cold demeanour in Octavius' wing, And sudden push gives them the overthrow. Ride, ride, Messala: let them all come down. Exeunt.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene II"?

   A. Portia's anxiety

   B. Cinna the poet

   C. The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost

   D. The first charge

SAT key: 1. D (The first charge)

Lesson 18: Act V, Scene III

Focus: the death of Cassius

Objective: Students will analyze how conflict develops in "Act V, Scene III" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (suicide): Cassius and Titinius take their own lives after a misunderstanding. Use the safe-messaging script; discuss Roman honor codes critically and the role of misinformation, not methods.
Student preview: This scene shows two deaths by suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read.
Suggested language: "How did a mistake lead to this outcome?"
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this scene is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Cassius's men are fleeing; Brutus's troops have charged too early and turned to looting. Cassius sends Titinius to see whether nearby troops are friend or foe and asks Pindarus to watch. Pindarus mistakenly reports Titinius captured. Believing all lost, Cassius has Pindarus stab him with the sword that killed Caesar: 'Caesar, thou art revenged.' Titinius returns with a victory garland from Brutus, finds Cassius dead, and kills himself. Brutus arrives, mourns Cassius as 'the last of all the Romans' and resolves to fight again.

Background: Plutarch reports that Cassius died on his birthday, killed by his freedman Pindarus at his own command, after misreading the battle.

Significance: A death built on misunderstanding: Brutus says Caesar's spirit 'turns our swords in our own proper entrails.' Note: this scene shows two suicides; preview with students.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How can a single misunderstanding lead to disaster? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and omens because.... Content note before we start: This scene shows two deaths by suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: How can a single misunderstanding lead to disaster?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and omens because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Caesar's spirit seems to win.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: envenomed — poisoned; engender — to give rise to; garland — a wreath worn as a sign of victory; revenged — avenged; freeman — a free person, no longer a slave. "envenomed": Origin of "envenom": Old French envenimer ("to poison"). "engender": Origin: Old French engendrer; earlier Latin ingenerāre.
Words: envenomed: poisoned · engender: to give rise to · garland: a wreath worn as a sign of victory · revenged: avenged · freeman: a free person, no longer a slave

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Plutarch reports that Cassius died on his birthday, killed by his freedman Pindarus at his own command, after misreading the battle. A death built on misunderstanding: Brutus says Caesar's spirit 'turns our swords in our own proper entrails.' Note: this scene shows two suicides; preview with students. Dramatic irony: Cassius misreads Titinius's capture (actually a welcome) and has Pindarus kill him. Characterization: Titinius kills himself in grief; Brutus mourns: "O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet!" Watch for blood: Blood turns the assassination from sacrifice into butchery; the conspirators bathe their hands in it. In this scene: "red rays thou dost sink to-night, / So in his red blood Cassius' day is set; / The sun of Rome is set! Our" (Act V, Scene III, Titinius).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Caesar, thou art revenged, / Even with the sword that kill'd thee" slowly and put it in my own words: Cassius tells Caesar's spirit that he is avenged with the very sword that killed him. Next, craft. I notice the irony that the same sword serves both murder and suicide. The strongest word is "revenged": it shows Caesar's spirit triumphing over his killers. Then, effect. What does Cassius say as he dies? My answer: Cassius dies by his own hand believing the battle lost; the line shows Caesar's power continues after death, defeating the conspirators.

> *Caesar, thou art revenged, / Even with the sword that kill'd thee* (Act V, Scene III)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Caesar, thou art revenged, / Even with the sword that kill'd thee" slowly and put it in my own words: Cassius tells Caesar's spirit that he is avenged with the very sword that killed him. Next, craft. I notice the irony that the same sword serves both murder and suicide. The strongest word is "revenged": it shows Caesar's spirit triumphing over his killers. Then, effect. What does Cassius say as he dies? My answer: Cassius dies by his own hand believing the battle lost; the line shows Caesar's power continues after death, defeating the conspirators.

40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Brutus. Look at the craft: Titinius kills himself in grief; Brutus mourns: "O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet!" Ask: How does this line connect to fate and omens? Expected: Caesar's spirit seems to win. (Brutus.)

> *O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet* (Act V, Scene III, Brutus)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Brutus. Look at the craft: Titinius kills himself in grief; Brutus mourns: "O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet!"
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and omens?
Expected answer: Caesar's spirit seems to win. (Brutus.)

50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the death of Cassius? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene III develops the idea of the death of Cassius. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. When the text says “O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet” (Act V, Scene III, Brutus), it shows this directly. Titinius laments "thou hast misconstrued everything," and Brutus sees Caesar "mighty yet."
Task: Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the death of Cassius? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene III develops the idea of the death of Cassius. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. When the text says “O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet” (Act V, Scene III, Brutus), it shows this directly. Titinius laments "thou hast misconstrued everything," and Brutus sees Caesar "mighty yet."

55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How can a single misunderstanding lead to disaster? Content note: suicide. Ask how the play frames Roman suicide.
Anchor question: How can a single misunderstanding lead to disaster?
Facilitation: Content note: suicide. Ask how the play frames Roman suicide.

60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the death of Cassius? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. ("O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet", Act V, Scene III, Brutus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the death of Cassius? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. ("O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet", Act V, Scene III, Brutus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how dramatic irony shapes the death of Cassius. Key takeaway: Caesar's spirit seems to win.

Total: 70 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Dramatic irony:** Cassius misreads Titinius's capture (actually a welcome) and has Pindarus kill him.
- **Characterization:** Titinius kills himself in grief; Brutus mourns: "O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet!"

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and omens:** Caesar's spirit seems to win.

Symbols and motifs

- **blood:** Blood turns the assassination from sacrifice into butchery; the conspirators bathe their hands in it. In this scene: "red rays thou dost sink to-night, / So in his red blood Cassius' day is set; / The sun of Rome is set! Our" (Act V, Scene III, Titinius).
- **Rome and the people:** The crowd's loyalty is fickle; speakers win Rome by moving the plebeians. In this scene: "Cassius, / Far from this country Pindarus shall run, / Where never Roman shall take note of him. Exit" (Act V, Scene III, Pindarus).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Caesar, thou art revenged, / Even with the sword that kill'd thee" (Act V, Scene III) Cassius's death.
- "O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet" (Act V, Scene III, Brutus) Brutus.
- "Alas, thou hast misconstrued everything" (Act V, Scene III, Titinius) Titinius.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I.
Evidence: "O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet" (Act V, Scene III, Brutus)
Reasoning: Titinius laments "thou hast misconstrued everything," and Brutus sees Caesar "mighty yet."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
envenomed (adjective)	poisoned	*Seek him, Titinius, whilst I go to meet The noble Brutus, thrusting this report Into his ears; I may say, thrusting it; For piercing steel and darts envenomed Shall be as welcome to the ears of Brutus As tidings of this sight.*	"envenomed": Origin of "envenom": Old French envenimer ("to poison"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/envenom#Etymology)
engender (verb)	to give rise to	*O error, soon conceived, Thou never comest unto a happy birth, But kill'st the mother that engender'd thee!*	"engender": Origin: Old French engendrer; earlier Latin ingenerāre. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/engender#Etymology)
garland (noun)	a wreath worn as a sign of victory	*But, hold thee, take this garland on thy brow; Thy Brutus bid me give it thee, and I Will do his bidding.*	
revenged (adjective)	avenged	*Caesar, thou art revenged, Even with the sword that kill'd thee.*	
freeman (noun)	a free person, no longer a slave	*Come now, keep thine oath; Now be a freeman: and with this good sword, That ran through Caesar's bowels, search this bosom.*	
disconsolate (adjective)	deeply unhappy	*All disconsolate, With Pindarus his bondman, on this hill.*	"disconsolate": Origin: Medieval Latin discōnsōlātus ("comfortless"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/disconsolate#Etymology)
discomfort (verb)	to discourage	*Come, therefore, and to Thasos send his body: His funerals shall not be in our camp, Lest it discomfort us.*	"discomfort": Origin: Anglo-Norman descomforter. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/discomfort#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. How can a single misunderstanding lead to disaster?
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with honor and self-deception?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What reward does Cassius promise Pindarus for killing him? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: His freedom.
2. What does Pindarus mistakenly report? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: That Titinius has been captured
3. With what does Cassius ask to be killed? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The sword that killed Caesar
4. What does Titinius bring back for Cassius? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A wreath of victory from Brutus
5. What does Brutus call Cassius? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The last of all the Romans
6. What does Brutus say Caesar's spirit does? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Turns their swords against themselves
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Cassius's men are fleeing; Brutus's troops have charged too early and turned to looting. Cassius sends Titinius to see whether nearby troops are friend or foe and asks Pindarus to watch. Pindarus mistakenly reports Titinius captured. Believing all lost, Cassius has Pindarus stab him with the sword that killed Caesar: 'Caesar, thou art revenged.' Titinius returns with a victory garland from…
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene III" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Seek him, Titinius, whilst I go to meet The noble Brutus, thrusting this report Into his ears; I may say, thrusting it; For piercing steel and darts envenomed Shall be as welcome to the ears of Brutus As tidings of this…" What does "envenomed" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: envenomed: poisoned.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Cassius believe Pindarus without checking? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Despair and his birthday omens; he expects defeat.
2. What does "Act V, Scene III" suggest about the death of Cassius? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A death built on

misunderstanding: Brutus says Caesar's spirit 'turns our swords in our own proper entrails.' Note: this scene shows two suicides; preview with students.

3. Find one example of conflict in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the death of Cassius? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “Caesar, thou art revenged, / Even with the sword that kill’d thee” (Act V, Scene III): Cassius's death. On characterization: Titinius kills himself in grief; Brutus mourns: "O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Come hither, sirrah: In Parthia did I take thee prisoner; And then I swore thee, saving of thy life, That whatsoever I did bid thee do, Thou shouldst attempt it.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Cassius's men are fleeing; Brutus's troops have charged too early and turned to looting. Cassius sends Titinius to see whether nearby troops are friend or foe and asks Pindarus to watch. Pindarus mistakenly reports Titinius captured. Believing all lost, Cassius has Pindarus stab him with the sword…
7. How does “Act V, Scene III” build on “Act V, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet” (Act V, Scene III, Brutus): Brutus. Theme link: Caesar's spirit seems to win. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “Alas, thou hast misconstrued everything” (Act V, Scene III, Titinius): Titinius. On characterization: Titinius kills himself in grief; Brutus mourns: "O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How can a single misunderstanding lead to disaster?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with honor and self-deception? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing

Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “Caesar, thou art revenged, / Even with the sword that kill’d thee” (Act V, Scene III): Cassius's death. Theme link: Caesar's spirit seems to win. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Cassius's death noble in the Roman sense or simply tragic? Discuss with care for the topic. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Discuss Roman honor codes vs. a modern view; use safe messaging.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet” (Act V, Scene III, Brutus): Brutus. Theme link: Caesar's spirit seems to win. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “A death built on misunderstanding: Brutus says Caesar's spirit 'turns our swords in our own proper entrails.' Note: this scene shows two suicides; preview with students.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “Alas, thou hast misconstrued everything” (Act V, Scene III, Titinius): Titinius. Theme link: Caesar's spirit seems to win. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “Caesar, thou art revenged, / Even with the sword that kill’d thee” (Act V, Scene III): Cassius's death. On characterization: Titinius kills himself in grief; Brutus mourns: "O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act V, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the death of Cassius. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet” (Act V, Scene III, Brutus): Brutus. Theme link: Caesar's spirit seems to win. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “Alas, thou hast misconstrued everything” (Act V, Scene III, Titinius): Titinius. Theme link: Caesar's spirit seems to win. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to rhetoric and persuasion: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “Caesar, thou art revenged, / Even with the sword that kill’d thee” (Act V, Scene III): Cassius's death. Theme link: Caesar's spirit seems to win. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the conflict in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet” (Act V, Scene III, Brutus): Brutus. Theme link: Caesar's spirit seems to win. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act V, Scene III” treats the death of Cassius with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “Alas, thou hast misconstrued everything” (Act V, Scene III, Titinius): Titinius. Theme link: Caesar's spirit seems to win. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act V, Scene IV” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “Caesar, thou art revenged, / Even with the sword that kill’d thee” (Act V, Scene III): Cassius's death. Theme link: Caesar's spirit seems to win. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the death of Cassius? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet” (Act V, Scene III, Brutus): Brutus. Theme link: Caesar's spirit seems to win. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Titinius bring back for Cassius?
   A. A letter from Portia
   B. A wreath of victory from Brutus
   C. Antony's sword
   D. A crown

   Key: B (A wreath of victory from Brutus)
2. [short · recall · DOK 1] What reward does Cassius promise Pindarus for killing him?
   Sample answer: His freedom.
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Come, therefore, and to Thasos send his body: His funerals shall not be in our camp, Lest it _____ us." Word bank: garland, engender, discomfort, envenomed
   Key: discomfort
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene III, Brutus: "O _____ Caesar, thou art mighty yet"
   Key: Julius
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Seek him, Titinius, whilst I go to meet The noble Brutus, thrusting this report Into his ears; I may say, thrusting it; For piercing steel and darts envenomed Shall be as welcome to the ears of Brutus As tidings of this…", what does "envenomed" most nearly mean?
   A. to plot
   B. boasting
   C. Roman army units
   D. poisoned

   Key: D (poisoned)
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Pindarus mistakenly report?
   A. That Rome is burning
   B. That Antony has fled
   C. That Brutus is dead
   D. That Titinius has been captured

   Key: D (That Titinius has been captured)
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] With what does Cassius ask to be killed?
   A. A spear
   B. Fire
   C. The sword that killed Caesar
   D. Poison

   Key: C (The sword that killed Caesar)
8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Brutus say Caesar's spirit does?
   A. Protects Rome
   B. Haunts Antony
   C. Turns their swords against themselves

D. Forgives them

Key: C (Turns their swords against themselves)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Caesar, thou art revenged, Even with the sword that kill’d thee.”, what does “revenged” most nearly mean?

   A. the supposed art of turning base metal to gold

   B. rhyming in a silly, sing-song way

   C. avenged

   D. to enclose; to contain

   Key: C (avenged)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet” (Act V, Scene III, Brutus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Brutus.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Caesar, thou art revenged, / Even with the sword that kill’d thee” (Act V, Scene III)

    A. Cassius's death.

    B. Caesar's courage or pride.

    C. Antony's tribute.

    D. Cassius's argument for action.

    Key: A (Cassius's death.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet” (Act V, Scene III, Brutus)

    A. The letter.

    B. The proscription.

    C. Brutus.

    D. Brutus's hope.

    Key: C (Brutus.)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Caesar, thou art revenged, / Even with the sword that kill’d thee” (Act V, Scene III) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Cassius's death.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene III”? Titinius kills himself in grief; Brutus mourns: "O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet!"

    A. Conflict

    B. Theme

    C. Characterization

    D. Hyperbole

    Key: C (Characterization)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet” (Act V, Scene III, Brutus).

    Sample answer: Titinius laments "thou hast misconstrued everything," and Brutus sees Caesar "mighty yet."

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how fate and omens develops from an earlier scene to “Act V, Scene III”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Caesar's spirit seems to win.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “But, hold thee, take this garland on thy brow; Thy Brutus bid me give it thee, and I Will do his bidding.”, what does “garland” most nearly mean?

    A. a wreath worn as a sign of victory

    B. one who heals (here, a joke: he "heals" old shoes)

    C. small tasks for others

    D. envious rivalry

    Key: A (a wreath worn as a sign of victory)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene III: “Caesar, thou art _____, / Even with the sword that kill’d thee”

    Key: revenged

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Come now, keep thine oath; Now be a _____: and with this good sword, That ran through Caesar’s bowels, search this bosom.” Word bank: envenomed, engender, freeman, garland

    Key: freeman

20. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act V, Scene III”?

    A. Cassius works on Brutus

    B. The death of Cassius

    C. The assassination

    D. The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost

    Key: B (The death of Cassius)

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Alas, thou hast misconstrued everything” (Act V, Scene III, Titinius)

    A. Envy kills virtue.

    B. Titinius.

    C. Antony's opening.

    D. Artemidorus's hope.

    Key: B (Titinius.)

22. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Cassius believe Pindarus without checking?

    Sample answer: Despair and his birthday omens; he expects defeat.

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene III”? Cassius misreads Titinius's capture (actually a welcome) and has Pindarus kill him.

    A. Dramatic irony

    B. Simile

    C. Alliteration

    D. Foreshadowing

    Key: A (Dramatic irony)

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Alas, thou hast misconstrued everything” (Act V, Scene III, Titinius). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Titinius.
25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is Cassius's death noble in the Roman sense or simply tragic? Discuss with care for the topic.
    Sample answer: Discuss Roman honor codes vs. a modern view; use safe messaging.
26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: Titinius laments "thou hast misconstrued everything," and Brutus sees Caesar "mighty yet."
27. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “All _____, With Pindarus his bondman, on this hill.” Word bank: envenomed, engender, garland, disconsolate
    Key: disconsolate
28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet” (Act V, Scene III, Brutus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Brutus.
29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Caesar, thou art revenged, / Even with the sword that kill’d thee” (Act V, Scene III) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Cassius's death.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	9, 5, 17, 4, 18, 1, 19, 6, 20, 21, 11, 22, 23, 14, 24, 25	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	18, 9, 8, 3, 17, 1, 22, 10, 12, 20, 11, 15, 24, 14, 25, 26	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	5, 27, 1, 7, 3, 10, 20, 12, 21, 13, 24, 23, 14, 15, 16, 26	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	1, 17, 27, 19, 11, 22, 20, 10, 21, 15, 23, 14, 24, 28, 26, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	19, 27, 6, 20, 10, 12, 11, 23, 15, 24, 14, 26, 25, 28, 16, 29	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Freshman	1, 4, 3, 20, 13, 22, 10, 23, 14, 15, 24, 26, 16, 29, 25, 28	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	19, 18, 12, 11, 21, 20, 10, 14, 23, 15, 24, 16, 25, 28, 29, 26	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Junior	27, 19, 11, 12, 21, 20, 13, 24, 14, 23, 15, 16, 25, 28, 29, 26	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Senior	19, 27, 21, 20, 11, 22, 13, 23, 24, 15, 14, 16, 29, 26, 28, 25	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5

Graduate / PhD	19, 27, 21, 20, 22, 10, 11, 23, 14, 15, 24, 25, 28, 16, 26, 29	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act V, Scene III,” how does Shakespeare show the death of Cassius? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the death of Cassius? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene III develops the idea of the death of Cassius. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of the death of Cassius. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene III suggests about the death of Cassius. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses conflict in Act V, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of the death of Cassius. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act V, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the death of Cassius responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act V, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the death of Cassius follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene III and its treatment of

the death of Cassius. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's conflict and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about the death of Cassius in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the death of Cassius. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *But, hold thee, take this garland on thy brow; Thy Brutus bid me give it thee, and I Will do his bidding.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “garland” most nearly mean?

   A. a free person, no longer a slave

   B. to discourage

   C. a wreath worn as a sign of victory

   D. deeply unhappy

2. *Come hither, sirrah: In Parthia did I take thee prisoner; And then I swore thee, saving of thy life, That whatsoever I did bid thee do, Thou shouldst attempt it. Come now, keep thine oath; Now be a freeman: and with this good sword, That ran through Caesar’s bowels, search this bosom. Stand not to answer: here, take thou the hilts; And, when my face is cover’d, as ’tis now, Guide thou the sword. Pindarus stabs him. Caesar, thou art revenged, Even with the sword that kill’d thee. Dies.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act V, Scene III”?

   A. Young Cato and Lucilius

   B. The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost

   C. The death of Cassius

   D. Storm, omens and recruitment

SAT key: 1. C (a wreath worn as a sign of victory); 2. C (The death of Cassius)

Lesson 19: Act V, Scene IV

Focus: young Cato and Lucilius

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Act V, Scene IV (young Cato and Lucilius) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.3

Teacher only · spoilers

Young Cato, Portia's brother, proclaims his name and is killed. Lucilius pretends to be Brutus to protect him and is captured. Antony recognizes the trick, orders that Lucilius be treated kindly, and says he would rather have such men as friends than enemies.

Background: Young Cato was the son of Cato the Younger, a famous defender of the republic, and the brother of Portia.

Significance: Lucilius's loyalty and Antony's generosity show that honor and kindness survive even in defeat.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *What does loyalty look like when a cause is losing? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to friendship and loyalty because....*
> **Prompt:** What does loyalty look like when a cause is losing?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to friendship and loyalty because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Lucilius's loyalty.

> **8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)**
> Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
> *Young Cato was the son of Cato the Younger, a famous defender of the republic, and the brother of Portia. Lucilius's loyalty and Antony's generosity show that honor and kindness survive even in defeat. Characterization: Young Cato dies fighting; Lucilius pretends to be Brutus to protect him. Characterization: Antony treats Lucilius with respect. Watch for honour: "Honourable" is a key word; Antony turns it into irony in the funeral oration. In this scene: “now thou diest as bravely as Titinius; / And mayst be honour’d, being Cato’s son” (Act V, Scene IV, Lucilius).*

> **16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes young Cato and Lucilius. Key takeaway: Lucilius's loyalty.*

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Young Cato dies fighting; Lucilius pretends to be Brutus to protect him.
- **Characterization:** Antony treats Lucilius with respect.

Themes and how they develop

- **friendship and loyalty:** Lucilius's loyalty.

Symbols and motifs

- **honour:** "Honourable" is a key word; Antony turns it into irony in the funeral oration. In this scene: “now thou diest as bravely as Titinius; / And mayst be honour’d, being Cato’s son” (Act V, Scene IV, Lucilius).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho” (Act V, Scene IV, Cato) Young Cato.
- “Brutus, my country’s friend; know me for Brutus” (Act V, Scene IV, Brutus) Lucilius's disguise.
- “I had rather have / Such men my friends than enemies” (Act V, Scene IV, Antony) Antony's respect.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires.
Evidence: “I had rather have / Such men my friends than enemies” (Act V, Scene IV, Antony)
Reasoning: He cries "know me for Brutus," and Antony says he would "rather have / Such men my friends than enemies."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
tyrants (noun)	cruel and unjust rulers	*A foe to tyrants, and my country’s friend; I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho!*	“tyrants”: Origin of “tyrant”: possibly Old French tyrant; earlier Latin tyrannus (“despot”). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/tyrant#Etymology)
kindness (noun)	kind treatment	*This is not Brutus, friend; but, I assure you, A prize no less in worth: keep this man safe; Give him all kindness: I had rather have Such men my friends than enemies.*	“kindness”: Origin: an English formation from kind + -ness. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/kindness#Etymology)
bravely (adverb)	courageously	*Why, now thou diest as bravely as Titinius; And mayst be honour’d, being Cato’s son.*	

Discussion questions

1. What does loyalty look like when a cause is losing?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with rhetoric and persuasion?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Lucilius say about Brutus being taken alive? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: No enemy shall ever take noble Brutus alive.
2. Who pretends to be Brutus? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Lucilius
3. Why does Lucilius pretend to be Brutus? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To protect him
4. Who recognizes the trick? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Antony
5. How does Antony order Lucilius to be treated? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Kindly
6. Whose son is young Cato? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Cato the Younger's
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act V, Scene IV” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Young Cato, Portia's brother, proclaims his name and is killed. Lucilius pretends to be Brutus to protect him and is captured. Antony recognizes the trick, orders that Lucilius be treated kindly, and says he would rather have such men as friends than enemies.
8. Who is on stage in “Act V, Scene IV”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act V, Scene IV” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “A foe to tyrants, and my country’s friend; I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho!” What does “tyrants” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: tyrants: cruel and unjust rulers.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Antony value Lucilius? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: His loyalty would make him a valuable friend.

2. What does “Act V, Scene IV” suggest about young Cato and Lucilius? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Lucilius's loyalty and Antony's generosity show that honor and kindness survive even in defeat.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the conflict in this scene shape what we understand about young Cato and Lucilius? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: “I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho” (Act V, Scene IV, Cato): Young Cato. Theme link: Lucilius's loyalty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “What bastard doth not?”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene IV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Young Cato, Portia's brother, proclaims his name and is killed. Lucilius pretends to be Brutus to protect him and is captured. Antony recognizes the trick, orders that Lucilius be treated kindly, and says he would rather have such men as friends than enemies.
7. How does “Act V, Scene IV” build on “Act V, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: “Brutus, my country’s friend; know me for Brutus” (Act V, Scene IV, Brutus): Lucilius's disguise. Theme link: Lucilius's loyalty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: “I had rather have / Such men my friends than enemies” (Act V, Scene IV, Antony): Antony's respect. On characterization: Antony treats Lucilius with respect. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What does loyalty look like when a cause is losing?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with rhetoric and persuasion? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: “I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho” (Act V, Scene IV, Cato): Young Cato. Theme link:

Lucilius's loyalty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Lucilius's deception admirable even though it is a lie? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Weigh loyalty against honesty.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: “Brutus, my country’s friend; know me for Brutus” (Act V, Scene IV, Brutus): Lucilius's disguise. Theme link: Lucilius's loyalty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Lucilius's loyalty and Antony's generosity show that honor and kindness survive even in defeat.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: “I had rather have / Such men my friends than enemies” (Act V, Scene IV, Antony): Antony's respect. Theme link: Lucilius's loyalty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: “I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho” (Act V, Scene IV, Cato): Young Cato. On characterization: Antony treats Lucilius with respect. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act V, Scene IV”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of young Cato and Lucilius. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: “Brutus, my country’s friend; know me for Brutus” (Act V, Scene IV, Brutus): Lucilius's disguise. Theme link: Lucilius's loyalty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: “I had rather have / Such men my friends than enemies” (Act V, Scene IV, Antony): Antony's respect. Theme link: Lucilius's loyalty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to public versus private self: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires.

Useful evidence: “I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho” (Act V, Scene IV, Cato): Young Cato. Theme link: Lucilius's loyalty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: “Brutus, my country’s friend; know me for Brutus” (Act V, Scene IV, Brutus): Lucilius's disguise. On characterization: Antony treats Lucilius with respect. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act V, Scene IV” treats young Cato and Lucilius with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: “I had rather have / Such men my friends than enemies” (Act V, Scene IV, Antony): Antony's respect. Theme link: Lucilius's loyalty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act V, Scene V” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: “I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho” (Act V, Scene IV, Cato): Young Cato. Theme link: Lucilius's loyalty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about young Cato and Lucilius? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: “Brutus, my country’s friend; know me for Brutus” (Act V, Scene IV, Brutus): Lucilius's disguise. Theme link: Lucilius's loyalty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Antony order Lucilius to be treated?

   A. Executed

   B. Sent away

C. Imprisoned harshly

D. Kindly

Key: D (Kindly)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “A foe to tyrants, and my country’s friend; I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho!”, what does “tyrants” most nearly mean?

   A. closely united (with the plot)

   B. cruel and unjust rulers

   C. to interpret; to explain

   D. stained red with blood

   Key: B (cruel and unjust rulers)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “A foe to _____, and my country’s friend; I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho!” Word bank: bravely, tyrants, kindness

   Key: tyrants

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does Lucilius pretend to be Brutus?

   A. To flee

   B. To trick Cassius

   C. To protect him

   D. To win a reward

   Key: C (To protect him)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whose son is young Cato?

   A. Caesar's

   B. Brutus's

   C. Cato the Younger's

   D. Cicero's

   Key: C (Cato the Younger's)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “This is not Brutus, friend; but, I assure you, A prize no less in worth: keep this man safe; Give him all _____: I had rather have Such men my friends than enemies.” Word bank: kindness, bravely, tyrants

   Key: kindness

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “This is not Brutus, friend; but, I assure you, A prize no less in worth: keep this man safe; Give him all kindness: I had rather have Such men my friends than enemies.”, what does “kindness” most nearly mean?

   A. kind treatment

   B. shortened

   C. noisy and busy

   D. food for horses

   Key: A (kind treatment)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene IV, Antony: “I had rather have / Such men my _____ than enemies”

   Key: friends

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who recognizes the trick?
   A. Antony
   B. Pindarus
   C. Octavius
   D. Lepidus

   Key: A (Antony)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I had rather have / Such men my friends than enemies” (Act V, Scene IV, Antony)
    A. Titinius.
    B. Antony's respect.
    C. Cassius's willingness to die.
    D. Artemidorus's hope.

    Key: B (Antony's respect.)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Antony value Lucilius?
    Sample answer: His loyalty would make him a valuable friend.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act V, Scene IV”?
    A. Young Cato and Lucilius
    B. Brutus and Cassius at odds
    C. The triumvirs' proscription list
    D. Storm, omens and recruitment

    Key: A (Young Cato and Lucilius)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Brutus, my country’s friend; know me for Brutus” (Act V, Scene IV, Brutus)
    A. Brutus's farewell.
    B. Antony's tribute.
    C. Brutus.
    D. Lucilius's disguise.

    Key: D (Lucilius's disguise.)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene IV”? Antony treats Lucilius with respect.
    A. Conflict
    B. Simile
    C. Hyperbole
    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene IV”? Young Cato dies fighting; Lucilius pretends to be Brutus to protect him.
    A. Tone / mood
    B. Personification

C. Characterization

D. Theme

Key: C (Characterization)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how friendship and loyalty develops from an earlier scene to “Act V, Scene IV”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Lucilius's loyalty.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Why, now thou diest as bravely as Titinius; And mayst be honour’d, being Cato’s son.”, what does “bravely” most nearly mean?

    A. to cut the limbs from a body

    B. inferiors; people of low rank

    C. courageously

    D. stained red with blood

    Key: C (courageously)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene IV, Cato: “I am the son of _____ Cato, ho”

    Key: Marcus

19. [short · recall · DOK 1] What does Lucilius say about Brutus being taken alive?

    Sample answer: No enemy shall ever take noble Brutus alive.

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who pretends to be Brutus?

    A. Messala

    B. Lucilius

    C. Titinius

    D. Cato

    Key: B (Lucilius)

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho” (Act V, Scene IV, Cato)

    A. Young Cato.

    B. Portia's frustration.

    C. Reducing the will.

    D. Brutus's idealism.

    Key: A (Young Cato.)

22. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Brutus, my country’s friend; know me for Brutus” (Act V, Scene IV, Brutus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Lucilius's disguise.

23. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho” (Act V, Scene IV, Cato) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Young Cato.

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “I had rather have / Such men my friends than enemies” (Act V, Scene IV, Antony). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Antony's respect.

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene IV, Brutus: “Brutus, my _____’s friend; know me for Brutus”
    Key: country
26. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “I had rather have / Such men my friends than enemies” (Act V, Scene IV, Antony).
    Sample answer: He cries "know me for Brutus," and Antony says he would "rather have / Such men my friends than enemies."
27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is Lucilius's deception admirable even though it is a lie?
    Sample answer: Weigh loyalty against honesty.
28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho” (Act V, Scene IV, Cato) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Young Cato.
29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Brutus, my country’s friend; know me for Brutus” (Act V, Scene IV, Brutus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Lucilius's disguise.
30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: He cries "know me for Brutus," and Antony says he would "rather have / Such men my friends than enemies."

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 3, 2, 8, 6, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 11, 24, 15, 14, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	3, 7, 17, 25, 19, 1, 22, 12, 11, 21, 10, 26, 24, 14, 16, 27	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	3, 17, 8, 1, 19, 21, 11, 10, 13, 23, 24, 14, 15, 26, 28, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	3, 6, 17, 5, 22, 11, 12, 10, 23, 14, 26, 15, 24, 27, 29, 28	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	6, 3, 20, 13, 23, 10, 22, 14, 15, 26, 24, 16, 28, 30, 29, 27	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Freshman	25, 9, 8, 21, 12, 23, 13, 15, 14, 24, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	3, 6, 11, 21, 10, 22, 12, 15, 24, 26, 14, 30, 27, 28, 29, 16	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Junior	3, 6, 21, 11, 13, 10, 12, 15, 24, 26, 14, 27, 16, 30, 28, 29	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Senior	3, 6, 11, 12, 22, 21, 13, 15, 26, 14, 24, 29, 27, 28, 16, 30	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD		

	25, 3, 21, 13, 23, 22, 11, 15, 14, 24, 26, 29, 27, 16, 30, 28	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act V, Scene IV,” how does Shakespeare show young Cato and Lucilius? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene IV, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of young Cato and Lucilius? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene IV develops the idea of young Cato and Lucilius. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of young Cato and Lucilius. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene IV suggests about young Cato and Lucilius. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act V, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of young Cato and Lucilius. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act V, Scene IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of young Cato and Lucilius responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act V, Scene IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of young Cato and Lucilius follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene IV and its treatment of

young Cato and Lucilius. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and conflict, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene IV as evidence for a larger claim about young Cato and Lucilius in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene IV as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of young Cato and Lucilius. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *What bastard doth not? Who will go with me? I will proclaim my name about the field: I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho! A foe to tyrants, and my country's friend; I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho!*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene IV"?

   A. Young Cato and Lucilius

   B. Brutus decides

   C. The tribunes and the fickle crowd

   D. Cinna the poet

SAT key: 1. A (Young Cato and Lucilius)

Lesson 20: Act V, Scene V

Focus: the death of Brutus

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “Act V, Scene V” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (suicide): Brutus dies by suicide with Strato's help. Use the safe-messaging script; keep focus on Antony's verdict and the play's questions about honor.
Student preview: This scene shows a death by suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read.
Suggested language: “Is Antony's final judgment of Brutus fair?”
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this scene is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Defeated, Brutus asks Clitus, Dardanius and Volumnius in turn to help him die; all refuse. He tells them Caesar's ghost appeared to him again at Philippi. Strato holds his sword and Brutus runs on it, saying 'Caesar, now be still: I kill'd not thee with half so good a will.' Antony and Octavius arrive. Antony calls Brutus 'the noblest Roman of them all,' the only conspirator who acted for the common good, not envy. Octavius orders an honorable burial and ends the play.

Background: Plutarch reports that Brutus died by his own hand after Philippi, assisted by Strato, in 42 BC. Octavius later became Augustus, Rome's first emperor, ending the republic Brutus tried to save.

Significance: The play closes with Antony's tribute, which reframes Brutus. Irony: the act meant to preserve the republic helped bring about the empire. Note: this scene depicts suicide; use safe messaging and offer support.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Can a person be noble and still be wrong? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to honour and idealism because.... Content note before we start: This scene shows a death by suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: Can a person be noble and still be wrong?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to honour and idealism because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Brutus's honour recognized.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: tarrying — staying; lingering; slaying — killing; bondage — slavery; captivity; entertain — to take into service; conquerors — winners in battle. "bondage": Origin: Medieval Latin bondagium; earlier Old English bonda ("householder"). "entertain": Origin: Middle English entertenen; earlier Old French entretenir. "conquerors": Origin of "conqueror": Old French conquereor.
Words: tarrying: staying; lingering · slaying: killing · bondage: slavery; captivity · entertain: to take into service · conquerors: winners in battle

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Plutarch reports that Brutus died by his own hand after Philippi, assisted by Strato, in 42 BC. Octavius later became Augustus, Rome's first emperor, ending the republic Brutus tried to save. The play closes with Antony's tribute, which reframes Brutus. Irony: the act meant to preserve the republic helped bring about the empire. Note: this scene depicts suicide; use safe messaging and offer support. Characterization: Brutus asks his servants to help him die; Strato holds the sword. Structure: Antony's eulogy: "This was the noblest Roman of them all." Watch for honour: "Honourable" is a key word; Antony turns it into irony in the funeral oration. In this scene: "a good respect; / Thy life hath had some smatch of honour in it: / Hold then my sword, and turn away thy face" (Act V, Scene V, Brutus).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Caesar, now be still: / I kill'd not thee with half so good a will" slowly and put it in my own words: Running on his sword, Brutus tells Caesar to be still, since he kills himself more willingly than he killed Caesar. Next, craft. I notice the direct address to Caesar's ghost, as if settling a debt. The strongest word is "still": it means at peace, as if his death will quiet Caesar's spirit. Then, effect. What does Brutus mean in his last words? My answer: In his last words Brutus means that Caesar can now rest, since Brutus killed him less willingly than he kills himself; he admits his guilt, and the question of his honor stays open.

> *Caesar, now be still: / I kill'd not thee with half so good a will* (Act V, Scene V, Brutus)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Caesar, now be still: / I kill'd not thee with half so good a will" slowly and put it in my own words: Running on his sword, Brutus tells Caesar to be still, since he kills himself more willingly than he killed Caesar. Next, craft. I notice the direct address to Caesar's ghost, as if settling a debt. The strongest word is "still": it means at peace, as if his death will quiet Caesar's spirit. Then, effect. What does Brutus mean in his last words? My answer: In his last words Brutus means that Caesar can now rest, since Brutus killed him less willingly than he kills himself; he admits his guilt, and the question of his honor stays open.

40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Antony's tribute. Look at the craft: Antony's eulogy: "This was the noblest Roman of them all." Ask: How does this line connect to honour and idealism? Expected: Brutus's honour recognized. (Antony's tribute.)

> *This was the noblest Roman of them all* (Act V, Scene V, Antony)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Antony's tribute. Look at the craft: Antony's eulogy: "This was the noblest Roman of them all."
Ask: How does this line connect to honour and idealism?
Expected answer: Brutus's honour recognized. (Antony's tribute.)

50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the death of Brutus? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene V develops the idea of the death of Brutus. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. When the text says “This was the noblest Roman of them all” (Act V, Scene V, Antony), it shows this directly. Antony calls him "the noblest Roman of them all," and Brutus's last words, "I kill'd not thee with half so good a will," admit his reluctance.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the death of Brutus? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene V develops the idea of the death of Brutus. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. When the text says “This was the noblest Roman of them all” (Act V, Scene V, Antony), it shows this directly. Antony calls him "the noblest Roman of them all," and Brutus's last words, "I kill'd not thee with half so good a will," admit his reluctance.

55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Can a person be noble and still be wrong? Ask: is Brutus the tragic hero?
Anchor question: Can a person be noble and still be wrong?
Facilitation: Ask: is Brutus the tragic hero?

60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the death of Brutus? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. (“This was the noblest Roman of them all”, Act V, Scene V, Antony). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the death of Brutus? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. (“This was the noblest Roman of them all”, Act V, Scene V, Antony). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the death of Brutus. Key takeaway: Brutus's honour recognized.

Total: 70 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Brutus asks his servants to help him die; Strato holds the sword.
- **Structure:** Antony's eulogy: "This was the noblest Roman of them all."

Themes and how they develop

- **honour and idealism:** Brutus's honour recognized.

Symbols and motifs

- **honour:** "Honourable" is a key word; Antony turns it into irony in the funeral oration. In this scene: “a good respect; / Thy life hath had some smatch of honour in it: / Hold then my sword, and turn away thy face” (Act V, Scene V, Brutus).
- **Rome and the people:** The crowd's loyalty is fickle; speakers win Rome by moving the plebeians. In this scene: “This was the noblest Roman of them all: / All the conspirators save only he / Did that” (Act V, Scene V, Antony).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Caesar, now be still: / I kill’d not thee with half so good a will” (Act V, Scene V, Brutus) Brutus's last words.
- “This was the noblest Roman of them all” (Act V, Scene V, Antony) Antony's tribute.
- “the elements / So mix’d in him that Nature might stand up / And say to all the world “This was a man” (Act V, Scene V, Antony) The ideal.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure.
Evidence: “This was the noblest Roman of them all” (Act V, Scene V, Antony)
Reasoning: Antony calls him "the noblest Roman of them all," and Brutus's last words, "I kill'd not thee with half so good a will," admit his reluctance.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
tarrying (verb)	staying; lingering	*Fly, fly, my lord; there is no tarrying here.*	
slaying (noun)	killing	*Sit thee down, Clitus: slaying is the word; It is a deed in fashion.*	
bondage (noun)	slavery; captivity	*Free from the bondage you are in, Messala: The conquerors can but*	“bondage”: Origin: Medieval Latin bondagium; earlier Old English bonda

		make a fire of him; For Brutus only overcame himself, And no man else hath honour by his death.	("householder"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/bondage#Etymology)
entertain (verb)	to take into service	*All that served Brutus, I will entertain them.*	"entertain": Origin: Middle English entertenen; earlier Old French entretenir. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/entertain#Etymology)
conquerors (noun)	winners in battle	*Free from the bondage you are in, Messala: The conquerors can but make a fire of him; For Brutus only overcame himself, And no man else hath honour by his death.*	"conquerors": Origin of "conqueror": Old French conquereor. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/conqueror#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Can a person be noble and still be wrong?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with public versus private self?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Where did Caesar's ghost appear again to Brutus? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In the fields of Philippi.
2. Who holds the sword for Brutus? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Strato
3. What does Brutus say to Caesar as he dies? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He killed Caesar with less good will than himself
4. What does Antony call Brutus? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The noblest Roman of them all
5. Why does Antony say Brutus was different from the other conspirators? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He acted for the common good, not envy
6. Who speaks the play's final lines? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Octavius
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene V" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Defeated, Brutus asks Clitus, Dardanius and Volumnius in turn to help him die; all refuse. He tells them Caesar's ghost appeared to him again at Philippi. Strato holds his sword and

Brutus runs on it, saying 'Caesar, now be still: I kill'd not thee with half so good a will.' Antony and Octavius arrive. Antony calls Brutus 'the noblest Roman of them all,' the only conspirator who acted for the…

8. Who is on stage in “Act V, Scene V”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act V, Scene V” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Fly, fly, my lord; there is no tarrying here.” What does “tarrying” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: tarrying: staying; lingering.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why do Brutus's servants refuse to help him die? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Love and loyalty; they cannot bring themselves to do it.
2. What does “Act V, Scene V” suggest about the death of Brutus? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The play closes with Antony's tribute, which reframes Brutus. Irony: the act meant to preserve the republic helped bring about the empire. Note: this scene depicts suicide; use safe messaging and offer support.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the theme in this scene shape what we understand about the death of Brutus? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “Caesar, now be still: / I kill’d not thee with half so good a will” (Act V, Scene V, Brutus): Brutus's last words. Theme link: Brutus's honour recognized. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Why, this, Volumnius: The ghost of Caesar hath appear’d to me Two several times by night; at Sardis once, And, this last night, here in Philippi fields: I know my hour is come.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene V”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Defeated, Brutus asks Clitus, Dardanius and Volumnius in turn to help him die; all refuse. He tells them Caesar's ghost appeared to him again at Philippi. Strato holds his sword and Brutus runs on it, saying 'Caesar, now be still: I kill'd not thee with half so good a will.' Antony and Octavius…
7. How does “Act V, Scene V” build on “Act V, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “This was the noblest Roman of them all” (Act V, Scene V, Antony): Antony's tribute. On structure: Antony's eulogy: "This was the noblest Roman of them all." Credit any

position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “the elements / So mix’d in him that Nature might stand up / And say to all the world “This was a man” (Act V, Scene V, Antony): The ideal. On characterization: Brutus asks his servants to help him die; Strato holds the sword. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can a person be noble and still be wrong?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with public versus private self? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “Caesar, now be still: / I kill’d not thee with half so good a will” (Act V, Scene V, Brutus): Brutus's last words. On structure: Antony's eulogy: "This was the noblest Roman of them all." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Antony praises Brutus after doing everything to destroy him. Is the tribute sincere, political, or both? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Accept justified readings; note Octavius takes command.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “This was the noblest Roman of them all” (Act V, Scene V, Antony): Antony's tribute. Theme link: Brutus's honour recognized. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “The play closes with Antony's tribute, which reframes Brutus. Irony: the act meant to preserve the republic helped bring about the empire. Note: this scene depicts suicide; use safe messaging and offer support.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “the elements / So mix’d in him that Nature might stand up / And say to all the world “This was a man” (Act V, Scene V, Antony): The ideal. Theme link: Brutus's honour recognized. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “Caesar, now be still: / I kill’d not thee with half so good a will” (Act V, Scene V, Brutus): Brutus's last words. On characterization: Brutus asks his servants to help him die; Strato holds the sword. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act V, Scene V”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the death of Brutus. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “This was the noblest Roman of them all” (Act V, Scene V, Antony): Antony's tribute. On structure: Antony's eulogy: "This was the noblest Roman of them all." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene V”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “the elements / So mix’d in him that Nature might stand up / And say to all the world “This was a man” (Act V, Scene V, Antony): The ideal. Theme link: Brutus's honour recognized. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to fate, omens and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “Caesar, now be still: / I kill’d not thee with half so good a will” (Act V, Scene V, Brutus): Brutus's last words. Theme link: Brutus's honour recognized. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “This was the noblest Roman of them all” (Act V, Scene V, Antony): Antony's tribute. On characterization: Brutus asks his servants to help him die; Strato holds the sword. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act V, Scene V” treats the death of Brutus with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “the elements / So mix’d in him that Nature might stand up / And say to all the world “This was a man” (Act V, Scene V, Antony): The ideal. Theme link: Brutus's honour

recognized. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. As the final scene, does this ending resolve public versus private self? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “Caesar, now be still: / I kill’d not thee with half so good a will” (Act V, Scene V, Brutus): Brutus's last words. Theme link: Brutus's honour recognized. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the death of Brutus? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “This was the noblest Roman of them all” (Act V, Scene V, Antony): Antony's tribute. Theme link: Brutus's honour recognized. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene V, Antony: “This was the _____ Roman of them all”

   Key: noblest

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Brutus say to Caesar as he dies?

   A. He was right

   B. He forgives Caesar

   C. He will see him in Rome

   D. He killed Caesar with less good will than himself

   Key: D (He killed Caesar with less good will than himself)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “All that served Brutus, I will entertain them.”, what does “entertain” most nearly mean?

   A. kind treatment

   B. statements about what will happen

   C. showy display

   D. to take into service

   Key: D (to take into service)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Antony call Brutus?

   A. A fool

   B. The noblest Roman of them all

   C. A coward

   D. A traitor

   Key: B (The noblest Roman of them all)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who holds the sword for Brutus?

   A. Volumnius

   B. Messala

   C. Clitus

   D. Strato

   Key: D (Strato)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Free from the bondage you are in, Messala: The _____ can but make a fire of him; For Brutus only overcame himself, And no man else hath honour by his death.” Word bank: slaying, conquerors, bondage, tarrying

   Key: conquerors

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who speaks the play's final lines?

   A. Lucilius

   B. Strato

   C. Antony

   D. Octavius

   Key: D (Octavius)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does Antony say Brutus was different from the other conspirators?

   A. He was the bravest fighter

   B. He acted for the common good, not envy

   C. He was Caesar's son

   D. He planned the plot

   Key: B (He acted for the common good, not envy)

9. [short · recall · DOK 1] Where did Caesar's ghost appear again to Brutus?

   Sample answer: In the fields of Philippi.

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “This was the noblest Roman of them all” (Act V, Scene V, Antony)

    A. Cassius notes it is his birthday: the day of birth may be the day of death.

    B. Antony's tribute.

    C. Brutus.

    D. Reducing the will.

    Key: B (Antony's tribute.)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “This was the noblest Roman of them all” (Act V, Scene V, Antony) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Antony's tribute.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “the elements / So mix’d in him that Nature might stand up / And say to all the world “This was a man” (Act V, Scene V, Antony)

    A. His plea.

    B. Antony's respect.

    C. The ideal.

    D. The tribunes' metaphor of limiting Caesar's power.

    Key: C (The ideal.)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why do Brutus's servants refuse to help him die?

    Sample answer: Love and loyalty; they cannot bring themselves to do it.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “the elements / So mix’d in him that Nature might stand up / And say to all the world “This was a man” (Act V, Scene V, Antony). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: The ideal.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene V”? Brutus asks his servants to help him die; Strato holds the sword.

    A. Symbolism

    B. Setting

    C. Characterization

    D. Hyperbole

    Key: C (Characterization)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how honour and idealism develops from an earlier scene to “Act V, Scene V”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Brutus's honour recognized.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene V, Antony: “the _____ / So mix’d in him that Nature might stand up / And say to all the world “This was a man”

    Key: elements

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Free from the bondage you are in, Messala: The conquerors can but make a fire of him; For Brutus only overcame himself, And no man else hath honour by his death.”, what does “bondage” most nearly mean?

    A. very poor people who ask for money

    B. slavery; captivity

    C. to stand over with legs wide apart

    D. the day of final judgment; the end of the world

    Key: B (slavery; captivity)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Sit thee down, Clitus: slaying is the word; It is a deed in fashion.”, what does “slaying” most nearly mean?

    A. killing

    B. payments to free captives

    C. courageously

    D. to stand over with legs wide apart

Key: A (killing)

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene V, Brutus: "_____, now be still: / I kill'd not thee with half so good a will"

    Key: Caesar

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "Caesar, now be still: / I kill'd not thee with half so good a will" (Act V, Scene V, Brutus)

    A. Brutus's last words.

    B. Caesar's courage or pride.

    C. The tribunes' metaphor of limiting Caesar's power.

    D. Brutus.

    Key: A (Brutus's last words.)

22. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "Caesar, now be still: / I kill'd not thee with half so good a will" (Act V, Scene V, Brutus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Brutus's last words.

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "This was the noblest Roman of them all" (Act V, Scene V, Antony).

    Sample answer: Antony calls him "the noblest Roman of them all," and Brutus's last words, "I kill'd not thee with half so good a will," admit his reluctance.

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in "Act V, Scene V"? Antony's eulogy: "This was the noblest Roman of them all."

    A. Structure

    B. Metaphor

    C. Personification

    D. Plot

    Key: A (Structure)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Caesar, now be still: / I kill'd not thee with half so good a will" (Act V, Scene V, Brutus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Brutus's last words.

26. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene V"?

    A. The death of Brutus

    B. Brutus decides

    C. The funeral orations

    D. Cinna the poet

    Key: A (The death of Brutus)

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: "The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: Antony calls him "the noblest Roman of them all," and Brutus's last words, "I kill'd not thee with half so good a will," admit his reluctance.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "This was the noblest Roman of them all" (Act V, Scene V, Antony) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Antony's tribute.
29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Antony praises Brutus after doing everything to destroy him. Is the tribute sincere, political, or both?
    Sample answer: Accept justified readings; note Octavius takes command.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	5, 3, 17, 9, 18, 19, 20, 8, 10, 21, 22, 12, 23, 15, 24, 25	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	6, 8, 20, 1, 7, 17, 12, 26, 11, 13, 21, 14, 23, 24, 25, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	19, 3, 1, 6, 5, 21, 13, 12, 11, 10, 14, 23, 24, 15, 27, 25	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	20, 4, 8, 17, 11, 10, 12, 13, 22, 23, 24, 14, 15, 27, 16, 25	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	6, 20, 4, 13, 21, 22, 12, 24, 23, 14, 15, 27, 25, 28, 29, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Freshman	6, 20, 9, 11, 13, 21, 26, 24, 14, 15, 23, 28, 16, 25, 29, 27	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	6, 20, 13, 11, 12, 10, 22, 14, 23, 24, 15, 16, 27, 28, 25, 29	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Junior	6, 20, 10, 11, 22, 13, 12, 14, 23, 15, 24, 29, 16, 28, 27, 25	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Senior	6, 20, 22, 21, 12, 26, 13, 15, 24, 14, 23, 16, 25, 28, 29, 27	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	6, 20, 11, 21, 10, 13, 22, 23, 14, 24, 15, 25, 27, 28, 16, 29	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act V, Scene V," how does Shakespeare show the death of Brutus? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene V, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the death of Brutus? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene V develops the idea of the death of Brutus. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and

explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of the death of Brutus. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene V suggests about the death of Brutus. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act V, Scene V to complicate the reader's understanding of the death of Brutus. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Act V, Scene V within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the death of Brutus responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Act V, Scene V alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the death of Brutus follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene V and its treatment of the death of Brutus. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene V as evidence for a larger claim about the death of Brutus in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene V as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the death of Brutus. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *Fly, fly, my lord; there is no tarrying here.*

As used in the text, what does the word "tarrying" most nearly mean?

A. staying; lingering

B. to take into service

C. winners in battle

D. slavery; captivity

2. *Why, this, Volumnius: The ghost of Caesar hath appear'd to me Two several times by night; at Sardis once, And, this last night, here in Philippi fields: I know my hour is come.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene V"?

A. Cinna the poet

B. The death of Brutus

C. The death of Cassius

D. Portia's anxiety

SAT key: 1. A (staying; lingering); 2. B (The death of Brutus)

Unit test

Julius Caesar: unit test · 90 minutes · 50 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [short · recall · DOK 1] Which characters on the cast list are conspirators against Caesar?
   Sample answer: Brutus, Cassius, Casca, Trebonius, Ligarius, Decius Brutus, Metellus Cimber and Cinna.
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Marcus Brutus, conspirator against Julius Caesar”, what does “conspirator” most nearly mean?
   A. being stopped before acting
   B. to declare publicly
   C. a person who joins a secret plot
   D. greedy (an itching palm wants bribes)
   Key: C (a person who joins a secret plot)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who are the two women named in the cast list?
   A. Calpurnia and Portia
   B. Lucretia and Portia
   C. Calpurnia and Cleopatra
   D. Portia and Octavia
   Key: A (Calpurnia and Portia)
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whom is Calpurnia married to?
   A. Brutus
   B. Caesar
   C. Cassius
   D. Antony
   Key: B (Caesar)
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is Artemidorus's profession?
   A. A poet
   B. A soothsayer
   C. A teacher of rhetoric
   D. A senator

Key: C (A teacher of rhetoric)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which three men become triumvirs after Caesar's death?

   A. Octavius, Brutus and Antony

   B. Antony, Cicero and Lepidus

   C. Octavius, Antony and Lepidus

   D. Brutus, Cassius and Casca

   Key: C (Octavius, Antony and Lepidus)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Artemidorus of Cnidos, a teacher of rhetoric”, what does “rhetoric” most nearly mean?

   A. to help; to favor

   B. envious rivalry

   C. to strip (statues) of their decorations

   D. the art of persuasive speaking

   Key: D (the art of persuasive speaking)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Marcus Brutus, _____ against Julius Caesar” Word bank: rhetoric, conspirator

   Key: conspirator

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Artemidorus of Cnidos, a teacher of _____” Word bank: conspirator, rhetoric

   Key: rhetoric

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does the final battle of the play take place?

    A. Philippi

    B. Pharsalus

    C. Rome

    D. Sardis

    Key: A (Philippi)

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does Brutus want to argue with Cassius?

    A. On the battlefield

    B. In Rome

    C. Before the armies

    D. Inside his tent

    Key: D (Inside his tent)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “There are no tricks in plain and simple faith; But hollow men, like horses hot at hand, Make gallant show and promise of their mettle; But when they should endure the bloody spur, They fall their crests, and, like…”, what does “deceitful” most nearly mean?

    A. tricky; dishonest

    B. the supposed art of turning base metal to gold

    C. to give rise to

    D. killing

    Key: A (tricky; dishonest)

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Thou hast described A hot friend cooling: ever note, Lucilius, When love begins to sicken and decay, It useth an enforced ceremony.", what does "enforced" most nearly mean?

    A. forced; strained

    B. understood; judged (well conceited: rightly grasped)

    C. Roman army units

    D. to stand over with legs wide apart

    Key: A (forced; strained)

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene II, Brutus: "_____ the eyes of both our armies here"

    Key: Before

15. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Before the eyes of both our armies here, Which should perceive nothing but love from us, Let us not wrangle: bid them move away; Then in my tent, Cassius, enlarge your griefs, And I will give you audience.", what does "wrangle" most nearly mean?

    A. to strip (statues) of their decorations

    B. firmness of mind

    C. being declared an outlaw

    D. to argue noisily

    Key: D (to argue noisily)

16. [mc · recall · DOK 1] To what does Brutus compare a cooling friend?

    A. Winter

    B. A dying fire

    C. Old wine

    D. Horses that fail under trial

    Key: D (Horses that fail under trial)

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "With _____ and with respect enough; But not with such familiar instances, Nor with such free and friendly conference, As he hath used of old." Word bank: wrangle, enlarge, deceitful, courtesy

    Key: courtesy

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Before the eyes of both our armies here, Which should perceive nothing but love from us, Let us not wrangle: bid them move away; Then in my tent, Cassius, enlarge your griefs, And I will give you audience.", what does "enlarge" most nearly mean?

    A. a slave

    B. to state freely; to explain fully

    C. ready to form a faction; active in a cause

    D. killing

    Key: B (to state freely; to explain fully)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Cassius accuse Brutus of?

    A. Wronging him

    B. Stealing

    C. Loving Antony

D. Betraying Rome

Key: A (Wronging him)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Lucilius say Cassius received him?

A. With open anger

B. With tears

C. With courtesy but not old friendliness

D. With great warmth

Key: C (With courtesy but not old friendliness)

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who speaks the play's final lines?

A. Lucilius

B. Strato

C. Antony

D. Octavius

Key: D (Octavius)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene V, Antony: "This was the _____ Roman of them all"

Key: noblest

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Fly, fly, my lord; there is no tarrying here.", what does "tarrying" most nearly mean?

A. small tasks for others

B. a bold undertaking

C. to provide for; to equip

D. staying; lingering

Key: D (staying; lingering)

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Free from the bondage you are in, Messala: The conquerors can but make a fire of him; For Brutus only overcame himself, And no man else hath honour by his death.", what does "bondage" most nearly mean?

A. very poor people who ask for money

B. slavery; captivity

C. to stand over with legs wide apart

D. the day of final judgment; the end of the world

Key: B (slavery; captivity)

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene V, Brutus: "_____, now be still: / I kill'd not thee with half so good a will"

Key: Caesar

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act V, Scene V, Antony: "the _____ / So mix'd in him that Nature might stand up / And say to all the world "This was a man"

Key: elements

27. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Free from the bondage you are in, Messala: The _____ can but make a fire of him; For Brutus only overcame himself, And no man else hath

honour by his death." Word bank: slaying, conquerors, bondage, tarrying

Key: conquerors

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Brutus say to Caesar as he dies?

    A. He was right

    B. He forgives Caesar

    C. He will see him in Rome

    D. He killed Caesar with less good will than himself

    Key: D (He killed Caesar with less good will than himself)

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Antony call Brutus?

    A. A fool

    B. The noblest Roman of them all

    C. A coward

    D. A traitor

    Key: B (The noblest Roman of them all)

30. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Dramatis Personae"?

    A. The cast and world of the play

    B. The death of Brutus

    C. The death of Cassius

    D. Cinna the poet

    Key: A (The cast and world of the play)

31. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "Calpurnia" (Dramatis Personae)

    A. His plea.

    B. Young Cato.

    C. Her fear.

    D. One of only two women, both wives who are not heard by their husbands.

    Key: D (One of only two women, both wives who are not heard by their husbands.)

32. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why might a play about killing a ruler have felt dangerous in London in 1599?

    Sample answer: Elizabeth was old with no named heir; succession and rebellion were live fears.

33. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "Marcus Brutus" (Dramatis Personae) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Listed among the conspirators; he has more lines than anyone.

34. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "Before the eyes of both our armies here" (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus)

    A. Brutus's concern for appearance.

    B. Brutus's decision.

    C. Antony's prophecy of civil war.

    D. Caesar reads Cassius accurately.

    Key: A (Brutus's concern for appearance.)

35. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Brutus on cooling friendship.

36. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Most noble brother, you have done me wrong” (Act IV, Scene II, Cassius)

    A. Cassius's accusation.

    B. Cassius's argument for action.

    C. Artemidorus's hope.

    D. Brutus's last words.

    Key: A (Cassius's accusation.)

37. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Most noble brother, you have done me wrong” (Act IV, Scene II, Cassius) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Cassius's accusation.

38. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Caesar, now be still: / I kill’d not thee with half so good a will” (Act V, Scene V, Brutus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Brutus's last words.

39. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “the elements / So mix’d in him that Nature might stand up / And say to all the world “This was a man” (Act V, Scene V, Antony)

    A. His plea.

    B. Antony's respect.

    C. The ideal.

    D. The tribunes' metaphor of limiting Caesar's power.

    Key: C (The ideal.)

40. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “This was the noblest Roman of them all” (Act V, Scene V, Antony) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Antony's tribute.

41. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Caesar, now be still: / I kill’d not thee with half so good a will” (Act V, Scene V, Brutus)

    A. Brutus's last words.

    B. Caesar's courage or pride.

    C. The tribunes' metaphor of limiting Caesar's power.

    D. Brutus.

    Key: A (Brutus's last words.)

42. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Calpurnia” (Dramatis Personae). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: One of only two women, both wives who are not heard by their husbands.

43. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Julius Caesar” (Dramatis Personae).
    Sample answer: Caesar, Antony and Octavius head one list, and Brutus, Cassius and the other conspirators another, so the play begins as a map of loyalty and opposition.

44. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act IV, Scene II”? Their alliance is cracking.

    A. Hyperbole

    B. Foreshadowing

    C. Irony

    D. Setting

    Key: B (Foreshadowing)

45. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony”

    A. Act II, Scene III

    B. Act IV, Scene III

    C. Act IV, Scene II

    D. Act II, Scene I

    Key: C (Act IV, Scene II)

46. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “the elements / So mix’d in him that Nature might stand up / And say to all the world “This was a man” (Act V, Scene V, Antony). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: The ideal.

47. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene V”? Brutus asks his servants to help him die; Strato holds the sword.

    A. Symbolism

    B. Setting

    C. Characterization

    D. Hyperbole

    Key: C (Characterization)

48. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Julius Caesar” (Dramatis Personae) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The title character, who will die halfway through.

49. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Brutus on cooling friendship.

50. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: Antony calls him "the noblest Roman of them all," and Brutus's last words, "I kill'd not thee with half so good a will," admit his reluctance.

51. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Near which city is Brutus's camp?

    A. Philippi

    B. Athens

    C. Rome

D. Sardis

Key: D (Sardis)

52. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Act IV, Scene II, Brutus: “When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an _____ ceremony”

Key: enforced

53. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Sit thee down, Clitus: slaying is the word; It is a deed in fashion.”, what does “slaying” most nearly mean?

A. killing

B. payments to free captives

C. courageously

D. to stand over with legs wide apart

Key: A (killing)

54. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “All that served Brutus, I will entertain them.”, what does “entertain” most nearly mean?

A. kind treatment

B. statements about what will happen

C. showy display

D. to take into service

Key: D (to take into service)

55. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Marcus Brutus” (Dramatis Personae)

A. Caesar's hubris just before his death.

B. Decius's flattery.

C. Caesar's courage or pride.

D. Listed among the conspirators; he has more lines than anyone.

Key: D (Listed among the conspirators; he has more lines than anyone.)

56. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Julius Caesar” (Dramatis Personae) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The title character, who will die halfway through.

57. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why does Brutus insist the quarrel move into the tent?

Sample answer: So the soldiers do not see their leaders divided.

58. [short · inference · DOK 2] Why do Brutus's servants refuse to help him die?

Sample answer: Love and loyalty; they cannot bring themselves to do it.

59. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act V, Scene V”?

A. The death of Brutus

B. Brutus decides

C. The funeral orations

D. Cinna the poet

Key: A (The death of Brutus)

60. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Dramatis Personae”? Caesar, the title character, dies in Act III; the cast list does not tell us that Brutus has the most lines.

    A. Structure

    B. Theme

    C. Symbolism

    D. Characterization

    Key: A (Structure)

61. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “Julius Caesar”

    A. Act IV, Scene II

    B. Dramatis Personae

    C. Act IV, Scene III

    D. Act IV, Scene I

    Key: B (Dramatis Personae)

62. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Before the eyes of both our armies here” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Brutus's concern for appearance.

63. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “This was the noblest Roman of them all” (Act V, Scene V, Antony).

    Sample answer: Antony calls him "the noblest Roman of them all," and Brutus's last words, "I kill'd not thee with half so good a will," admit his reluctance.

64. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “Caesar, now be still: / I kill’d not thee with half so good a will”

    A. Act V, Scene V

    B. Act V, Scene IV

    C. Act V, Scene III

    D. Act IV, Scene II

    Key: A (Act V, Scene V)

65. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: Caesar, Antony and Octavius head one list, and Brutus, Cassius and the other conspirators another, so the play begins as a map of loyalty and opposition.

66. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how friendship and loyalty develops from an earlier scene to “Act IV, Scene II”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: the friendship under strain.

67. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how honour and idealism develops from an earlier scene to “Act V, Scene V”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Brutus's honour recognized.

68. [short · recall · DOK 1] Who brings news of Cassius's approach and his cold manner?

    Sample answer: Lucilius (with Pindarus, Cassius's servant).

69. [short · recall · DOK 1] Where did Caesar's ghost appear again to Brutus?

    Sample answer: In the fields of Philippi.

70. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who holds the sword for Brutus?

    A. Volumnius

    B. Messala

    C. Clitus

    D. Strato

    Key: D (Strato)

71. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does Antony say Brutus was different from the other conspirators?

    A. He was the bravest fighter

    B. He acted for the common good, not envy

    C. He was Caesar's son

    D. He planned the plot

    Key: B (He acted for the common good, not envy)

72. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Julius Caesar” (Dramatis Personae)

    A. Antony on Lepidus.

    B. Antony's taunt about rhetoric.

    C. Antony's opening.

    D. The title character, who will die halfway through.

    Key: D (The title character, who will die halfway through.)

73. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “This was the noblest Roman of them all” (Act V, Scene V, Antony)

    A. Cassius notes it is his birthday: the day of birth may be the day of death.

    B. Antony's tribute.

    C. Brutus.

    D. Reducing the will.

    Key: B (Antony's tribute.)

74. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Dramatis Personae”? The cast is divided by politics: Caesar; the triumvirs after his death (Antony, Octavius, Lepidus); the conspirators; senators; tribunes; the citizens. Students should see the factions before they see the people.

    A. Structure

    B. Setting

    C. Personification

    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

75. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus).

    Sample answer: Brutus observes that when love "begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony."

76. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act V, Scene V”? Antony's eulogy: "This was the noblest Roman of them all."

    A. Structure

    B. Metaphor

    C. Personification

    D. Plot

    Key: A (Structure)

77. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Marcus Brutus” (Dramatis Personae) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Listed among the conspirators; he has more lines than anyone.

78. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is Brutus right to care so much about appearances in front of the army?

    Sample answer: Accept leadership arguments; link to his public-honor theme.

79. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Caesar, now be still: / I kill’d not thee with half so good a will” (Act V, Scene V, Brutus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Brutus's last words.

80. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus)

    A. Antony's tribute.

    B. Brutus on cooling friendship.

    C. The ghost.

    D. Decius's flattery.

    Key: B (Brutus on cooling friendship.)

81. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act IV, Scene II”? Brutus and Cassius meet in tension; Brutus asks to talk privately in his tent.

    A. Alliteration

    B. Metaphor

    C. Characterization

    D. Tone / mood

    Key: C (Characterization)

82. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “This was the noblest Roman of them all” (Act V, Scene V, Antony) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Antony's tribute.

83. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Act IV, Scene II”?

    A. The first charge

    B. Cinna the poet

    C. Brutus and Cassius at odds

    D. Brutus decides

    Key: C (Brutus and Cassius at odds)

84. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] The play is named for Caesar, yet he appears in few scenes. Who do you predict is the true center of the play, and why?

    Sample answer: Brutus is a strong case: his choices and conscience drive the plot.

85. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: Brutus observes that when love "begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony."

86. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Antony praises Brutus after doing everything to destroy him. Is the tribute sincere, political, or both?

    Sample answer: Accept justified readings; note Octavius takes command.

87. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene III”? We know he will not be heard.

    A. Imagery

    B. Tone / mood

    C. Characterization

    D. Dramatic irony

    Key: D (Dramatic irony)

88. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how power and ambition develops from an earlier scene to “Dramatis Personae”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: every group is defined by its relation to Caesar's power.

89. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Most noble brother, you have done me wrong” (Act IV, Scene II, Cassius) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Cassius's accusation.

90. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “Caesar, beware of Brutus; take heed of Cassius”

    A. Act II, Scene III

    B. Act III, Scene III

    C. Act II, Scene IV

    D. Act V, Scene II

    Key: A (Act II, Scene III)

91. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] If Caesar had read the letter, would the play's events have been different? What does this scene suggest about chance?

    Sample answer: Accept arguments for chance, character, and fate.

92. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Act II, Scene III”? Artemidorus reads his warning letter to the audience.

    A. Structure

    B. Simile

    C. Allusion

    D. Characterization

    Key: A (Structure)

93. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Caesar, beware of Brutus; take heed of Cassius” (Act II, Scene III, Artemidorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The letter.
94. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how fate and omens develops from an earlier scene to “Act II, Scene III”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: one more warning that fails.
95. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Compare this scene with Antony's funeral speech. Which shows the 'real' Antony?
    Sample answer: Strong answers see both as performances of one strategic self.
96. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Is Lucilius's deception admirable even though it is a lie?
    Sample answer: Weigh loyalty against honesty.
97. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “This is a slight unmeritable man, / Meet to be sent on errands” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Antony on Lepidus.
98. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how power and ambition develops from an earlier scene to “Act IV, Scene I”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be.
99. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Brutus, my country’s friend; know me for Brutus” (Act V, Scene IV, Brutus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Lucilius's disguise.
100. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: "If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live," he says, and the audience knows Caesar will not read it.
101. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: They begin with "These many, then, shall die," and Antony plans to "cut off some charge in legacies" from the will he used to win the crowd.
102. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho” (Act V, Scene IV, Cato) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Young Cato.
103. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how friendship and loyalty develops from an earlier scene to “Act V, Scene IV”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Lucilius's loyalty.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30, 31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40, 41, 42, 43, 44, 45, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50	recall 29, inference 12, analysis 6, synthesis 3
HS Freshman		recall 26, inference 12, analysis 9, synthesis 3

	7, 2, 4, 9, 8, 10, 6, 5, 1, 17, 51, 13, 18, 15, 14, 52, 11, 19, 29, 23, 26, 53, 21, 22, 54, 27, 55, 31, 56, 33, 57, 35, 37, 34, 58, 59, 38, 41, 42, 60, 61, 44, 62, 45, 63, 47, 64, 65, 66, 67	
HS Sophomore	9, 7, 8, 10, 4, 5, 2, 17, 15, 19, 11, 12, 68, 69, 70, 22, 71, 23, 24, 31, 32, 30, 56, 72, 55, 35, 37, 57, 36, 34, 73, 40, 39, 59, 58, 42, 74, 43, 62, 75, 44, 76, 64, 47, 77, 48, 78, 49, 79, 67	recall 19, inference 16, analysis 9, synthesis 6
HS Junior	4, 8, 1, 3, 5, 7, 20, 18, 15, 16, 51, 69, 70, 24, 26, 25, 72, 30, 56, 31, 33, 32, 80, 57, 35, 36, 34, 59, 73, 38, 58, 40, 74, 43, 61, 60, 81, 45, 62, 75, 47, 64, 63, 76, 48, 77, 49, 66, 67, 82	recall 16, inference 16, analysis 12, synthesis 6
HS Senior	3, 6, 4, 5, 10, 12, 16, 51, 52, 26, 70, 22, 71, 32, 56, 55, 31, 30, 33, 80, 35, 34, 57, 83, 59, 41, 73, 40, 39, 61, 42, 43, 60, 62, 75, 81, 45, 46, 47, 63, 64, 77, 84, 65, 49, 85, 78, 82, 67, 86	recall 13, inference 16, analysis 12, synthesis 9
AP	5, 9, 6, 16, 17, 19, 22, 53, 27, 31, 55, 30, 56, 57, 36, 37, 83, 38, 41, 58, 59, 43, 61, 74, 60, 42, 87, 45, 62, 75, 81, 44, 47, 63, 76, 64, 46, 48, 65, 84, 88, 77, 89, 66, 85, 49, 79, 50, 82, 86	recall 9, inference 12, analysis 16, synthesis 13
College Freshman	8, 9, 10, 13, 52, 68, 26, 71, 24, 30, 31, 72, 33, 36, 83, 34, 57, 58, 41, 59, 73, 43, 42, 60, 74, 61, 87, 81, 62, 75, 45, 44, 76, 64, 46, 47, 63, 65, 48, 77, 88, 84, 49, 85, 89, 66, 67, 79, 50, 86	recall 9, inference 12, analysis 16, synthesis 13
College Sophomore	9, 8, 68, 20, 53, 70, 30, 32, 56, 55, 35, 57, 83, 80, 41, 38, 73, 59, 61, 74, 43, 42, 60, 90, 81, 75, 62, 44, 45, 76, 63, 47, 46, 64, 88, 77, 84, 65, 48, 91, 49, 85, 89, 78, 66, 67, 86, 82, 79, 50	recall 6, inference 12, analysis 16, synthesis 16
College Junior	9, 2, 20, 16, 25, 54, 31, 55, 56, 80, 83, 34, 41, 38, 73, 60, 74, 61, 43, 42, 92, 45, 81, 75, 62, 44, 76, 47, 46, 64, 63, 65, 48, 84, 77, 88, 93, 94, 95, 66, 89, 78, 49, 85, 96, 86, 67, 79, 82, 50	recall 6, inference 9, analysis 16, synthesis 19
College Senior	9, 8, 21, 56, 32, 55, 37, 34, 36, 73, 41, 39, 60, 42, 61, 74, 43, 90, 62, 81, 44, 75, 45, 76, 63, 46, 64, 47, 88, 65, 48, 84, 77, 91, 93, 94, 97, 98, 78, 85, 49, 66, 89, 96, 99, 50, 79, 86, 67, 82	recall 3, inference 9, analysis 16, synthesis 22
Graduate / PhD	9, 52, 28, 31, 33, 34, 35, 38, 73, 42, 61, 60, 43, 74, 87, 44, 81, 45, 75, 62, 46, 63, 76, 64, 47, 84, 77, 88, 65, 48, 91, 94, 93, 100, 95, 101, 97, 78, 66, 89, 49, 85, 96, 102, 103, 86, 67, 50, 79, 82	recall 3, inference 6, analysis 16, synthesis 25

Final paper

Julius Caesar: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how William Shakespeare develops power, ambition and tyranny across Julius Caesar. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in Julius Caesar and argue how its meaning changes over the play and why that change matters to honor and self-deception.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in Julius Caesar. Argue whether the play judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether Julius Caesar finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of rhetoric and persuasion. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: Scaffolded support 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

Evidence requirement: at least 6 quotations from at least three sections, from the beginning, middle and end. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the act, scene and line (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.
Organization	15	Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.

Essay assignments

Essay: Power, ambition and tyranny

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Julius Caesar teaches about power, ambition and tyranny. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops power, ambition and tyranny in Julius Caesar. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops power, ambition and tyranny across Julius Caesar. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Julius Caesar (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of power, ambition and tyranny. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of power, ambition and tyranny in Julius Caesar. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Julius Caesar (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of power, ambition and tyranny, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Julius Caesar's treatment of power, ambition and tyranny in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on power, ambition and tyranny in Julius Caesar that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on power, ambition and tyranny in Julius Caesar. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about power, ambition and tyranny in Julius Caesar, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on power, ambition and tyranny in Julius Caesar, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Honor and self-deception

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Julius Caesar teaches about honor and self-deception. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops honor and self-deception in Julius Caesar. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops honor and self-deception across Julius Caesar. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Julius Caesar (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of honor and self-deception. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of honor and self-deception in Julius Caesar. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Julius Caesar (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of honor and self-deception, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Julius Caesar's treatment of honor and self-deception in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on honor and self-deception in Julius Caesar that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on honor and self-deception in Julius Caesar. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about honor and self-deception in Julius Caesar, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on honor and self-deception in Julius Caesar, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Rhetoric and persuasion

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Julius Caesar teaches about rhetoric and persuasion. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops rhetoric and persuasion in Julius Caesar. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops rhetoric and persuasion across Julius Caesar. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Julius Caesar (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of rhetoric and persuasion. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of rhetoric and persuasion in Julius Caesar. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Julius Caesar (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of rhetoric and persuasion, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Julius Caesar's treatment of rhetoric and persuasion in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on rhetoric and persuasion in Julius Caesar that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on rhetoric and persuasion in Julius Caesar. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about rhetoric and persuasion in Julius Caesar, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on rhetoric and persuasion in Julius Caesar, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Public versus private self

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Julius Caesar teaches about public versus private self. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops public versus private self in Julius Caesar. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops public versus private self across Julius Caesar. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Julius Caesar (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of public versus private self. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of public versus private self in Julius Caesar. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Julius Caesar (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of public versus private self, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Julius Caesar's treatment of public versus private self in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on public versus private self in Julius Caesar that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on public versus private self in Julius Caesar. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about public versus private self in Julius Caesar, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on public versus private self in Julius Caesar, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

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Essay: Fate, omens and free will

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Julius Caesar teaches about fate, omens and free will. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops fate, omens and free will in Julius Caesar. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops fate, omens and free will across Julius Caesar. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Julius Caesar (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of fate, omens and free will. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of fate, omens and free will in Julius Caesar. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Julius Caesar (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of fate, omens and free will, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Julius Caesar's treatment of fate, omens and free will in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on fate, omens and free will in Julius Caesar that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

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